

QUESTION_ID: 87aa7bab

SOURCE_FILE: Central Ideas and Details(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 1

SKILL: Central Ideas and Details

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

A common assumption among art historians is that the invention of photography in the mid-nineteenth century displaced the painted portrait in the public consciousness. The diminishing popularity of the portrait miniature, which coincided with the rise of photography, seems to support this claim. However, photography's impact on the portrait miniature may be overstated. Although records from art exhibitions in the Netherlands from 1820 to 1892 show a decrease in the number of both full-sized and miniature portraits submitted, this trend was established before the invention of photography. Based on the text, what can be concluded about the diminishing popularity of the portrait miniature in the nineteenth century?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. Factors other than the rise of photography may be more directly responsible for the portrait miniature's decline.
 - B. Although portrait miniatures became less common than photographs, they were widely regarded as having more artistic merit.
 - C. The popularity of the portrait miniature likely persisted for longer than art historians have assumed.
 - D. As demand for portrait miniatures decreased, portrait artists likely shifted their creative focus to photography.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice A is the best answer. The text says that the impact of photography on the portrait miniature might be "overstated," as some records show a decrease in the number of portrait miniatures before the invention of photography. From this, we can conclude that factors other than the rise of photography may be more directly responsible for the portrait miniature's decline. Choice B is incorrect. The text never discusses the "artistic merit" of either art form. Choice C is incorrect. The text never suggests that the portrait miniature was popular for longer than historians thought-if anything, it suggests that the portrait miniature started losing its popularity earlier than historians thought. Choice D is incorrect. The text never suggests that portrait painters shifted to become photographers.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: d73a908a

SOURCE_FILE: Central Ideas and Details(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 2

SKILL: Central Ideas and Details

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

Believing that living in an impractical space can heighten awareness and even improve health, conceptual artists Madeline Gins and Shusaku Arakawa designed an apartment building in Japan to be more fanciful than functional. A kitchen counter is chest-high on one side and knee-high on the other; a ceiling has a door to nowhere. The effect is disorienting but invigorating: after four years there, filmmaker Nobu Yamaoka reported significant health benefits. Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. Although inhabiting a home surrounded by fanciful features such as those designed by Gins and Arakawa can be rejuvenating, it is unsustainable.
 - B. Designing disorienting spaces like those in the Gins and Arakawa building is the most effective way to create a physically stimulating environment.
 - C. As a filmmaker, Yamaoka has long supported the designs of conceptual artists such as Gins and Arakawa.
 - D. Although impractical, the design of the apartment building by Gins and Arakawa may improve the well-being of the building's residents.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice D is the best answer because it most accurately states the main idea of the text. According to the text, conceptual artists Gins and Arakawa have designed an apartment building that is disorienting because of several unconventional elements, such as uneven kitchen counters and "a door to nowhere." The text goes on to suggest that there may be benefits to this kind of design because filmmaker Yamaoka lived in the apartment building for four years and reported health benefits. Thus, although the design is impractical, it may improve the well-being of the apartment building's residents. Choice A is incorrect. Although the text mentions that Yamaoka lived in the apartment for four years, it doesn't address how long someone can beneficially live in a home surrounded by fanciful features or whether doing so can be sustained. Choice B is incorrect. Although the text mentions the potential benefits of living in a home with disorienting design features, it doesn't suggest that this is the most effective method to create a physically stimulating environment. Choice C is incorrect because the text refers to Yamaoka to support the claim that Gins and Arakawa's apartment building design may be beneficial, but the text doesn't indicate that Yamaoka supports the designs of other conceptual artists.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: ed314256

SOURCE_FILE: Central Ideas and Details(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 3

SKILL: Central Ideas and Details

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

The most recent iteration of the immersive theater experience *Sleep No More*, which premiered in New York City in 2011, transforms its performance space—a five-story warehouse—into a 1930s-era hotel. Audience members, who wander through the labyrinthine venue at their own pace and follow the actors as they play out simultaneous, interweaving narrative loops, confront the impossibility of experiencing the production in its entirety. The play's refusal of narrative coherence thus hinges on the sense of spatial fragmentation that the venue's immense and intricate layout generates.

What does the text most strongly suggest about *Sleep No More*'s use of its performance space?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

r

- A. The choice of a New York City venue likely enabled the play's creators to experiment with the use of theatrical space in a way that venues from earlier productions could not.
- B. Audience members likely find the experience of the play disappointing because they generally cannot make their way through the entire venue.
- C. The production's dependence on a particular performance environment would likely make it difficult to reproduce exactly in a different theatrical space.
- D. Audience members who navigate the space according to a recommended itinerary will likely have a better grasp of the play's narrative than audience members who depart from that itinerary.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice C is the best answer. The text says that the production's use of its large, winding space has a very specific effect on the audience. Given that the space itself is so important to creating this effect, it would be difficult to reproduce the production in a different space.

Choice A is incorrect. The fact that the venue is in New York City isn't connected to the experimental nature of the performance. It's the size of the venue, not its location in New York, that affects the theatrical experience. Choice B is incorrect. The text never suggests that audience members are disappointed because they can't see the entire production. In fact, it suggests that that's an important part of the experience.

Choice D is incorrect. The text doesn't mention a recommended itinerary for audience members.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 8c1be131

SOURCE_FILE: Central Ideas and Details(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 4

SKILL: Central Ideas and Details

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

During the World War II era, some Mexican American women adopted a striking new look called pachuca style. They wore altered men's jackets or zoot suits (wide-legged, long-coated suits) and dramatic makeup, and they combed their hair into high, rounded shapes. Some people criticized pachuca style, saying it was dangerous and women should dress traditionally. But historians see things differently. They see pachuca style as a form of rebellion against the era's rigid social expectations for women. They say that it showed a desire for self-expression and freedom on the part of women who adopted the style. According to the text, how do historians view pachuca style?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. They think that pachuca style was such a popular trend that it continues to influence fashion in the United States to the present day.
 - B. They think that pachuca style was a way for some Mexican American women to express themselves and resist strict social expectations.
 - C. They think that pachuca style was celebrated because it enabled some Mexican American women to show their support for the United States during World War II.
 - D. They think that pachuca style was similar to other fashion trends that different groups of women adopted in the same period.

CORRECT_ANSWER:**RATIONALE:**

e

Choice B is the best answer because it presents a statement about how historians view pachuca style that is supported by the text. The text first describes the distinctive pachuca style of dress adopted by some Mexican American women during World War II, saying that some criticized it and asserted that women should dress traditionally. The text then goes on to contrast this position with that of historians, who "see things differently": according to these historians, the pachuca style showed a wish for freedom and self-expression, and it acted as a kind of rebellion against what society expected of women at the time. Therefore, according to the text, historians think that the pachuca style was a way for Mexican women to express themselves and resist strict social expectations.

Choice A is incorrect because the text explicitly describes the pachuca style as a distinctive look adopted during the World War II era. It does not indicate that the pachuca style influences fashion in the United States in the present day. Choice C is incorrect because the text does not indicate that Mexican American women wore the pachuca style to show support for the United States during World War II; rather, the style was a means of self-expression and rebellion against social expectations. Choice D is incorrect because the text does not compare the pachuca style to other fashion trends: the pachuca style is the only style mentioned.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 92c2564d

SOURCE_FILE: Central Ideas and Details(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 5

SKILL: Central Ideas and Details

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

Utah is home to Pando, a colony of about 47,000 quaking aspen trees that all share a single root system. Pando is one of the largest single organisms by mass on Earth, but ecologists are worried that its growth is declining in part because of grazing by animals. The ecologists say that strong fences could prevent deer from eating young trees and help Pando start thriving again. According to the text, why are ecologists worried about Pando?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

r

- A. It isn't growing at the same rate it used to.
- B. It isn't producing young trees anymore.
- C. It can't grow into new areas because it is blocked by fences.
- D. Its root system can't support many more new trees.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice A is the best answer because it presents an explanation that is directly stated in the text for why ecologists are worried about Pando. The text states that Pando is a colony of about 47,000 quaking aspen trees that represents one of the largest organisms on Earth. According to the text, ecologists are worried that Pando's growth is declining, partly because animals are feeding on the trees. In other words, the ecologists are worried that Pando isn't growing at the same rate it used to. Choice B is incorrect. Rather than indicating that Pando isn't producing young trees anymore, the text reveals that Pando is indeed producing young trees, stating that those trees can be protected from grazing deer by strong fences. Choice C is incorrect because the text states that fences can be used to prevent deer from eating Pando's young trees, not that Pando itself can't grow in new areas because it's blocked by fences. Choice D is incorrect because the text offers no evidence that Pando's root system is incapable of supporting new trees or is otherwise a cause of worry for ecologists.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 458b4a11

SOURCE_FILE: Central Ideas and Details(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 6

SKILL: Central Ideas and Details

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

To understand how temperature change affects microorganism-mediated cycling of soil nutrients in alpine ecosystems, Eva Kaštovská et al. collected plant-soil cores in the Tatra Mountains at elevations around 2,100 meters and transplanted them to elevations of 1,700-1,800 meters, where the mean air temperature was warmer by 2°C. Microorganism-mediated nutrient cycling was accelerated in the transplanted cores; crucially, microorganism community composition was unchanged, allowing Kaštovská et al. to attribute the acceleration to temperature-induced increases in microorganism activity. It can most reasonably be inferred from the text that the finding about the microorganism community composition was important for which reason?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. It provided preliminary evidence that microorganism-mediated nutrient cycling was accelerated in the transplanted cores.
 - B. It suggested that temperature-induced changes in microorganism activity may be occurring at increasingly high elevations.
 - C. It ruled out a potential alternative explanation for the acceleration in microorganism-mediated nutrient cycling.
 - D. It clarified that microorganism activity levels in the plant-soil cores varied depending on which microorganisms comprised the community.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice C is the best answer because it accurately describes why the finding about the microorganism community composition was important. The text describes an experiment by Eva Kaštovská and her team in which they collected plant-soil cores at one elevation and transplanted them to sites at a lower elevation, where the mean air temperature was warmer. Kaštovská and her team observed that microorganism-mediated nutrient cycling was accelerated in the transplanted cores and that "crucially, microorganism community composition was unchanged," which allowed the team to attribute the acceleration to changes in microorganism activity brought about by the difference in temperature. This strongly implies that the team wouldn't have been able to make that attribution otherwise, meaning that a change in microorganism composition represented another possible explanation for the acceleration that had to be ruled out. Choice A is incorrect. Although the text says microorganism-mediated cycling of soil nutrients increased in the transplanted cores, this is unrelated to what's important about the finding that the microorganism composition didn't change—that it allowed the team to attribute the change in activity solely to the change in temperature. Choice B is incorrect. Although the text compares activity in one core at two different elevations, the text doesn't address changes in activity at various elevations over time. Choice D is incorrect. Although different microorganisms likely exhibit different levels of activity, the text indicates that there was no change in microorganism composition, and there is nothing in the text about different microorganisms having different activity levels.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 3543e6e2

SOURCE_FILE: Central Ideas and Details(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 7

SKILL: Central Ideas and Details

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

The following text is from Jane Austen's 1811 novel *Sense and Sensibility*. Elinor lives with her younger sisters and her mother, Mrs. Dashwood. Elinor, this eldest daughter, whose advice was so effectual, possessed a strength of understanding, and coolness of judgment, which qualified her, though only nineteen, to be the counsellor of her mother, and enabled her frequently to counteract, to the advantage of them all, that eagerness of mind in Mrs. Dashwood which must generally have led to imprudence. She had an excellent heart; her disposition was affectionate, and her feelings were strong; but she knew how to govern them: it was a knowledge which her mother had yet to learn; and which one of her sisters had resolved never to be taught. According to the text, what is true about Elinor?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. Elinor often argues with her mother but fails to change her mind.
 - B. Elinor can be overly sensitive with regard to family matters.
 - C. Elinor thinks her mother is a bad role model.
 - D. Elinor is remarkably mature for her age.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice D is the best answer because it provides a detail about Elinor that is established in the text. The text indicates that although Elinor is "only nineteen, " she gives good advice and exhibits such a high level of understanding and judgment that she serves as "the counsellor of her mother."

Thus, Elinor is mature beyond her years.

Choice A is incorrect because it isn't supported by the text: although the text says that Elinor advises her mother and often counteracts her mother's impulses, there's no mention of Elinor arguing with her mother or failing to change her mother's mind.

Choice B is incorrect because it isn't supported by the text: although the text mentions that Elinor has strong feelings, it doesn't indicate that she's excessively sensitive when it comes to family issues. Choice C is incorrect because it isn't supported by the text: there's no mention of what Elinor thinks about her mother and no suggestion that she thinks her mother is a bad role model. Because she's described as having "an excellent heart, " Elinor likely doesn't think ill of her mother.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 1ba5ad7a

SOURCE_FILE: Central Ideas and Details(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 8

SKILL: Central Ideas and Details

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

Many literary theorists distinguish between *fabula*, a narrative's content, and *syuzhet*, a narrative's arrangement and presentation of events. In the film *The Godfather Part II*, the *fabula* is the story of the Corleone family, and the *syuzhet* is the presentation of the story as it alternates between two timelines in 1901 and 1958. But literary theorist Mikhail Bakhtin maintained that *fabula* and *syuzhet* are insufficient to completely describe a narrative—he held that systematic categorizations of artistic phenomena discount the subtle way in which meaning is created by interactions between the artist, the work, and the audience. Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. Literary theorist Mikhail Bakhtin argued that there are important characteristics of narratives that are not fully encompassed by two concepts that other theorists have used to analyze narratives.
 - B. Literary theorist Mikhail Bakhtin claimed that meaning is not inherent in a narrative but is created when an audience encounters a narrative so that narratives are interpreted differently by different people.
 - C. The storytelling methods used in *The Godfather Part II* may seem unusually complicated, but they can be easily understood when two concepts from literary theory are utilized.
 - D. Narratives that are told out of chronological order are more difficult for audiences to understand than are narratives presented chronologically.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice A is the best answer because it most accurately states the main idea of the text. The text begins by explaining that many literary theorists rely on the concepts of *fabula* (a narrative's content) and *syuzhet* (a narrative's arrangement and presentation of events) and illustrates these concepts by explaining how they can be applied to the film *The Godfather Part II*. The text then discusses how Mikhail Bakhtin, a literary theorist, argued that *fabula* and *syuzhet* can't fully describe a narrative, since systematic categorizations such as these fail to account for all the ways in which interactions between the artist, the work, and the audience produce meaning. Thus, the main idea is that Bakhtin argued that there are important characteristics of narratives that are not fully encompassed by two concepts that other theorists have used to analyze narratives.

Choice B is incorrect because according to the text, Mikhail Bakhtin believed that meaning was created through the interactions of the artist, narrative, and audience, not simply through the interaction between the audience and narrative; moreover, the text doesn't address whether Bakhtin focused on the ways in which different people interpret narratives differently. Choice C is incorrect. Although the text implies that the storytelling methods used in *The Godfather Part II* are complicated, it discusses the film only to illustrate how the concepts of *fabula* and *syuzhet* may be applied to a narrative. The film's storytelling methods aren't the primary focus of the text. Choice D is incorrect. The text discusses *The Godfather Part II*, whose narrative doesn't adhere to a single chronological order, only to illustrate the concepts of *fabula* (a narrative's content) and *syuzhet* (a narrative's arrangement and presentation of events). The primary focus of this text isn't the structure of this film or of other narratives that are told out of chronological order; moreover, the text doesn't consider whether such structures make it harder for audiences to understand narratives.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 602b47c7

SOURCE_FILE: Central Ideas and Details(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 9

SKILL: Central Ideas and Details

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

Biologists have predicted that birds' feather structures vary with habitat temperature, but this hadn't been tested in mountain environments.

Ornithologist Sahas Barve studied feathers from 249 songbird species inhabiting different elevations-and thus experiencing different temperatures-in the Himalaya Mountains. He found that feathers of high-elevation species not only have a greater proportion of warming downy sections to flat and smooth sections than do feathers of low-elevation species, but high-elevation species' feathers also tend to be longer, providing a thicker layer of insulation.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

r

A. Barve's investigation shows that some species of Himalayan songbirds have evolved feathers that better regulate body temperature than do the feathers of other species, contradicting previous predictions.

B. Barve found an association between habitat temperature and feather structure among Himalayan songbirds, lending new support to a general prediction.

C. Barve discovered that songbirds have adapted to their environment by growing feathers without flat and smooth sections, complicating an earlier hypothesis.

D. The results of Barve's study suggest that the ability of birds to withstand cold temperatures is determined more strongly by feather length than feather structure, challenging an established belief.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice B is the best answer. The text describes how Barve found an association between habitat temperature and feather structure among Himalayan songbirds, which supports the general prediction that birds' feather structures vary with habitat temperature.

Choice A is incorrect. Barve's study isn't said to contradict previous predictions. In fact, the study supports the prediction described in the first sentence, which is that birds' feather structures vary with habitat temperature. Choice C is incorrect. Barve's study isn't said to "complicate an earlier hypothesis."

" In fact, the study supports the earlier prediction described in the first sentence, which is that birds' feather structures vary

with habitat temperature. Choice D is incorrect. The text doesn't compare the importance of feather length and feather structure, and it doesn't

say that Barve's study challenges any established beliefs. In fact, the study supports the prediction described in the first sentence, which is that birds' feather structures vary with habitat temperature.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: cf956802

SOURCE_FILE: Central Ideas and Details(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 10

SKILL: Central Ideas and Details

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

When fashion designer Lloyd Henri Kiva New opened his store in Scottsdale, Arizona, in 1945, he quickly became known for creating delicately crafted leather goods, like belts and hats. He was perhaps most renowned for his colorful handbags, which he made by hand using a long and painstaking process. As he gained more customers, New began using sewing machines and other tools to help him produce bags more efficiently, though he continued to handcraft the crucial details that made each bag unique. Based on the text, what would have been the most likely consequence if New had not begun using sewing machines?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

r

- A. He would have been unable to ensure that each bag included unique, handcrafted details.
- B. He would have struggled to meet the increasing demand for his bags.
- C. He would have had to individually design each bag he produced.
- D. He would not have been able to generate as much interest in his bags.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice B is the best answer because it presents the most likely consequence if New had not begun using sewing machines. The text states that New gained new customers and that sewing machines allowed him to make bags more efficiently, or in less time than he could when sewing by hand. It's reasonable to conclude that if New hadn't reduced the time it took to make each bag by starting to use sewing machines, it would have been hard for him to keep up with the increased demand. Choice A is incorrect because the text indicates that New added unique, handcrafted details to his bags before he started using sewing machines and continued to do so after he started using them. Choice C is incorrect because the text doesn't suggest that individually designing each bag would have been a consequence of not using sewing machines, since New was already designing unique details for each bag before he started using sewing machines and continued to do so after he started using them. Choice D is incorrect because the text indicates that people were already interested in New's bags before he started using sewing machines. Rather than allowing New to generate more interest in his bags, sewing machines helped New keep up with the interest that had already grown.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 714e4c10

SOURCE_FILE: Central Ideas and Details(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 11

SKILL: Central Ideas and Details

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

Ruth Asawa was an accomplished artist who worked in many art forms, including her unique tied-wire sculptures, but she was dedicated to more than the creation of art. Asawa also wanted to bring art to children in her hometown of San Francisco, California. To that end, in 1968 she cofounded the Alvarado School Arts Workshop, which brought works of art and artists into public schools, and in 1982 she helped found a San Francisco public arts high school, which was later named after her. Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. Asawa inspired many other artists to share their work with students in public schools.
 - B. Asawa's unique sculptures were appreciated more by local art communities than they were nationwide.
 - C. Asawa's interest in art education prompted her to create art programs for students in San Francisco.
 - D. Asawa left a promising career as a sculptor to work as an art teacher in San Francisco schools.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice C is the best answer because it most accurately states the main idea of the text. The text begins by establishing Ruth Asawa as an artist who worked in several art forms but emphasizes that she was interested in art for reasons other than her desire to create it. The text mentions two ways in which Asawa brought art to children through public schools: cofounding the Alvarado School Arts Workshop in 1968 and helping found a public arts high school in 1982. Thus, the main idea is that Asawa's interest in art education motivated her to establish arts programs for students in San Francisco.

Choice A is incorrect because the text doesn't mention Asawa inspiring other artists to share their work with students. While the text does note that the Alvarado School Arts Workshop brought works of art and artists into public schools, it doesn't state that Asawa motivated these artists.

Choice B is incorrect because the text makes no comparison between local and national appreciation of Asawa's sculptures. While the text does mention that Asawa created unique tied-wire sculptures and was connected to San Francisco, it does not contrast her local and national critical receptions. Choice D is incorrect. Although the text emphasizes Asawa's educational initiatives, it doesn't state or imply that she abandoned her career as a sculptor to work as an art teacher. Instead, the text portrays her educational work as a complement to her career as a successful artist.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 11a9f635

SOURCE_FILE: Central Ideas and Details(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 12

SKILL: Central Ideas and Details

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

Paleontologists searching for signs of ancient life have found many fossilized specimens of prehistoric human ancestors, including several from the Pleistocene era discovered in a geological formation in the Minatogawa quarry in Japan. However, to study the emergence of the earliest multicellular organisms to appear on Earth, researchers must turn elsewhere, such as to the Ediacaran geological formation at Mistaken Point in Canada. A UNESCO World Heritage Site, the 146-hectare reserve contains more than 10,000 fossils that together document a critical moment in evolutionary history.

What does the text indicate about the geological formation at Mistaken Point?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. It holds a greater number of fossils but from a smaller variety of species than the formation in the Minatogawa quarry does.
 - B. It has provided evidence that the earliest human species may have emerged before the Pleistocene era.
 - C. It is widely considered by paleontologists to be the most valuable source of information about prehistoric life forms.
 - D. It contains specimens from an older time period than those found in the formation in the Minatogawa quarry.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice D is the best answer. The text says that the formation at Mistaken Point contains fossils of "the earliest multicellular organisms," which implies that these fossils are from an older time period than the fossils of "prehistoric human ancestors" found in the Minatogawa quarry.

Choice A is incorrect. The text says that the formation at Mistake Point contains "more than 10,000 fossils," but it doesn't compare this number to the number of fossils in the Minatogawa quarry. It also doesn't say anything about the variety of species in either formation. Choice B is incorrect. The text says that the formation at Mistaken Point contains fossils of "the earliest multicellular organisms," but it never says that the site contains early human fossils too. Rather, the early human fossils mentioned in the text were found in the formation at Minatogawa quarry.

Choice C is incorrect. The text says that the fossils at Mistaken Point "document a critical moment in evolutionary history," but it never says that Mistaken Point is the most valuable source of information about prehistoric life forms.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 2312021b

SOURCE_FILE: Central Ideas and Details(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 13

SKILL: Central Ideas and Details

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

In a study by Mika R. Moran, Daniel A. Rodriguez, and colleagues, residents of Quito, Ecuador, and Lima, Peru, were surveyed about parks in their cities. Of the 618 respondents from Quito, 82.9% indicated that they use the city's parks, and of the 663 respondents from Lima, 72.7% indicated using city parks. Given that the percentage of Quito respondents who reported living within a 10-minute walk of a park was much lower than that reported by Lima respondents, greater proximity alone can't explain the difference in park use. The text makes which point about the difference between the proportions of Quito residents and Lima residents using parks?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. It was much larger than the researchers conducting the study expected.
 - B. It is caused by something other than the parks' proximity to city residents.
 - C. It could be due to inaccuracies in the survey results.
 - D. It was calculated using sources that predate the survey.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice B is the best answer because it presents a statement about the difference between the proportions of Quito residents and Lima residents using parks that is supported by the text. The text states that 82.9% of surveyed Quito residents and 72.7% of surveyed Lima residents reported using their city's parks. The text then notes that compared to Lima respondents, a much smaller percentage of Quito respondents said they live within a 10-minute walk of a park. The text concludes that because a greater proportion of Quito respondents used parks despite generally living farther from them than Lima respondents did, "greater proximity"-being closer to a park-"can't explain the difference in park use."

That is, the text makes the point that the difference between the proportions of Quito residents and Lima residents using parks is caused by something other than the distance of the parks from city residents.

Choice A is incorrect because the text doesn't address whether the researchers had expected a particular result and doesn't indicate that they were surprised by the difference in park usage between the two cities' residents. The text simply presents the survey findings without stating the researchers' expectations. Choice C is incorrect because the text gives no indication that there might be inaccuracies in the survey results; the text presents the findings as factual information and uses them as the basis for a conclusion that a certain factor doesn't explain differences in park usage between Quito and Lima residents. Choice D is incorrect because the text doesn't mention any sources that predate the survey or suggest that the difference in proportions was calculated using such sources. According to the text, the information about park usage came directly from the survey of residents in Quito and Lima.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 57485f5e

SOURCE_FILE: Central Ideas and Details(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 14

SKILL: Central Ideas and Details

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

The following text is adapted from Johanna Spyri's 1881 novel Heidi (translated by Elisabeth Stork in 1915). Eight-year-old Heidi and her friend's grandmother are looking at some illustrated books. Heidi had come and was looking with wondering eyes at the splendid pictures in the large books, that Grandmama was showing her. Suddenly she screamed aloud, for there on the picture she saw a peaceful flock grazing on a green pasture. In the middle a shepherd was standing, leaning on his crook. The setting sun was shedding a golden light over everything. With glowing eyes Heidi devoured the scene. Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. Heidi is upset until she sees a serene image of a pasture in one of Grandmama's books.
 - B. Heidi is delighted and fascinated by an image she sees in one of Grandmama's books.
 - C. Heidi is initially frightened by an image in one of Grandmama's books but quickly comes to appreciate its beauty.
 - D. Heidi is inspecting an image in one of Grandmama's books because she has never seen a shepherd with his sheep before.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice B is the best answer because it most effectively states the main idea of the text, which is that Heidi is delighted and fascinated by an image she sees in one of Grandmama's books. In the text, Heidi screams upon first seeing the picture of the green pasture. In another context, such a reaction might suggest fear, but here the reaction is followed by descriptions of an image that's peaceful rather than scary. The text goes on to describe Heidi's eyes as "glowing" and states that she "devoured the scene," suggesting that the image delights and fascinates her so much that she wants to examine every detail. Together, these descriptions suggest that Heidi is thrilled and intrigued by the image in the book. Choice A is incorrect because there's nothing in the text to suggest that Heidi is upset before seeing the peaceful image of the green pasture. Before Heidi sees that image, the text describes her as "looking with wondering eyes at the splendid pictures" in the book, suggesting that Heidi is intrigued, not that she's unhappy. Choice C is incorrect. Although Heidi screams upon first seeing the image, the text's description of the image and Heidi's other reactions to it suggest that she is screaming with delight, not fear. The text describes the images in the book as "splendid" and the particular image that causes her to scream as peaceful rather than frightening. It also describes Heidi's eyes as "glowing" and states that she "devoured the scene," suggesting that the image of the green pasture delights and fascinates her so much that she wants to examine every detail. Choice D is incorrect because it's unclear from the text whether Heidi has ever seen a shepherd with his sheep before. The text merely suggests that she is delighted and fascinated by the image of the shepherd and his sheep.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: e677fa6c

SOURCE_FILE: Central Ideas and Details(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 15

SKILL: Central Ideas and Details

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

The following text is adapted from Edgar Allan Poe's 1849 story "Landor's Cottage."

During a pedestrian trip last summer, through one or two of the river counties of New York, I found myself, as the day declined, somewhat embarrassed about the road I was pursuing. The land undulated very remarkably; and my path, for the last hour, had wound about and about so confusedly, in its effort to keep in the valleys, that I no longer knew in what direction lay the sweet village of B--, where I had determined to stop for the night. Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. The narrator remembers a trip he took and admits to getting lost.
 - B. The narrator recalls fond memories of a journey that he took through some beautiful river counties.
 - C. The narrator describes what he saw during a long trip through a frequently visited location.
 - D. The narrator explains the difficulties he encountered on a trip and how he overcame them.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice A is the best answer. The narrator is "embarrassed" about the route he took, which ends up leaving him lost and confused about how to get to his destination for the evening. Choice B is incorrect. This choice doesn't match the passage. The narrator is embarrassed, rather than fond, and he doesn't describe the beauty of the place. Choice C is incorrect. This choice doesn't match the passage. We don't know from this excerpt whether or not the narrator has visited this part of New York multiple times. Choice D is incorrect. This choice doesn't match the passage. The narrator doesn't explain how he overcame being lost in this excerpt.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 11c68ded

SOURCE_FILE: Central Ideas and Details(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 16

SKILL: Central Ideas and Details

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

A contraction of "you all," the pronoun "y'all" has long been used as a plural version of "you" in the South and in Black communities around the US. In recent decades, most other English-speaking communities in the US have begun to use "y'all." What explains its rise in popularity? Many varieties of English have no pronoun that specifically addresses more than one person and instead must use "you" to address both one person and more than one. But "y'all" always refers to two or more people. As a result, it conveys the speaker's meaning more precisely than "you" can. Which question does the text most directly attempt to answer?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. How many other plural versions of the pronoun "you" are there in English, besides "y'all"?
 - B. Why has the pronoun "y'all" become more widely used in the US?
 - C. When was the first recorded use of the pronoun "y'all" in the English language?
 - D. Is "y'all" commonly used in English-speaking regions of the world besides the US?

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice B is the best answer because it presents a question that the text is attempting to answer: why has the pronoun "y'all" become more widely used in the US? The text begins by explaining where and how the plural pronoun "y'all" originated and then goes on to state that its use has been rising in popularity, even in areas outside of its place of origin. The text then attributes this rise in popularity to the fact that many varieties of English do not have a pronoun to address more than one person, and thus "you" must function as both a singular and plural pronoun. Choice A is incorrect because while the text states that "y'all" is used as a plural of "you" in English, it does not discuss other plural forms of the word. Choice C is incorrect because while the text discusses the general origins of the pronoun "y'all," it does not state when the use of the pronoun was first recorded in the English language. Choice D is incorrect because though the text addresses the use of the pronoun "y'all" within English-speaking communities in the US, it does not address its use outside of that geographic area.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 66c47028

SOURCE_FILE: Central Ideas and Details(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 17

SKILL: Central Ideas and Details

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

In 1934 physicist Eugene Wigner posited the existence of a crystal consisting entirely of electrons in a honeycomb-like structure. The so-called Wigner crystal remained largely conjecture, however, until Feng Wang and colleagues announced in 2021 that they had captured an image of one. The researchers trapped electrons between two semiconductors and then cooled the apparatus, causing the electrons to settle into a crystalline structure. By inserting an ultrathin sheet of graphene above the crystal, the researchers obtained an impression—the first visual confirmation of the Wigner crystal.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

r

- A. Researchers have obtained the most definitive evidence to date of the existence of the Wigner crystal.
- B. Researchers have identified an innovative new method for working with unusual crystalline structures.
- C. Graphene is the most important of the components required to capture an image of a Wigner crystal.
- D. It's difficult to acquire an image of a Wigner crystal because of the crystal's honeycomb structure.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice A is the best answer because it most accurately states the main idea of the text. According to the text, Eugene Wigner hypothesized that a crystal could exist that would be composed of electrons and have a honeycomb-like shape. The text goes on to say that the existence of the Wigner crystal remained unconfirmed until Feng Wang and colleagues were able to make an impression of one using two semiconductors and an ultrathin sheet of graphene. Thus, the main idea is that researchers have obtained the most definitive evidence to date of the existence of the Wigner crystal.

Choice B is incorrect because the text focuses on one kind of crystal—the Wigner crystal—and doesn't discuss crystalline structures in general. And although the text conveys that Wang and colleagues figured out a way to capture an image of a Wigner crystal, it doesn't address the idea of applying this approach to other types of crystals. Choice C is incorrect because the text describes in general the process Wang and colleagues followed to obtain an impression of the Wigner crystal; it doesn't address the relative importance of each component in that process. Choice D is incorrect because the text doesn't state that researchers had a hard time getting an impression of the Wigner crystal because of its honeycomb structure. Nothing in the text indicates why it took so long to prove the existence of this crystal or take an impression of it.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 1a2b29c9

SOURCE_FILE: Central Ideas and Details(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 18

SKILL: Central Ideas and Details

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

The following text is adapted from María Cristina Mena's 1914 short story "The Vine-Leaf."
"

It is a saying in the capital of Mexico that Dr. Malsufrido carries more family secrets under his hat than any archbishop.

The doctor's hat is, appropriately enough, uncommonly capacious, rising very high, and sinking so low that it seems to be

supported by his ears and eyebrows, and it has a furry look, as if it had been brushed the wrong way, which is perhaps what

happens to it if it is ever brushed at all. When the doctor takes it off, the family secrets do not fly out like a flock of parrots, but

remain nicely bottled up beneath a dome of old and highly polished ivory.

Based on the text, how do people in the capital of Mexico most likely regard Dr. Malsufrido?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

r

A. Many have come to tolerate him despite his disheveled appearance.

B. Few feel concerned that he will divulge their confidences.

C. Some dislike how freely he discusses his own family.

D. Most would be unimpressed by him were it not for his professional expertise.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice B is the best answer. The text describes a saying in the capital that Malsufrido keeps more secrets than an archbishop. It also says that

when he takes off his hat, "the family secrets do not fly out... but remain nicely bottled up,

" suggesting that he will not betray his confidences.

Choice A is incorrect. This choice doesn't reflect the text. While his hat is large and appears to have been brushed in the wrong direction, Dr.

Malsufrido does not seem to be regarded as ill-dressed or disheveled. Choice C is incorrect. This choice is the opposite of what the text says.

The secrets of families (his and others') remain "bottled up" in his head. Choice D is incorrect. This choice isn't supported by the text. His

professional expertise is not discussed in the passage.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 2fdfe002

SOURCE_FILE: Central Ideas and Details(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 19

SKILL: Central Ideas and Details

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

The following text is adapted from Countee Cullen's 1926 poem "Thoughts in a Zoo."
"

They in their cruel traps, and we in ours,
Survey each other's rage, and pass the hours
Commiserating each the other's woe,
To mitigate his own pain's fiery glow.
Man could but little proffer in exchange
Save that his cages have a larger range.
That lion with his lordly, untamed hear t
Has in some man his human counterpar t,
Some lofty soul in dreams and visions wrapped,
But in the stifling flesh securely trapped.
Based on the text, what challenge do humans sometimes experience?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. They cannot effectively tame cer tain wild animals because of a lack of compassion.
 - B. They cannot focus on setting attainable goals because of a lack of motivation.
 - C. They quickly become frustrated when faced with difficult tasks because of a lack of self-control.
 - D. They have aspirations that cannot be fulfilled because of cer tain limitations.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice D is the best answer. The text metaphorically likens humans to animals in a zoo, suggesting that humans have dreams that they cannot fulfill because they are trapped.

Choice A is incorrect. The speaker says that the lion has an "untamed hear t," but the speaker doesn't actually mention anything about humans taming wild animals or a lack of compassion. Choice B is incorrect. The speaker doesn't suggest that humans lack motivation. Rather, the speaker thinks that humans are "trapped" and prevented from achieving their dreams. Choice C is incorrect. The speaker doesn't mention anything about humans becoming frustrated or lacking self-control. Rather, the speaker thinks that humans are "trapped" and prevented from achieving their dreams.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 0d81b7d9

SOURCE_FILE: Central Ideas and Details(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 20

SKILL: Central Ideas and Details

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

Paleontologist Alan Tennyson and colleagues studied fossil bones found in New Zealand that are more than 55 million years old. The researchers determined that the fossil bones belonged to two previously unknown species of prehistoric penguins. Moreover, they estimated that one of the two penguin species was more than three times the size of the emperor penguin, which is the largest penguin species that exists today.

Based on the text, which choice best describes the two previously unknown penguin species?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. They are frequently studied by paleontologists.
 - B. They are no longer living species.
 - C. They were smaller than penguin species that exist today.
 - D. They spent little of their lives in water.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice B is the best answer because it presents a statement about the two previously unknown penguin species that is supported by the text. According to the text, Alan Tennyson and colleagues studied fossil bones belonging to two previously unknown penguin species that are described as prehistoric, or ancient. The text goes on to say that one of the two species was considerably larger than the emperor penguin, which is currently the largest penguin in existence. Thus, the text indicates that the other species aren't in existence today, or that the two previously unknown penguin species are no longer living species. Choice A is incorrect. Although the text states that Alan Tennyson is a paleontologist who studied the fossils of two previously unknown penguin species, it doesn't say whether these penguins are frequently studied by paleontologists. Choice C is incorrect because the text says that one of the two previously unknown penguin species was three times larger than the emperor penguin (a penguin alive today), not that they were both smaller than penguin species that exist today. Choice D is incorrect because the text doesn't discuss whether the two previously unknown penguin species spent any time in water.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 701126bc

SOURCE_FILE: Central Ideas and Details(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 21

SKILL: Central Ideas and Details

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

In superfluorescence, electrical charges known as dipoles emit light in synchronized bursts so intense that they are visible to the eye. Until recently, this phenomenon has only been observed at extremely cold temperatures because dipoles cannot synchronize at higher temperatures. But in a study, Melike Biliroglu and colleagues observed superfluorescence at room temperature in thin films made of perovskite and other similarly crystalline materials; the researchers propose that the formation of shock-absorbing quasiparticles called polarons in the material protects dipoles from thermal interference. Based on the text, how are polarons believed to be involved in the superfluorescence observed in Biliroglu and colleagues' study?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. Polarons enable superfluorescent bursts to cross from one crystalline material to another.
 - B. Polarons allow for the dipoles to synchronize despite higher temperatures.
 - C. Polarons accelerate the dipoles' release of superfluorescent bursts.
 - D. Polarons decrease the intensity of the superfluorescent burst.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice B is the best answer because it most accurately describes Biliroglu and colleagues' claim about how the polarons function in relation to superfluorescence. The text indicates that "until recently, " superfluorescence (intense, synchronized bursts of light emitted by dipoles) has solely been observed at very cold temperatures. However, it also states that, recently, Biliroglu and colleagues report observing the phenomenon at room temperature. They achieved this using "thin films made of perovskite and other similarly crystalline materials, " which the researchers claim allows for the formation of polarons. They also suggest that these polarons might absorb the thermal shocks that typically disrupt dipole synchronization at warmer temperatures. Thus, based on the text, Biliroglu and colleagues believe that polarons help dipoles synchronize at temperatures well above those at which superfluorescence had previously been observed. Choice A is incorrect because the text doesn't address the prospect of a superfluorescent burst moving between crystalline materials or any other mediums. Choice C is incorrect because the text's discussion of polarons is about how they might enable superfluorescence at higher temperatures than those at which it had previously been observed. Rather than suggesting that polarons speed up superfluorescent bursts, the text suggests that no superfluorescence can occur at room temperature in the absence of polarons. Thus, the text indicates that polarons make superfluorescent bursts more likely to occur at higher temperatures than those at which it had previously been observed, not that polarons accelerate the bursts. Choice D is incorrect because the text's discussion of polarons is about how they might enable superfluorescence at higher temperatures than those at which it had previously been observed. In the absence of polarons, the text suggests there would be no superfluorescence at room temperature. Thus, rather than decrease the intensity of superfluorescent bursts, polarons make them more likely to occur under certain circumstances.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 8a8236e1

SOURCE_FILE: Central Ideas and Details(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 22

SKILL: Central Ideas and Details

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

Scent is tightly interwoven with our daily lives, often evoking significant memories and important social events. This connection is of growing interest to archaeologists who hope to use it to better understand ancient rituals, trade, social hierarchies, and medicine. Although the speed at which odor molecules dissipate makes identifying ancient scents challenging, advancements in biomolecular technologies show promise in unlocking ancient aromas from preserved artifacts. Archaeological studies making use of these advancements may provide new insights into past societies.

According to the text, what is one reason some archaeologists are interested in recovering scents from ancient artifacts?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. They are investigating whether people's sense of smell has declined in recent centuries.
 - B. They believe the scents could illuminate important aspects of ancient life.
 - C. They think that ancient scents would be enjoyable to people today.
 - D. They hope to develop new medicines using ancient scent molecules.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice B is the best answer. The text states that archaeologists are interested in using scents to better understand "ancient rituals, trade, social hierarchies, and medicine, " all of which are important aspects of ancient life.

Choice A is incorrect. The text doesn't say anything about investigating if people's sense of smell has declined in recent centuries. It says that scents fade over time-not that people have gotten worse at smelling scents. Choice C is incorrect. The text says that archaeologists are interested in using scents to better understand "ancient rituals, trade, social hierarchies, and medicine, " but it doesn't say anything about ancient scents being enjoyable to people today. Choice D is incorrect. The text doesn't say anything about developing new medicines. Rather, it says that archaeologists are interested in using scents to better understand "ancient rituals, trade, social hierarchies, and medicine.

"

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: b38935ab

SOURCE_FILE: Central Ideas and Details(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 23

SKILL: Central Ideas and Details

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

Historians point to the rule of the Piast dynasty as crucial to the formation of the Polish state. However, some differentiate between members of the dynasty like Mieszko II Lambert, who ruled as king from 1025 to 1031 CE, and less well-documented figures like Siemomys, who is said to have ruled in the 10th century but whose historical actuality is disputed. Siemomys appears in the *Gesta principum Polonorum*, a chronicle of medieval Polish history written between 1112 and 1118. However, the chronicle's documentation of Siemomys relies on oral tradition, unlike its records of later rulers.

According to the text, what is a difference between how historians view Siemomys and how they view Mieszko II Lambert?

ANSWER CHOICES:

- r
- A. Historians agree that Mieszko II Lambert existed, but disagree about whether Siemomys existed.
 - B. Historians believe that the *Gesta principum Polonorum* provides more evidence for Siemomys's existence than it does for Mieszko II Lambert's existence.
 - C. Historians agree that Siemomys ruled Poland much later than Mieszko II Lambert.
 - D. Historians find the orally transmitted stories affirming the existence of Mieszko II Lambert to be more convincing than similar stories about Siemomys.

CORRECT ANSWER:**RATIONALE:**

e

Choice A is the best answer because it presents a statement about how historians view Siemomys and Mieszko II Lambert that is supported by the text. The text states that the Piast dynasty had a number of different members. The text refers to two of the rulers in the Piast dynasty by name: Mieszko II Lambert, whose rule was known to have occurred from 1025 to 1031 CE, and Siemomys ("whose historical actuality is disputed"), for whom less is known and who therefore is the subject of debate among historians. The text further casts doubt about Siemomys by stating that he is "said to have ruled" during the 10th century, or the 900s, which suggests the possibility that he didn't rule. The text also mentions that the chronicle's documentation of Siemomys relies on oral tradition, unlike its records of later rulers, including Mieszko II Lambert. This indicates that historians agree that Mieszko II Lambert was an actual historical figure, but they disagree about whether Siemomys existed.

Choice B is incorrect because the text states that the *Gesta principum Polonorum*'s documentation of Siemomys comes from oral tradition—spoken rather than written documentation—unlike its records of rulers who came after Siemomys. This suggests that the chronicle provides less reliable evidence rather than more evidence for Siemomys's existence in the 900s (or the 10th century) than it does for later rulers like Mieszko II Lambert, who ruled from 1025 to 1031 CE. Choice C is incorrect because the text indicates the opposite: Siemomys supposedly ruled earlier in the 10th century, while Mieszko II Lambert ruled from 1025 to 1031 CE. The 10th century spans the years from 901 to 1000 CE, so Siemomys is believed to have ruled earlier than Mieszko II Lambert did, not later as this choice states. Choice D is incorrect. Although the text mentions that information in the written chronicle *Gesta principum Polonorum* draws its information about Siemomys from the oral tradition, it doesn't mention orally transmitted stories about Mieszko II Lambert. Instead, it states that the chronicle's documentation of Siemomys relies on oral tradition unlike the records of later rulers do, which suggests that the documentation of later rulers such as Mieszko II Lambert did not rely on oral

tradition. Thus, no comparison can be made about how convincing the orally transmitted stories of each ruler are to historians.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: c6d7dc78

SOURCE_FILE: Central Ideas and Details(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 24

SKILL: Central Ideas and Details

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

Stores often play background music to create a pleasant shopping experience. Based on a survey, Amir Manzoor found that such music was linked to reduced enjoyment among customers. Manzoor thinks that one explanation for this result is that the surveyed customers may have wanted to finish their shopping as quickly as possible. They therefore weren't focused on enjoying the experience. It's possible that background music could improve the experience of other customers whose main goal is to have a good time while they shop.

Based on the text, which research question was Manzoor's study most likely intended to answer?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

r

- A. Does the volume of a store's background music affect how much time customers spend in the store?
- B. How does the use of background music in stores affect customers' shopping experience?
- C. Do customers spend more money when shopping for music in stores or online?
- D. What genres of music do customers prefer to listen to while they are shopping?

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice B is the best answer because it presents a research question that is clearly addressed by Manzoor's study as described in the text. The text indicates that Manzoor surveyed customers and found that background music was linked to reduced enjoyment while shopping. Manzoor then explains this result in terms of the music interfering with customers' main goal (finishing their shopping as quickly as possible), speculating that background music might improve the experience of customers with different shopping goals. Throughout the text, the focus is on the relationship between background music and customers' shopping experience, suggesting that Manzoor's study was designed to answer how background music affects that experience. Choice A is incorrect because the text doesn't mention the volume of background music or how much time customers spend in a store. Instead, the text focuses on whether background music is linked to customer enjoyment of the shopping experience. Choice C is incorrect because the text doesn't address how much money customers spend or compare in-store and online purchasing. Rather, the text discusses background music played during shopping, not music as a product to be purchased. Choice D is incorrect because the text doesn't discuss different genres of music or customers' preferences for particular genres. Instead, the text addresses background music in general and its link to customer enjoyment.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: c228bd45

SOURCE_FILE: Central Ideas and Details(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 25

SKILL: Central Ideas and Details

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

The following text is adapted from Edith Nesbit's 1906 novel *The Railway Children*.
Mother did not spend all her time in paying dull [visits] to dull ladies, and sitting dully at home waiting for dull ladies to pay [visits] to her. She was almost always there, ready to play with the children, and read to them, and help them to do their home-lessons. Besides this she used to write stories for them while they were at school, and read them aloud after tea, and she always made up funny pieces of poetry for their birthday and for other great occasions.
According to the text, what is true about Mother?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. She wishes that more ladies would visit her.
 - B. Birthday are her favorite special occasion.
 - C. She creates stories and poems for her children.
 - D. Reading to her children is her favorite activity.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice C is the best answer because it describes something that is true of Mother, as presented in the text. The text indicates that in addition to other activities, Mother writes stories for her children while they are at school and makes up "funny pieces of poetry" for certain occasions.
Choice A is incorrect because the text suggests that Mother prefers to spend her time with her children and doesn't sit at home hoping that ladies will visit her. Choice B is incorrect because the text says only that Mother makes up poetry for the children's birthday, not that she likes birthday more than other special occasions. Choice D is incorrect because the text doesn't suggest that Mother prefers reading to her children over the other activities she does with them, such as playing with them and writing stories and poems for them.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 640b60c2

SOURCE_FILE: Central Ideas and Details(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 26

SKILL: Central Ideas and Details

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

Archaeologists have observed similarities in the tools, such as bidirectional blades, uncovered at the Neolithic-period Mesopotamian settlement of Çayönü Tepesi and those uncovered at roughly contemporaneous settlements elsewhere in Southwest Asia, including those in the South Levant, Central Anatolia, and Central Zagros. Although similarities in tools could be attributed to imitative behavior or trade, Nefize Ezgi Altınkaya et al. found evidence of genetic affinity among the populations of Çayönü Tepesi, Central Anatolia, the South Levant, and—to a lesser extent—Central Zagros.

Information in the text best supports which statement about the finding made by Altınkaya et al.?

ANSWER CHOICES:

- A. It implies that people and tools likely arrived in Çayönü Tepesi from settlements in Central Anatolia and the South Levant at an earlier time than they did from settlements in Central Zagros.
- B. It raises the possibility that similarities in the design of tools found at Neolithic settlements in Southwest Asia emerged due to population blending between those settlements.
- C. It suggests that in the Neolithic period, people in the South Levant and Central Anatolia imitated tool designs originating in Çayönü Tepesi more frequently than people in Central Zagros did.
- D. It helps explain why contemporaneous Neolithic peoples in Southwest Asia had similar tools but lacked other obvious cultural similarities.

CORRECT ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

Choice B is the best answer because it presents a statement about Altınkaya et al.'s finding that is supported by the text. The text notes that tool similarities across Neolithic settlements could be attributed to imitative behavior or trade. However, Altınkaya et al. found evidence of genetic affinity (that is, genetic relatedness) among the populations of these settlements. Genetic relatedness among populations with similar tools raises an alternative possibility: the tool similarities may have emerged through population blending rather than through imitation or trade alone. Thus, the finding raises the possibility that tool design similarities resulted from population blending. Choice A is incorrect because the text doesn't address the timing or direction of migration between settlements. Although lesser genetic affinity with Central Zagros could reflect various historical patterns, the text presents genetic relatedness as evidence of population intermixing, not as evidence about when people or tools arrived at particular locations. Choice C is incorrect because the text doesn't indicate that tools originated specifically at Çayönü Tepesi or that other settlements imitated its designs. Although the text notes that genetic affinity with Central Zagros was found "to a lesser extent," this describes degrees of genetic relatedness, not the frequency of tool imitation. Instead, the text presents tool similarities as a shared phenomenon across settlements. Choice D is incorrect because the text doesn't discuss a lack of cultural similarities among Neolithic peoples in Southwest Asia. Rather, the text focuses solely on tool similarities and genetic affinity without addressing other cultural parallels or differences.

END QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 9731a22b

SOURCE_FILE: Central Ideas and Details(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 27

SKILL: Central Ideas and Details

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

Paleontologist Lucas E. Fiorelli and colleagues have reported the discovery at a mine in Brazil of several egg clutches, partially preserved single eggs, and egg shells from the Late Cretaceous period. The researchers have concluded that the area was once a nesting and breeding site for titanosaurs, a group of sauropod dinosaurs. The finding is significant given the previous lack of known nesting sites in northern regions of South America, which led many paleontologists to assume that titanosaurs migrated south to lay eggs. What does the text most strongly suggest about the site discovered by the researchers?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. It is the earliest known example of a titanosaur nesting and breeding site.
 - B. It was very difficult to excavate given that it was discovered in a mine.
 - C. It may have been occupied by other sauropods in addition to titanosaurs.
 - D. It is farther north than any other nesting site discovered in South America.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice D is the best answer because it presents a statement about the site discovered by the researchers that is supported by the text. The text discusses Fiorelli and colleagues' discovery of egg clutches, single eggs, and eggshells in a Brazilian mine. According to the text, the presence of these eggs, which are from the Late Cretaceous period, led the researchers to conclude that the location was once a nesting and breeding site for titanosaurs. The text then explains that the finding is important because of the "previous lack of known nesting sites in northern regions of South America."

"If there haven't been any other discoveries of a nesting site in South America's northern regions and the site in the Brazilian mine is the first, then the text strongly suggests that the site is farther north than other nesting sites that have been discovered in South America."

Choice A is incorrect because the text doesn't suggest that the site discovered by Fiorelli and colleagues is the earliest titanosaur nesting and breeding site known to paleontologists but rather that it's the first nesting site found in northern regions of South America. Moreover, the text doesn't suggest how the timeline of the newly discovered site compares with that of other titanosaur nesting and breeding sites. Choice B is incorrect because there is no mention in the text about any difficulties that Fiorelli and colleagues faced when they were excavating the nesting and breeding site in the Brazilian mine. Choice C is incorrect because the text doesn't support the idea that the nesting and breeding site in the Brazilian mine was occupied by sauropods other than titanosaurs. The text simply mentions that titanosaurs are sauropod dinosaurs and presents the researchers' conclusion that the site they discovered was for titanosaurs.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 2b252bbd

SOURCE_FILE: Central Ideas and Details(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 28

SKILL: Central Ideas and Details

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

Within higher education, studying philosophy requires that students be conversant with the field's foundational texts and historical figures. By contrast, doing philosophy within or beyond the academy demands the creative, self-directed application of acquired expertise to enduring questions about the nature of existence and knowledge. While both approaches engage with influential figures, those who do philosophy treat such figures as vital interlocutors who facilitate new insights rather than as ossified authorities who, though relevant to the present, primarily represent the discipline's past. Based on the text, which choice best describes the relationship between doing philosophy and studying philosophy?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. Doing philosophy helps students formulate concrete solutions to practical issues, whereas studying philosophy prioritizes engagement with historical arguments in the field.
 - B. Doing philosophy involves developing novel ideas through imagined dialogue with past philosophers based on knowledge of those philosophers' views acquired by studying philosophy.
 - C. Doing philosophy requires students to challenge the ideas articulated by past philosophers, especially when these ideas are broadly accepted by other people studying philosophy.
 - D. Doing philosophy represents a departure from the norms that govern scholarly inquiry, whereas studying philosophy requires conforming to these norms.

CORRECT_ANSWER:**RATIONALE:**

e

Choice B is the best answer because it most accurately describes the relationship between doing philosophy and studying philosophy as presented in the text. According to the text, studying philosophy requires being familiar with foundational texts and historical figures, while doing philosophy demands "the creative, self-directed application of acquired expertise"-a phrase implying that doing philosophy builds on knowledge gained through study. The text adds that those who do philosophy treat influential figures as "vital interlocutors who facilitate new insights" (that is, as dialogue partners whose ideas help generate new thinking). In other words, doing philosophy involves developing novel ideas through engagement with the ideas of past philosophers, knowledge of which can be acquired only by studying philosophy. Choice A is incorrect. While the text does state that studying philosophy requires engagement with historical texts and figures, the text describes doing philosophy as addressing "enduring questions about the nature of existence and knowledge, " which are abstract philosophical questions, not practical issues. Rather than formulating concrete solutions, doing philosophy involves the creative application of expertise to these broad, enduring questions. Choice C is incorrect because the text doesn't characterize doing philosophy as requiring students to challenge past philosophers' ideas. Instead, the text suggests that those who do philosophy engage creatively with historical figures, which can, but doesn't necessarily entail, opposition. Additionally, the text doesn't claim that the ideas of past philosophers are broadly accepted by those studying philosophy. Choice D is incorrect because the text doesn't discuss norms of scholarly inquiry or characterize either approach in terms of conforming to or departing from such norms. Rather, the text notes that doing philosophy can occur "within or beyond the academy, " which

suggests compatibility with scholarly settings rather than an inevitable departure from them.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 5325b3cc

SOURCE_FILE: Central Ideas and Details(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 29

SKILL: Central Ideas and Details

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

Philadelphia's Black Pearl Chamber Orchestra, founded by Jeri Lynne Johnson, performs classical music, from well-known compositions by Beethoven to contemporary works by Jessie Montgomery. For the orchestra's iConduct! program, Johnson invites community members to learn some basic elements of conducting and then experience conducting the Black Pearl orchestra themselves. Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

r

- A. The Black Pearl orchestra performs music from all over the world but mostly performs music composed by Philadelphians.
- B. Johnson founded the Black Pearl orchestra to perform classical music by contemporary artist Jessie Montgomery.
- C. The Black Pearl orchestra gives community members the chance to both listen to and participate in classical music performance.
- D. Johnson has community members conduct an orchestra to demonstrate how difficult the task is.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice C is the best answer because it most accurately states the main idea of the text. The text begins by stating that the Black Pearl orchestra performs classical music, and then goes on to explain that the orchestra offers an iConduct! program. According to the text, this program offers community members the opportunity to learn some basics about conducting and then apply what they learn by conducting the orchestra themselves. Thus, the main idea of the text is that community members can both listen to and participate in a classical music performance. Choice A is incorrect. Although the text states that the Black Pearl orchestra is based in Philadelphia, it doesn't indicate that most of the music it plays was composed by Philadelphians. Choice B is incorrect. Although the text does state that Johnson founded the Black Pearl orchestra, this is just a detail and not the main focus of the text. Moreover, while the text does say that the orchestra sometimes plays music by Montgomery, it doesn't assert that the orchestra was founded solely for the purpose of performing Montgomery's work. Choice D is incorrect. Although the text explains that community members are invited to conduct the Black Pearl orchestra after participating in the iConduct! program, the text doesn't indicate that Johnson allows community members to do this for the specific purpose of showing how difficult the task is.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 70aacc03

SOURCE_FILE: Central Ideas and Details(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 30

SKILL: Central Ideas and Details

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

Elizabeth Asiedu has identified a negative correlation between the share of developing countries' economies derived from natural-resource extraction and those countries' receipts of foreign investment. This may appear counterintuitive-resource extraction requires initial investments (in extractive technology, for instance) at scales best met by multinational corporations-but Asiedu notes that natural-resource industries' boom-bust cycle can destabilize local currencies and increase developing countries' vulnerability to external shocks, creating levels of uncertainty to which foreign investors are typically averse. Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. Although it may seem surprising that foreign investment declines in developing countries as natural-resource extraction makes up a larger share of those countries' economies, that decline happens because resource extraction requires initial investments too large for foreign investors to supply.
 - B. Although developing countries tend to become less dependent on foreign investment as natural-resource industries make up a larger share of their economies, this change may not occur if the boom-bust cycle of those industries destabilizes local currencies or increases countries' vulnerability to external shocks.
 - C. Although one might expect that foreign investment would increase as natural-resource extraction makes up a larger share of developing countries' economies, the opposite happens because heavy reliance on natural resources can lead to unattractive conditions for investors.
 - D. Although foreign investors tend to avoid initial investments in natural-resource industries in developing countries, foreign investment may increase significantly as those industries stabilize and the risks associated with them decline.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice C is the best answer because it accurately states the main idea of the text. According to the text, contrary to what some might expect, foreign investment is typically lower in developing countries whose economies are more dependent on natural-resource extraction. The text explains that high reliance on natural-resource extraction can subject a developing country to economic shocks that can destabilize the local currency and introduce economic uncertainty that tends to keep investors away. In other words, although we may think otherwise, foreign investors are less willing to invest in projects in developing countries whose economies are heavily dependent on natural-resource extraction because those economies tend to exhibit instability that investors want to avoid.

Choice A is incorrect. The text does indicate that foreign investment is typically lower in developing countries whose economies are more dependent on natural-resource extraction; the text further indicates that natural-resource extraction requires substantial initial investments (to acquire things like required technologies) for which there are fewer investors willing to participate at this stage than one might think. But the text does not implicate the cost of these initial investments as a reason why foreign investment is less widely available than some might think.

Choice B is incorrect. The text indicates that greater dependence on natural-resource extraction makes a developing country less appealing to foreign investors because of associated economic instability. Rather than arguing that the goal of developing countries is to become less dependent on foreign investment, as the phrasing of choice B suggests, the text focuses only on why foreign

investors become less involved with such countries, which suggests that more investment would be preferable. Choice D is incorrect. Although the text indicates that natural-resource extraction requires substantial initial investments (to acquire things like required technologies) and that there are fewer likely investors willing to participate at this stage than one might think, the text does not address what investors are likely to do over time as the industry stabilizes itself.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 04cbeca3

SOURCE_FILE: Command of Evidence(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 1

SKILL: Command of Evidence

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

In 1534 CE, King Henry VIII of England split with the Catholic Church and declared himself head of the Church of England, in part because Pope Clement VII refused to annul his marriage to Catherine of Aragon. Two years later, Henry VIII introduced a policy titled the Dissolution of the Monasteries that by 1540 had resulted in the closure of all Catholic monasteries in England and the confiscation of their estates. Some historians assert that the enactment of the policy was primarily motivated by perceived financial opportunities. Which quotation from a scholarly article best supports the assertion of the historians mentioned in the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- "
- A. "At the time of the Dissolution of the Monasteries, about 2 percent of the adult male population of England were monks; by 1690, the proportion of the adult male population who were monks was less than 1 percent."
- B. "A contemporary description of the Dissolution of the Monasteries, Michael Sherbrook's *Falle of the Religious Howses*, recounts witness testimony that monks were allowed to keep the contents of their cells and that the monastery timber was purchased by local yeomen."
- C. "In 1535, the year before enacting the Dissolution of the Monasteries, Henry commissioned a survey of the value of church holdings in England-the work, performed by sheriffs, bishops, and magistrates, began that January and was swiftly completed by the summer."
- D. "The October 1536 revolt known as the Pilgrimage of Grace had several economic motives: high food prices due to a poor harvest the prior year; the Dissolution of the Monasteries, which closed reliable sources of food and shelter for many; and rents and taxes throughout Northern England that were not merely high but predatory."

CORRECT_ANSWER:**RATIONALE:**

e

Choice C is the best answer. The fact that Henry VIII commissioned a survey of church holdings just before enacting the Dissolution of the Monasteries suggests that he was interested in the potential profits from claiming their assets. This supports the historians' assertion. Choice A is incorrect. This choice describes a potential effect of the Dissolution of the Monasteries. The decrease in the proportion of monks in England isn't relevant to the question of Henry VIII's motivations. Choice B is incorrect. Details about how the monks were treated during the dissolution don't address Henry VIII's motivations for enacting the policy in the first place. That the monks could keep the content of their cells (their rooms) and sell off the timber they'd harvested has no impact on the value of the monasteries' estates-their land holdings. Choice D is incorrect. This choice mentions one impact that the Dissolution of the Monasteries contributed to, two years after it happened. But it doesn't help explain why Henry VIII might have wanted to enact the policy in the first place.

END_QUESTION

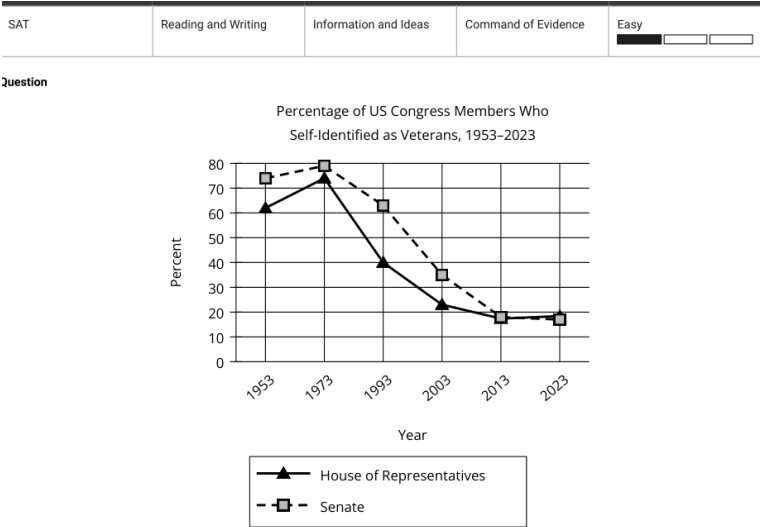
QUESTION:

80
70
60
50
40
30
20
10
0
Percent
1953
1973
1993
2003
2013
2023

Percentage of US Congress Members Who
Self-Identified as Veterans, 1953-2023
Year
House of Representatives
Senate

Since the nation's earliest days, both houses of the United States Congress have counted many military veterans among their elected officials, including Hiram L. Fong (who served in the US Army Air Force) and Ralph Harold Metcalfe Sr. (who served in the US Army). A research institute gathered historical data about congressional members who have reported past military experience and determined that _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the graph to complete the sentence?



Since the nation's earliest days, both houses of the United States Congress have counted many military veterans among their elected officials, including Hiram L. Fong (who served in the US Army Air Force) and Ralph Harold Metcalfe Sr. (who served in the US Army). A research institute gathered historical data about congressional members who have reported past military experience and determined that _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the graph to complete the sentence?

- Answer
- A. from 2003 to 2023, the House of Representatives had a higher percentage of those members than the Senate did.
- B. from 1953 to 2003, those members constituted a majority in both houses of Congress.
- C. the percentage of those members decreased substantially in both houses of Congress from 1973 to 2013.
- D. the percentage of those members remained fairly consistent, regardless of house, from 1993 to 2023.

ANSWER_CHOICES:

r

- A. from 2003 to 2023, the House of Representatives had a higher percentage of those members than the Senate did.
- B. from 1953 to 2003, those members constituted a majority in both houses of Congress.
- C. the percentage of those members decreased substantially in both houses of Congress from 1973 to 2013.
- D. the percentage of those members remained fairly consistent, regardless of house, from 1993 to 2023.

CORRECT_ANSWER:**RATIONALE:**

e

Choice C is the best answer because it accurately uses data from the graph to complete the statement regarding the research institute's findings

about veteran representation in Congress. The graph shows that the percentage of veterans in both houses of Congress decreased dramatically

from 1973 to 2013. In 1973, the House of Representatives consisted of approximately 74% veterans, and the Senate was made up of

approximately 79% veterans. By 2013, veteran members of both houses had fallen to approximately 17%-18%. This represents a substantial

decrease of more than 50% in each house over this 40-year period.

Choice A is incorrect because from 2003 to 2023, the House of Representatives did not consistently have a higher percentage of veterans than

the Senate did. According to the graph, in 2003 the Senate was made up of approximately 35% veterans, while the House consisted of

approximately 23% veterans. In 2013, the number of veterans in the Senate was still slightly higher (approximately 18%) than in the House

(approximately 17%). Only in 2023 did the House have a marginally higher percentage than the Senate. Choice B is incorrect because veterans

did not constitute a majority in both houses throughout the entire period shown in the graph from 1953 to 2003.

According to the graph, both

houses had a majority of veterans in 1953 (approximately 62% in the House and approximately 74% in the Senate) and in 1973 (approximately

74% in the House and approximately 79% in the Senate), but by 1993 the House had fallen below 50% to approximately 40% veterans. By 2003,

both houses were well below 50%. Choice D is incorrect because the percentage of veterans in Congress did not remain consistent from 1993 to

2023. The graph shows significant changes in the number of members reporting past military service during this period, particularly the

continued decline from 1993 to 2003. In 1993, the House had approximately 40% veterans and the Senate had approximately 63% veterans, but

by 2003 these percentages had dropped to approximately 23% and 35%, respectively. Furthermore, there was a large gap between the two

houses in 1993 that narrowed considerably by 2013, which contradicts the claim that the percentage of veterans across both houses "remained

fairly consistent" during this period.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: d5b9ed0d

SOURCE_FILE: Command of Evidence(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 4

SKILL: Command of Evidence

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

7
6
5
4
3
2
1
0

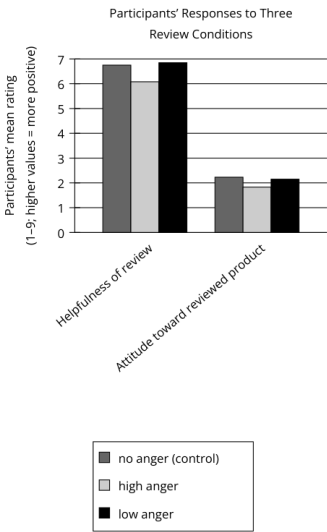
Participants' mean rating
(1-9; higher values = more positive)
Helpfulness of review
Attitude toward reviewed product
Participants' Responses to Three
Review Conditions
no anger (control)
high anger
low anger

To understand how expressions of anger in reviews of products affect readers of those reviews, business scholar Dezhi Yin and colleagues measured study participants' responses to three versions of the same negative review—a control review expressing no anger, a review expressing a high degree of anger, and a review expressing a low degree of anger. Reviewing the data, a student concludes that the mere presence of anger in a review may not negatively affect readers' perceptions of the review, but a high degree of anger in a review does worsen readers' perceptions of the review.

Which choice best describes data from the graph that support the students' conclusion?

SAT	Reading and Writing	Information and Ideas	Command of Evidence	Hard
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Question



To understand how expressions of anger in reviews of products affect readers of those reviews, business scholar Dezhi Yin and colleagues measured study participants' responses to three versions of the same negative review—a control review expressing no anger, a review expressing a high degree of anger, and a review expressing a low degree of anger. Reviewing the data, a student concludes that the mere presence of anger in a review may not negatively affect readers' perceptions of the review, but a high degree of anger in a review does worsen readers' perceptions of the review.

Which choice best describes data from the graph that support the students' conclusion?

Answer

A. On average, participants' ratings of the helpfulness of the review were substantially higher than were participants' ratings of the reviewed product regardless of which type of review participants had seen.

ANSWER_CHOICES:

r

A. On average, participants' ratings of the helpfulness of the review were substantially higher than were participants' ratings of the reviewed product regardless of which type of review participants had seen.

B. Compared with participants who saw the control review, participants who saw the low-anger review rated the review as slightly more helpful, whereas participants who saw the high-anger review rated the review as less helpful.

C. Participants who saw the low-anger review rated the review as slightly more helpful than participants who saw the control review did, but participants' attitude toward the reviewed product was slightly worse when participants saw the low-anger review than when they saw the no-anger review.

D. Compared with participants who saw the low-anger review, participants who saw the high-anger review rated the review as less helpful and had a less positive attitude toward the reviewed product.

CORRECT_ANSWER:**RATIONALE:**

e

Choice B is the best answer. The claim is that low anger does not negatively affect readers' perceptions of the review, while high anger does negatively affect readers' perceptions of the review. This choice accurately expresses the supporting data from the "helpfulness of review" part of the graph: that low-anger reviews were rated as slightly more helpful than no-anger reviews, while high-anger reviews were rated as less helpful than no-anger reviews.

Choice A is incorrect. This choice does not support the conclusion. The conclusion is only about how participants feel about the review itself-the participants' ratings of the reviewed product are not relevant. Choice C is incorrect. This choice does not support the conclusion. The conclusion is only about how participants feel about the review itself-the participants' attitude towards the reviewed product is not relevant.

Choice D is incorrect. This choice does not support the conclusion. The conclusion is only about how participants feel about the review itself-the participants' attitude towards the reviewed product is not relevant.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 6a6bbac3

SOURCE_FILE: Command of Evidence(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 6

SKILL: Command of Evidence

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

Number and Origin of Clamshell Tools Found at Different Levels Below the Surface in Neanderthal Cave
Depth of tools found below surface in cave
(meters)

Clamshells that Neanderthals collected from
the beach

Clamshells that Neanderthals harvested from
the seafloor

3-4

99

33

6-7

1

0

4-5

2

0

2-3

7

0

5-6

18

7

Studying tools unearthed at a cave site on the western coast of Italy, archaeologist Paola Villa and colleagues have determined that prehistoric

Neanderthal groups fashioned them from shells of clams that they harvested from the seafloor while wading or diving or that washed up on the

beach. Clamshells become thin and eroded as they wash up on the beach, while those on the seafloor are smooth and sturdy, so the research

team suspects that Neanderthals prized the tools made with seafloor shells. However, the team also concluded that those tools were likely more

challenging to obtain, noting that _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to support the research team's conclusion?

SAT	Reading and Writing	Information and Ideas	Command of Evidence	Hard
-----	---------------------	-----------------------	---------------------	------

Question

Number and Origin of Clamshell Tools Found at Different Levels Below the Surface in Neanderthal Cave

Depth of tools found below surface in cave (meters)	Clamshells that Neanderthals collected from the beach	Clamshells that Neanderthals harvested from the seafloor
3–4	99	33
6–7	1	0
4–5	2	0
2–3	7	0
5–6	18	7

Studying tools unearthed at a cave site on the western coast of Italy, archaeologist Paola Villa and colleagues have determined that prehistoric Neanderthal groups fashioned them from shells of clams that they harvested from the seafloor while wading or diving or that washed up on the beach. Clamshells become thin and eroded as they wash up on the beach, while those on the seafloor are smooth and sturdy, so the research team suspects that Neanderthals prized the tools made with seafloor shells. However, the team also concluded that those tools were likely more challenging to obtain, noting that _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to support the research team's conclusion?

Answer

- A. at each depth below the surface in the cave, the difference in the numbers of tools of each type suggests that shells were easier to collect from the beach than to harvest from the seafloor.
- B. the highest number of tools were at a depth of 3–4 meters below the surface, which suggests that the Neanderthal population at the site was highest during the related period of time.
- C. at each depth below the surface in the cave, the difference in the numbers of tools of each type suggests that Neanderthals preferred to use clamshells from the beach because of their durability.
- D. the higher number of tools at depths of 5–6 meters below the surface in the cave than at depths of 4–5 meters below the surface suggests that the size of clam populations changed over time.

ANSWER CHOICES :

- A. at each depth below the surface in the cave, the difference in the numbers of tools of each type suggests that shells were easier to collect from the beach than to harvest from the seafloor.
- B. the highest number of tools were at a depth of 3-4 meters below the surface, which suggests that the Neanderthal population at the site was highest during the related period of time.
- C. at each depth below the surface in the cave, the difference in the numbers of tools of each type suggests that Neanderthals preferred to use clamshells from the beach because of their durability.
- D. the higher number of tools at depths of 5-6 meters below the surface in the cave than at depths of 4-5 meters below the surface suggests that the size of clam populations changed over time.

CORRECT ANSWER :

RATIONALE :

Choice A is the best answer because it most effectively uses data from the table to support the researchers' conclusion about the harvesting of clamshells by Neanderthals for use as tools. The text explains that Neanderthals used clamshells to make tools and that the sturdiest, and therefore the most desirable, shells for this purpose are found on the seafloor, not on the beach. However, the researchers also concluded that the clamshell tools made from shells from the seafloor are rarer than those made from shells from the beach. Meanwhile the table shows that at each depth, the number of tools made from shells from the beach exceeds the number made from the more desirable shells from the seafloor. The fact that the more desirable shells are less common suggests that it was significantly more difficult to harvest shells from the seafloor than from the beach.

Choice B is incorrect because knowing which depth represents the period of time with the highest Neanderthal population does not help answer the question of why the Neanderthals consistently made more tools from the less desirable shells from the beach than they made from the more desirable shells from the seafloor. Choice C is incorrect because it claims that the beach shells are more durable than the seafloor shells, which

contradicts the text's description of shells from the seafloor as smoother and sturdier than shells from the beach. Choice D is incorrect because knowing which depth has the most artifacts or whether the clam population fluctuated does not help explain why tools made from the less desirable shells from the beach outnumber tools made from the more desirable shells from the seafloor.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 6f626ae5

SOURCE_FILE: Command of Evidence(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 8

SKILL: Command of Evidence

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

"To You" is an 1856 poem by Walt Whitman. In the poem, Whitman suggests that readers, whom he addresses directly, have not fully understood themselves, writing, _____

Which quotation from "To You" most effectively illustrates the claim?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

r

A. "You have not known what you are, you have slumber'd upon yourself / all your life, / Your eyelids have been the same as closed most of the time.

"

B. "These immense meadows, these interminable rivers, you are immense / and interminable as they.

"

C. "I should have made my way straight to you long ago, / I should have blabb'd nothing but you, I should have chanted nothing / but you.

"

D. "I will leave all and come and make the hymns of you, / None has understood you, but I understand you.

"

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice A is the best answer because it presents the quotation that most directly illustrates the claim that Whitman's poem suggests that its readers haven't fully understood themselves. This quotation makes that point directly by saying to readers, "You have not known what you are.

"

The quotation goes on to reinforce this point using a metaphor of sleep, saying that readers have "slumber'd" and that their "eyelids have been the same as closed most of the time.

"

Choice B is incorrect because this quotation doesn't suggest that readers haven't fully understood themselves but instead characterizes readers as "immense" and "interminable.

" Although immense and interminable things can be difficult to understand, this quotation doesn't make that point. Choice C is incorrect because this quotation doesn't suggest that readers haven't fully understood themselves but instead conveys the

speaker's regret over not having celebrated readers sooner. In fact, this quotation says nothing at all about readers themselves-it's focused

solely on the speaker's feelings about readers. Choice D is incorrect because this quotation doesn't suggest that readers haven't fully understood

themselves; instead, this quotation makes the point that the speaker has understood readers and is determined to create "hymns" about them.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: ccb1ab92

SOURCE_FILE: Command of Evidence(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 9

SKILL: Command of Evidence

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

180
160
140
120
100
80
60
40
20
0

REM sleep as % of baseline
(mean difference from
baseline was not statistically
significant)

Day 1
Day 2

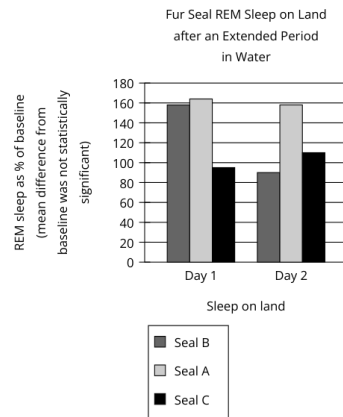
Fur Seal REM Sleep on Land
after an Extended Period
in Water
Sleep on land
Seal B
Seal A
Seal C

Research suggests that REM sleep in animals is homeostatically regulated: animals compensate for periods of REM sleep deprivation by increasing subsequent REM sleep. When on land, fur seals get enough REM sleep, but during the weeks they're in the water, they get almost none. In a study of fur seals' sleep habits, researchers recorded the REM sleep (as a percentage of baseline) of fur seals once they had returned to land. They concluded that REM sleep may not be homeostatically regulated in fur seals, citing as evidence the fact that the seals in the study

Which choice most effectively uses data from the graph to complete the text?

SAT	Reading and Writing	Information and Ideas	Command of Evidence	Hard
-----	---------------------	-----------------------	---------------------	------

Question



Research suggests that REM sleep in animals is homeostatically regulated: animals compensate for periods of REM sleep deprivation by increasing subsequent REM sleep. When on land, fur seals get enough REM sleep, but during the weeks they're in the water, they get almost none. In a study of fur seals' sleep habits, researchers recorded the REM sleep (as a percentage of baseline) of fur seals once they had returned to land. They concluded that REM sleep may not be homeostatically regulated in fur seals, citing as evidence the fact that the seals in the study

Which choice most effectively uses data from the graph to complete the text?

Answer

1. didn't show significantly less REM sleep during the second day after returning to land than they did during the first day.
3. showed no significant differences from one another in baseline levels of REM sleep.
2. didn't consistently demonstrate a significant increase in REM sleep after their period of deprivation in the water.
2. showed no significant difference between REM sleep after returning to land and REM sleep while in the water.

ANSWER CHOICES:

- A. didn't show significantly less REM sleep during the second day after returning to land than they did during the first day.
- B. showed no significant differences from one another in baseline levels of REM sleep.
- C. didn't consistently demonstrate a significant increase in REM sleep after their period of deprivation in the water.
- D. showed no significant difference between REM sleep after returning to land and REM sleep while in the water.

CORRECT ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

Choice C is the best answer. If REM sleep were homeostatically regulated in fur seals, then all the seals would compensate with REM levels significantly over baseline after going weeks without REM. We'd also expect the seals to maintain those elevated REM levels for some time. Since seals B and C return very quickly to baseline REM levels, this suggests that REM sleep in fur seals may not be regulated homeostatically. Choice A is incorrect. This doesn't support the conclusion. If REM sleep were homeostatically regulated in fur seals, then we'd suspect the seals to sustain REM levels well above baseline for a prolonged period in order to compensate for weeks of REM deprivation while in the water. Whether or not there's a reduction in REM sleep from day 1 to day 2 doesn't tell us how REM sleep on those days relates to baseline, which is where our focus should be. Choice B is incorrect. The y-axis of this graph doesn't depict baseline levels of REM sleep, but rather shows REM sleep as a percent of baseline. Choice D is incorrect. The graph doesn't depict REM sleep while in the water for the seals in the study. Additionally, we're told fur seals get no REM sleep while in the water, which is significantly different to the values shown in the graph for after they return to land.

END QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: be19faa1

SOURCE_FILE: Command of Evidence(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 11

SKILL: Command of Evidence

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

90
80
70
60
50
40
30
20
10
0

Percentage of all sites analyzed

0%

Up to 25%

More than 25%

Home Heating Needs Met with Subsurface

Thermal Pollution for Two Temperature

Conditions, by Percentage of Sites

Local heating needs met

Current surface temperature

Maximum plausible surface

temperature

Urbanization, industrialization, and the warming climate create thermal pollution (excess heat) in the shallow subsurface soil. Susanne A. Benz

and colleagues analyzed thousands of sites on three continents under one scenario in which surface temperature remains at the current level

and under another in which the surface reaches the maximum plausible temperature. They then categorized each site according to the

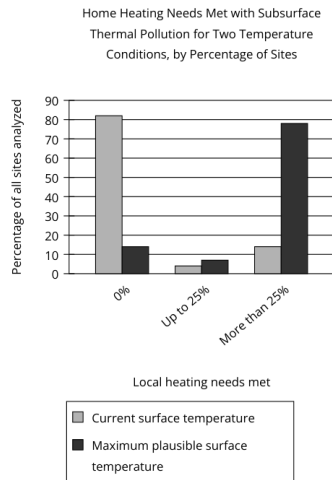
percentage of local home heating needs that could be met using this excess subsurface heat. The team concluded that if surface temperature

approaches the maximum plausible level, the percentage of sites where thermal pollution could feasibly contribute to meeting home heating needs will increase.

Which choice best describes data in the graph that support Benz and colleagues' conclusion?

SAT	Reading and Writing	Information and Ideas	Command of Evidence	Hard
-----	---------------------	-----------------------	---------------------	------

Question



Urbanization, industrialization, and the warming climate create thermal pollution (excess heat) in the shallow subsurface soil. Susanne A. Benz and colleagues analyzed thousands of sites on three continents under one scenario in which surface temperature remains at the current level and under another in which the surface reaches the maximum plausible temperature. They then categorized each site according to the percentage of local home heating needs that could be met using this excess subsurface heat. The team concluded that if surface temperature approaches the maximum plausible level, the percentage of sites where thermal pollution could feasibly contribute to meeting home heating needs will increase.

Which choice best describes data in the graph that support Benz and colleagues' conclusion?

Answer

A. Under both temperature conditions, less than 10% of sites were in the up-to-25% group, but at the maximum plausible surface temperature, almost 80% of sites could have all their local heating needs met by thermal pollution.

ANSWER CHOICES:

- A. Under both temperature conditions, less than 10% of sites were in the up-to-25% group, but at the maximum plausible surface temperature, almost 80% of sites could have all their local heating needs met by thermal pollution.
- B. At current surface temperatures, more than 80% of the sites have no need for supplemental local home heating from subsurface thermal pollution, but at the maximum plausible surface temperature, more than 70% of sites exhibit significantly greater home heating needs.
- C. At current surface temperatures, more than 80% of sites can meet, at most, 25% of local home heating needs with subsurface thermal pollution, but at the maximum plausible surface temperature, more than 80% of sites can meet greater than 25% of local home heating needs.
- D. At current surface temperatures, more than 80% of the sites cannot use subsurface thermal pollution to meet any portion of local home heating needs, but at the maximum plausible surface temperature, that percentage drops below 20%.

CORRECT ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

Choice D is the best answer. The researchers concluded that as we approach maximum plausible surface temperatures, there will be a larger percentage of sites where thermal pollution could contribute to meeting home heating needs. By showing that only a small percentage of homes can currently use thermal pollution for home heating, and that this percentage would grow much larger at maximum plausible surface temperatures, this choice supports the researchers' conclusion. Choice A is incorrect. We do not know how many sites could have all (i.e., 100%) of their local heating needs met by thermal pollution, as the graph only classifies sites by whether "0%", "Up to 25%", and "More than 25%" of heating needs could be met. Choice B is incorrect. The graph is not depicting need for supplemental heating from thermal pollution, but rather potential to use thermal pollution for supplemental heating. Choice C is incorrect. The graph indicates that, at current surface temperatures, less than 10% of sites can meet 25% of local home heating needs and that more than 80% of sites cannot meet any local home heating needs.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 645fd11a

SOURCE_FILE: Command of Evidence(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 13

SKILL: Command of Evidence

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

7
6
5
4
3
2
1
0

Average number of individuals
directly reporting to CEO
1991-1995
1996-2001
2001-2008

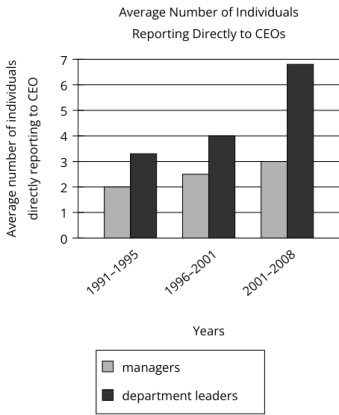
Average Number of Individuals
Reporting Directly to CEOs
Years
managers
department leaders

Considering a large sample of companies, economics experts Maria Guadalupe, Julie Wulf, and Raghuram Rajan assessed the number of managers and leaders from different departments who reported directly to a chief executive officer (CEO). According to the researchers, the findings suggest that across the years analyzed, there was a growing interest among CEOs in connecting with more departments in their companies.

Which choice best describes data from the graph that support the researchers' conclusion?

SAT	Reading and Writing	Information and Ideas	Command of Evidence	Hard
-----	---------------------	-----------------------	---------------------	------

Question



Considering a large sample of companies, economics experts Maria Guadalupe, Julie Wulf, and Raghuram Rajan assessed the number of managers and leaders from different departments who reported directly to a chief executive officer (CEO). According to the researchers, the findings suggest that across the years analyzed, there was a growing interest among CEOs in connecting with more departments in their companies.

Which choice best describes data from the graph that support the researchers' conclusion?

Answer

1. The average numbers of managers and department leaders reporting directly to their CEO didn't fluctuate from the 1991-1995 period to the 2001-2008 period.
2. The average number of managers reporting directly to their CEO was highest in the 1996-2001 period.
3. The average number of department leaders reporting directly to their CEO was greater than the average number of managers reporting directly to their CEO in each of the three periods studied.
4. The average number of department leaders reporting directly to their CEO rose over the three periods studied.

ANSWER_CHOICES:

r

- A. The average numbers of managers and department leaders reporting directly to their CEO didn't fluctuate from the 1991-1995 period to the 2001-2008 period.
- B. The average number of managers reporting directly to their CEO was highest in the 1996-2001 period.
- C. The average number of department leaders reporting directly to their CEO was greater than the average number of managers reporting directly to their CEO in each of the three periods studied.
- D. The average number of department leaders reporting directly to their CEO rose over the three periods studied.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice D is the best answer because it describes data from the graph that support the researchers' conclusion that there is a growing interest among CEOs in connecting with more departments in their companies. The graph shows the average number of individuals reporting directly to CEOs during three different time periods: the individuals are divided into managers and department leaders. The average number of department leaders directly reporting to their CEO during the 1991-1995 period was slightly more than three, during the 1996-2001 period it was four, and during the 2001-2008 period it was almost seven. Thus, the average number of department leaders reporting directly to their CEO rose over the three periods studied, which suggests that CEOs were connecting with more departments.

Choice A is incorrect because the average number of managers and department leaders reporting directly to their CEO rose for both categories between the 1991-1995 and 2001-2008 periods; thus, it isn't true that the average numbers didn't fluctuate. Choice B is incorrect because the average number of managers reporting directly to their CEO was highest in the 2001-2008 period, not in the 1996-2001 period. Choice C is incorrect. Although it correctly describes a feature of the graph, the observation that more department leaders than managers are reporting to CEOs does not by itself address the question of whether CEOs are connecting with more departments over time-to address that question, one needs to know whether the number of department leaders reporting to CEOs is increasing over time.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 85439572

SOURCE_FILE: Command of Evidence(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 15

SKILL: Command of Evidence

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

Roasted green chiles are a popular ingredient in Southwestern cuisine, but the traditional roasting method of burning propane is not environmentally friendly. To see if solar power could provide a better alternative, engineer Kenneth Armijo and his team roasted batches of green chiles using between 38 and 42 heliostats, which are devices that concentrate sunlight. The team was successful in reaching the same roasting temperature used in traditional propane roasting, but they found that propane yielded faster results. While the fastest solar-roasted green chiles took six minutes, batches using propane took only four. Armijo hypothesizes that they can reduce the roasting time for solar-roasted green chiles by using more heliostats.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Armijo's hypothesis?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

r

- A. The temperature inside the roasting drum is distributed more evenly when roasting green chiles with solar power than with propane.
- B. Attempts to roast green chiles using 50 heliostats yields results in fewer than six minutes.
- C. Green chile connoisseurs prefer the flavor of solar-roasted green chiles over the flavor of propane-roasted green chiles.
- D. The skins of solar-roasted green chiles are easier to peel than the skins of propane-roasted green chiles.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice B is the best answer. Armijo believes that using more heliostats will speed up the roasting process, and this finding shows that with 50 heliostats-more than the number of heliostats already used-the roasting time is indeed reduced. Choice A is incorrect. The evenness of temperature in the roasting drum doesn't tell us about the speed of the roasting process, which is what Armijo's hypothesis is concerned with. Choice C is incorrect. Armijo's hypothesis is focused on the speed of the roasting process, not the flavor of the resulting roasted chiles. Choice D is incorrect. Though Armijo's hypothesis mentions a benefit of solar-roasting green chiles (easier peeling), it doesn't address the speed of the roasting process.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 356ad646

SOURCE_FILE: Command of Evidence(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 16

SKILL: Command of Evidence

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

Baltimore, Maryland, has installed engineered structures along 71% of its shoreline to protect infrastructure from wave erosion and other hazards, a practice known as shoreline hardening. To evaluate the responses of waterbirds to two types of hardening structures-riprap and bulkheads-Diann Prosser et al. surveyed waterbird communities consisting of the tundra swan, the great blue heron, and 62 other species at different sites in the Chesapeake Bay on the US East Coast. Utilizing the Index of Waterbird Community Integrity (IWCi), on which a high score corresponds to high community integrity, the researchers found that bulkheads are more strongly negatively correlated with waterbird community integrity than is riprap. Which finding, if true, would most directly illustrate the researchers' finding?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

r

- A. The difference in average IWCi scores for waterbird communities at Stony and Old Road, two sites with a higher percentage of shoreline consisting of bulkheads than of riprap, was statistically insignificant.
- B. Waterbird communities at Old Road, a site with a relatively high percentage of shoreline consisting of bulkheads, had lower average IWCi scores than did waterbird communities at Miles, a site with a relatively high percentage of shoreline consisting of riprap.
- C. Waterbird communities at Cur tis, a site with a high percentage of shoreline consisting of bulkheads and riprap, had lower average IWCi scores than did waterbird communities at Onancock, a site with a low percentage of shoreline consisting of bulkheads and riprap.
- D. Waterbird communities at Cur tis, a site with equal percentages of shoreline consisting of bulkheads and riprap, had higher average IWCi scores than did waterbird communities at Miles, a site with different percentages of shoreline consisting of bulkheads and riprap.

CORRECT_ANSWER:**RATIONALE:**

e

Choice B is the best answer because it presents a finding that, if true, would most directly illustrate the researchers' finding about waterbird responses to shoreline hardening structures. The text explains that using the IWCi, an index on which higher scores indicate higher community integrity, researchers found that bulkheads are more strongly negatively correlated with waterbird community integrity than riprap is-that is, that bulkheads reduce the integrity of waterbird communities more than riprap does. The finding that waterbird communities at a site with a relatively high percentage of bulkheads along the shoreline (Old Road) had lower average IWCi scores than waterbird communities at a site with a relatively high percentage of riprap along the shoreline (Miles) did would illustrate the researchers' finding, since it would be an example of lower waterbird community integrity in a location with substantial bulkhead presence than in a location with substantial riprap presence.

Choice A is incorrect because a finding of similar waterbird community integrity in two sites predominated by bulkheads wouldn't reveal anything about waterbird community integrity at sites predominated by riprap or how waterbird community integrity compares between the two types of sites. Thus, the finding wouldn't illustrate the discovery of a difference in how bulkheads and riprap correlate with waterbird community integrity.

Choice C is incorrect because it presents a finding that compares waterbird community integrity at sites with different overall amounts of shoreline hardening but without distinguishing between bulkheads and riprap. Such a distinction would be necessary to illustrate the researchers'

finding of a difference in how bulkheads and riprap each correlate with waterbird community integrity. Choice D is incorrect because it presents a finding that addresses a difference in waterbird community integrity between one site with equal percentages of bulkheads and riprap along its shoreline (Cur tis) and one site with unequal percentages of bulkheads and riprap (Miles) but without indicating whether bulkheads or riprap were more prevalent at Miles. This finding wouldn't provide any clear information about how bulkheads and riprap each correlate with waterbird community integrity, so it wouldn't illustrate the researchers' finding of a difference between those correlations.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: c83e0b43

SOURCE_FILE: Command of Evidence(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 17

SKILL: Command of Evidence

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

O Pioneers! is a 1913 novel by Willa Cather. In the novel, Cather depicts Alexandra Bergson as a person who takes comfort in understanding the world around her: _____

Which quotation from O Pioneers! most effectively illustrates the claim?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

r

A. "She looked fixedly up the bleak street as if she were gathering her strength to face something, as if she were trying with all her might to grasp a situation which, no matter how painful, must be met and dealt with somehow.

"

B. "She had never known before how much the country meant to her. The chirping of the insects down in the long grass had been like the sweetest music. She had felt as if her heart were hiding down there, somewhere, with the quail and the plover and all the little wild things that crooned or buzzed in the sun. Under the long shaggy ridges, she felt the future stirring.

"

C. "Alexandra drove off alone. The rattle of her wagon was lost in the howling of the wind, but her lantern, held firmly between her feet, made a moving point of light along the highway, going deeper and deeper into the dark country.

"

D. "Alexandra drew her shawl closer about her and stood leaning against the frame of the mill, looking at the stars which glittered so keenly through the frosty autumn air. She always loved to watch them, to think of their vastness and distance, and of their ordered march. It fortified her to reflect upon the great operations of nature, and when she thought of the law that lay behind them, she felt a sense of personal security.

"

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice D is the best answer because it most effectively uses a quotation from O Pioneers! to illustrate the claim that Alexandra Bergson takes comfort in understanding the world around her. In the quotation, Alexandra is described as enjoying looking at the stars and feeling a "sense of personal security" when she contemplates nature's order and its governing laws. This suggests that Alexandra takes comfort in understanding the world around her.

Choice A is incorrect because the quotation expresses how Alexandra Bergson attempts to meet difficult situations with determination, not how she takes comfort in understanding the world around her. Choice B is incorrect because the quotation expresses "how much the country meant to" Alexandra Bergson, not how she takes comfort in understanding the world around her. In detailing some of the wildlife surrounding Alexandra, the quotation conveys that nature is important to her but not necessarily that it gives her comfort. Choice C is incorrect because the quotation describes Alexandra driving her wagon down a highway at night; it doesn't describe how she takes comfort in understanding the world around her or address how she's feeling as she drives off.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 6177abc5

SOURCE_FILE: Command of Evidence(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 18

SKILL: Command of Evidence

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

Video Game Availability by Initial Release Years

Initial release years	Percentage of games still available
1975-1979	0.89
1980-1984	3.65
1985-1989	15.38
1990-1994	19.33
1995-1999	14.22

In a recent study, researchers found that relatively few video games released over the decades remain available today. For example, only 14.22 percent of games are still available that were initially released in _____. Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the statement?

SAT	Reading and Writing	Information and Ideas	Command of Evidence	Easy

Question

Video Game Availability by Initial Release Years	
Initial release years	Percentage of games still available
1975–1979	0.89
1980–1984	3.65
1985–1989	15.38
1990–1994	19.33
1995–1999	14.22

n a recent study, researchers found that relatively few video games released over the decades remain available today. For example, only 14.22 percent of games are still available that were initially released in _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the statement?

- Answer
- A. 2000–2004.

3. 1995–1999.

2. 1970–1974.

D. 1985–1989.

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. 2000–2004.

B. 1995–1999.

C. 1970–1974.

D. 1985–1989.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice B is the best answer because it most effectively uses data from the table to complete the statement about video game availability. The text states that just a few games released in the past are available today and then indicates that there is a period of years from which only 14.22 percent of the games released are available. The table shows that 14.22 percent of games are still available from the years 1995-1999.

Choice A is incorrect because the years 2000-2004 are not represented in the table. Choice C is incorrect because the years 1970-1974 are not represented in the table. Choice D is incorrect because the years 1985-1989 correspond to a percentage of games still available of 15.38 percent, not 14.22 percent.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: a9040290

SOURCE_FILE: Command of Evidence(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 19

SKILL: Command of Evidence

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

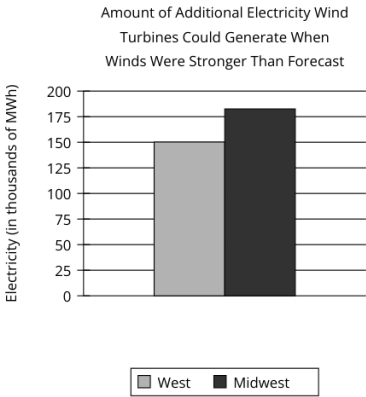
200
175
150
125
100
75
50
25
0
Electricity (in thousands of MWh)

Amount of Additional Electricity Wind
Turbines Could Generate When
Winds Were Stronger Than Forecast
West
Midwest

Electric companies that use wind turbines rely on weather forecasts to predict the maximum amount of power, in megawatt-hours (MWh), they can generate using wind so that they can determine how much they'll need to generate from other sources. When winds are stronger than they were forecast to be, however, the predicted maximum amount of electricity wind turbines could generate will be too low. For example, the graph shows that for the West region, the winds were _____ Which choice most effectively uses data from the graph to complete the example?

SAT	Reading and Writing	Information and Ideas	Command of Evidence	Medium
-----	---------------------	-----------------------	---------------------	--------

Question



Electric companies that use wind turbines rely on weather forecasts to predict the maximum amount of power, in megawatt-hours (MWh), they can generate using wind so that they can determine how much they'll need to generate from other sources. When winds are stronger than they were forecast to be, however, the predicted maximum amount of electricity wind turbines could generate will be too low. For example, the graph shows that for the West region, the winds were _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the graph to complete the example?

Answer

1. strong enough to generate about 150 thousand more MWh of electricity from wind turbines.
2. so weak that the electricity from wind turbines was about 175 thousand MWh less than predicted.
3. so weak that the electricity from wind turbines was about 150 thousand MWh less than predicted.
4. strong enough to generate about 175 thousand more MWh of electricity from wind turbines.

ANSWER_CHOICES:

r

- A. strong enough to generate about 150 thousand more MWh of electricity from wind turbines.
- B. so weak that the electricity from wind turbines was about 175 thousand MWh less than predicted.
- C. so weak that the electricity from wind turbines was about 150 thousand MWh less than predicted.
- D. strong enough to generate about 175 thousand more MWh of electricity from wind turbines.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice A is the best answer. The claim is that when winds are stronger than forecasted, wind turbines can generate more energy than predicted.

The supporting graph shows the additional amount (above the predicted amount) that the turbines generated under those conditions, with the West generating about 150 thousand additional MWh.

Choice B is incorrect. This choice doesn't complete the example. The graph shows the additional amount of electricity that the wind turbines generated. The West bar is greater than 0, so the West generated more than the predicted amount. Choice C is incorrect. This choice doesn't complete the example. The graph shows the additional amount of electricity that the wind turbines generated. The West bar is greater than 0, so the West generated more than the predicted amount. Choice D is incorrect. This choice misreads the graph. The graph shows us that the West (the bar on the left) generated about 150 thousand additional MWh.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: bc1b8a42

SOURCE_FILE: Command of Evidence(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 21

SKILL: Command of Evidence

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

Percentage of Bus Shelters with Shade in a County by Areas' Highest Average Summer Surface Temperature

Highest average surface temperature (Fahrenheit)

Percentage of bus stops with shaded shelter

90.2°

15%

97.7°

22%

102.7°

24%

111.2°

28%

125.6°

29%

A student is researching a bus system in a large county where surface temperatures vary by area and are hot in the summer. The student claims that all areas of the county should have more bus stops with shaded shelter, noting that the highest percentage of bus stops with shaded shelter for any area is only _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the student's claim?

SAT	Reading and Writing	Information and Ideas	Command of Evidence	Easy

Question

Percentage of Bus Shelters with Shade in a County by Areas' Highest Average Summer Surface Temperature

Highest average surface temperature (Fahrenheit)	Percentage of bus stops with shaded shelter
90.2°	15%
97.7°	22%
102.7°	24%
111.2°	28%
125.6°	29%

A student is researching a bus system in a large county where surface temperatures vary by area and are hot in the summer. The student claims that all areas of the county should have more bus stops with shaded shelter, noting that the highest percentage of bus stops with shaded shelter for any area is only _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the student's claim?

Answer

- A. 50%.
- B. 15%.
- C. 90%.
- D. 29%.

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. 50%.
 - B. 15%.
 - C. 90%.
 - D. 29%.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e
Choice D is the best answer because it effectively uses data from the table to complete the student's claim about the highest percentage of bus stops with shaded shelter in the areas represented. The table shows the highest average surface temperature of five areas and the percentage of bus stops with shaded shelter in each area, and 29% is the highest percentage listed. Choice A is incorrect because the list of percentages of bus stops with shaded shelter does not include 50%; the highest percentage in the table is 29%. Choice B is incorrect because 15% is the lowest value in the listed percentages of bus stops with shaded shelter, not the highest value. Choice C is incorrect because the list of percentages of bus stops with shaded shelter does not include 90%; the highest percentage in the table is 29%.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: a13541c0

SOURCE_FILE: Command of Evidence(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 22

SKILL: Command of Evidence

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

Sandra Cisneros's 1984 novella *The House on Mango Street* made a lasting impact on US literature. Its depiction of Mexican American culture inspired later authors to examine their own heritage within their fictional works. Also influential was the book's portrayal of the main character, Esperanza, during a pivotal year of her youth. This insightful depiction of a preteen girl encouraged authors who, like Cisneros herself, are Latina to use fictional works to examine experiences from their own youth. Which statement, if true, would most strongly support the claim in the underlined sentence?

ANSWER CHOICES:

- r
- A. In interviews, a number of Latina authors say that *The House on Mango Street* inspired them to write about their own adolescence in their novels.
 - B. In published writings, several prominent authors who are not Latina say that reading *The House on Mango Street* influenced their approach to writing fiction.
 - C. *The House on Mango Street* has sold over six million copies and is one of the most commonly read books among high school and university students in the US.
 - D. Since 1984, new novels about young Latina characters by Latina authors have often been compared to *The House on Mango Street*.

CORRECT ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice A is the best answer because it presents a finding that, if true, would most strongly support the claim in the underlined sentence. The text begins by explaining that the portrayal of Mexican American culture in Sandra Cisneros's *The House on Mango Street* inspired later authors to explore their own heritage. Noting that Cisneros's novella was also influential for its depiction of a formative year in a female character's youth, the text then claims that this depiction inspired other Latina authors to use fiction to explore their own experiences of youth. Since this claim addresses how Cisneros encouraged Latina authors specifically to portray their youthful experiences, it would be directly supported by such authors stating that her novella influenced them to write about their own adolescence, or the transitional period between childhood and adulthood.

Choice B is incorrect. The text states that with its portrayal of Mexican American culture, *The House on Mango Street* inspired later authors to explore their own heritage, and since this statement isn't limited to only Latina authors, it can be inferred that authors who aren't Latina were also likely influenced by the novella. But because the claim in the underlined sentence concerns the novella's influence on Latina authors specifically, the finding that the book also influenced authors who weren't Latina would fail to provide support for the claim.

Choice C is incorrect because the finding that *The House on Mango Street* has sold millions of copies and is widely read among students in the US doesn't relate directly to the text's claim that the novella has influenced Latina authors specifically. Choice D is incorrect. While comparisons of new novels about young Latina characters by Latina authors to Cisneros's *The House on Mango Street* would likely be founded on similarities between those novels and Cisneros's novella, such similarities wouldn't necessarily be evidence of the novella's influence; such similarities might arise if Cisneros and younger Latina authors alike depicted certain basic cultural and historical features of their communities. Testimony from younger Latina authors about how *The House on Mango Street* had inspired them would be far more persuasive evidence of the novella's

influence.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: dd1757fd

SOURCE_FILE: Command of Evidence(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 23

SKILL: Command of Evidence

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

Neural networks are computer models intended to reflect the organization of human brains and are often used in studies of brain function. According to an analysis of 11,000 such networks, Rylan Schaeffer and colleagues advise caution when drawing conclusions about brains from observations of neural networks. They found that when attempting to mimic grid cells (brain cells used in navigation), while 90% of the networks could accomplish navigation-related tasks, only about 10% of those exhibited any behaviors similar to those of grid cells. But even this approximation of grid-cell activity has less to do with similarity between the neural networks and biological brains than it does with the rules programmed into the networks. Which finding, if true, would most directly support the claim in the underlined sentence?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. The rules that allow for networks to exhibit behaviors like those of grid cells have no equivalent in the function of biological brains.
 - B. The networks that do not exhibit behaviors like those of grid cells were nonetheless programmed with rules that had proven useful in earlier neural-network studies.
 - C. Neural networks can often accomplish tasks that biological brains do, but they are typically programmed with rules to model multiple types of brain cells simultaneously.
 - D. Once a neural network is programmed, it is trained on certain tasks to see if it can independently arrive at processes that are similar to those performed by biological brains.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice A is the best answer. While many networks can perform navigation tasks, or even mimic grid cells, it doesn't mean they're actually behaving like biological brains-this finding suggests that the rules that govern neural network behavior are completely unlike the way real brains work.

Choice B is incorrect. Although it mentions the rules that are programmed into the networks, this finding wouldn't clarify whether or not these rules have anything to do with the function of biological brains. Choice C is incorrect. This choice suggests that neural networks are modeled after multiple types of brain cells, which sidesteps the question of whether these rule-based networks are genuinely similar to biological brains.

Choice D is incorrect. This choice doesn't address the key point of the claim, which is that the apparent similarity between neural networks and biological brains is only due to the rules programmed into the networks. It focuses on training tasks, not the originally programmed rules.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 15873d14

SOURCE_FILE: Command of Evidence(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 24

SKILL: Command of Evidence

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

90
80
70
60
50
40
30
20
10
0

Percent

2009/2010

2010/2011

2011/2012

2012/2013

2013/2014

Percentage of Maize Exported
by Three Countries for Marketing
Years 2009/2010-2013/2014

Marketing year

Argentina

Brazil

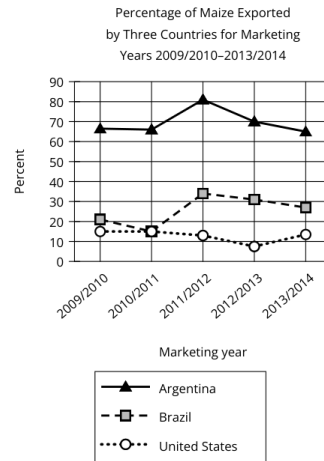
United States

Argentina, Brazil, and the United States are among the world's leading producers of maize (corn), and each country exports a certain percentage of maize each marketing year, which runs from March to February in Argentina and Brazil and from September to August in the United States. A student is researching those percentages and finds that for the marketing year 2012/2013, the percentage of maize exported by _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the graph to complete the text?

SAT	Reading and Writing	Information and Ideas	Command of Evidence	Medium
-----	---------------------	-----------------------	---------------------	--------

Question



Argentina, Brazil, and the United States are among the world's leading producers of maize (corn), and each country exports a certain percentage of maize each marketing year, which runs from March to February in Argentina and Brazil and from September to August in the United States. A student is researching those percentages and finds that for the marketing year 2012/2013, the percentage of maize exported by _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the graph to complete the text?

Answer

- Brazil increased from the previous marketing year but remained lower than the percentage exported by the United States.
- Brazil exceeded the percentage exported by Argentina for the first time.
- Argentina decreased from the previous marketing year but remained the highest among the three countries.
- the United States reached its highest point during the five marketing years.

ANSWER CHOICES:

- A. Brazil increased from the previous marketing year but remained lower than the percentage exported by the United States.
- B. Brazil exceeded the percentage exported by Argentina for the first time.
- C. Argentina decreased from the previous marketing year but remained the highest among the three countries.
- D. the United States reached its highest point during the five marketing years.

CORRECT ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

Choice C is the best answer because it most effectively uses data from the graph to complete the text's discussion of the percentages of maize exported in the marketing year 2012/2013. The graph presents percentages of maize exported by Argentina, Brazil, and the United States in marketing years 2009/2010 to 2013/2014 and indicates that for the marketing year 2012/2013, the percentage of maize exported by Argentina decreased to about 70 percent from about 80 percent in the previous marketing year. The graph also shows that the percentage of maize exported by Argentina remained highest among the three countries in the marketing year 2012/2013, surpassing the percentage exported by Brazil (about 31 percent) and by the United States (about 8 percent). Choice A is incorrect because for the marketing year 2012/2013, the graph indicates that the percentage of maize exported by Brazil didn't increase from the previous year; rather, it decreased from about 34 percent to about 31 percent. Moreover, the graph shows that the percentage of maize exported by Brazil remained higher, not lower, than the percentage exported by the United States in the marketing year 2012/2013. Choice B is incorrect because the graph indicates that the percentage of maize exported by Brazil never exceeded the percentage exported by Argentina for any of the marketing years represented. Choice D is incorrect because the graph indicates that the percentage of maize exported by the United States reached its lowest point, not its highest, during the five marketing years in 2012/2013, with the United States exporting only about 8 percent of its maize in that marketing year.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 8a584241

SOURCE_FILE: Command of Evidence(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 26

SKILL: Command of Evidence

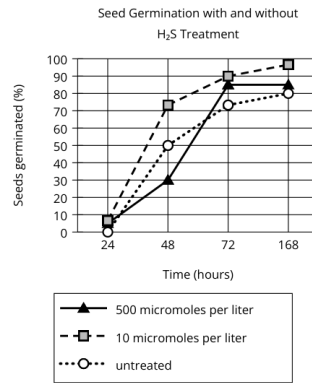
DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

100
90
80
70
60
50
40
30
20
10
0
Seeds germinated (%)
24
48
72
168
Seed Germination with and without
H₂S Treatment
Time (hours)
500 micromoles per liter
10 micromoles per liter
untreated
In high concentrations, hydrogen sulfide (H₂S) is typically toxic to many plants. Frederick D. Dooley and colleagues wanted to understand what effects low doses of H₂S might have on plant growth. They treated bean, corn, wheat, and pea seeds with various concentrations (measured in micromoles per liter) of H₂S and tracked the germination of those seeds along with the germination of untreated seeds. Treatment with particular concentrations of H₂S was associated with accelerated germination: for example, _____
Which choice most effectively uses data from the graph to complete the statement?

SAT	Reading and Writing	Information and Ideas	Command of Evidence	Medium
-----	---------------------	-----------------------	---------------------	--------

Question



In high concentrations, hydrogen sulfide (H₂S) is typically toxic to many plants. Frederick D. Dooley and colleagues wanted to understand what effects low doses of H₂S might have on plant growth. They treated bean, corn, wheat, and pea seeds with various concentrations (measured in micromoles per liter) of H₂S and tracked the germination of those seeds along with the germination of untreated seeds. Treatment with particular concentrations of H₂S was associated with accelerated germination; for example, _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the graph to complete the statement?

Answer

1. at 24 hours, less than 10% of seeds treated with H₂S at a concentration of 10 micromoles per liter had germinated, whereas more than 90% of those seeds had germinated at 168 hours.
2. at 48 hours, more than 70% of seeds treated with H₂S at a concentration of 10 micromoles per liter had germinated, whereas only approximately 50% of untreated seeds had germinated.
3. at 168 hours, more than 90% of seeds treated with H₂S at concentrations of 10 or 500 micromoles per liter had germinated, whereas less than 70% of untreated seeds had germinated.
4. at 48 hours, approximately 50% of seeds treated with H₂S at a concentration of 10 micromoles per liter had germinated, whereas only approximately 30% of untreated seeds had germinated.

ANSWER CHOICES:

- r
- A. at 24 hours, less than 10% of seeds treated with H₂S at a concentration of 10 micromoles per liter had germinated, whereas more than 90% of those seeds had germinated at 168 hours.
- B. at 48 hours, more than 70% of seeds treated with H₂S at a concentration of 10 micromoles per liter had germinated, whereas only approximately 50% of untreated seeds had germinated.
- C. at 168 hours, more than 90% of seeds treated with H₂S at concentrations of 10 or 500 micromoles per liter had germinated, whereas less than 70% of untreated seeds had germinated.
- D. at 48 hours, approximately 50% of seeds treated with H₂S at a concentration of 10 micromoles per liter had germinated, whereas only approximately 30% of untreated seeds had germinated.

CORRECT ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice B is the best answer. The claim is that some concentrations of H₂S led to increased germination rates, and this choice accurately shows that seeds treated with 10 micromoles per liter of H₂S tended to germinate faster than untreated seeds. Choice A is incorrect. This choice doesn't justify the claim. The claim compares the germination rates of seeds exposed to certain concentrations of H₂S to untreated seeds, but this choice only discusses one concentration of H₂S, so it can't support any comparison between treated and untreated groups. Choice C is incorrect. This choice misreads the graph. At 168 hours, only about 85% of seeds treated with H₂S at 500 micromoles per liter and well over 70% of untreated seeds had germinated (about 80%). Choice D is incorrect. This choice misreads the graph. At 48 hours, about 70% of seeds treated with H₂S at 10 micromoles per liter and about 50% of untreated seeds had germinated.

END QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: dd72993d

SOURCE_FILE: Command of Evidence(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 28

SKILL: Command of Evidence

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

Rivers rich in sediment appear yellow, while increases in red algae make rivers appear red. To track things like the sediment or algae content of large US rivers, John R. Gardner and colleagues used satellite data to determine the dominant visible wavelengths of light measured for various segments of these rivers. The researchers classified wavelengths of 495 nanometers (nm) and below as red, wavelengths between 495 and 560 nm as blue, and wavelengths of 560 nm and above as yellow. The researchers concluded that for the Missouri River, segments flowing into lakes tend to carry more sediment than those flowing out of lakes. Which finding, if true, would most directly support the researchers' conclusion?

ANSWER CHOICES:

- r
- A. The segments of the Missouri River that had higher levels of chlorophyll-a, which contributes to the green color of photosynthetic organisms, have dominant wavelengths of light between 490 and 560 nm.
 - B. In lakes through which segments of the Missouri River pass, the dominant wavelength of light tended to be above 560 nm near the lakes' shores and below 560 nm in the lakes' centers.
 - C. The majority of the segments of the Missouri River were found to have dominant wavelengths of light significantly higher than 560 nm.
 - D. Segments of the Missouri River flowing into lakes typically had dominant wavelengths of light above 560 nm, while segments flowing out of lakes typically had dominant wavelengths below 560 nm.

CORRECT ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice D is the best answer because it presents a finding that, if true, would support Gardner and colleagues' conclusion that segments of the Missouri River flowing into lakes tend to carry more sediment than do segments of the river flowing out of lakes. The text says that rivers appear yellow when they contain a lot of sediment and appear red when they contain a lot of algae. It goes on to explain that Gardner and colleagues measured the wavelengths of light for different segments of rivers in the United States and classified those wavelength measurements into colors: red for wavelengths of 495 nanometers and below, blue for wavelengths between 495 and 560 nanometers, and yellow for wavelengths of 560 nanometers and above. Combined with the earlier information about river colors, this suggests that rivers rich in sediment will have wavelengths of 560 nanometers and above (since such rivers appear yellow). If researchers found that Missouri River segments flowing into lakes tend to have wavelengths above 560 nanometers and segments flowing out of lakes tend to have wavelengths below 560 nanometers, this finding would support Gardner and colleagues' conclusion, since it would suggest that the river tends to carry more sediment when it flows into lakes than when it flows out of lakes.

Choice A is incorrect because finding that sections of the Missouri River with high chlorophyll-a levels have wavelengths between 490 and 560 nanometers would be irrelevant to the researchers' conclusion that segments of the river flowing into lakes are richer in sediment than are segments of the river flowing out of lakes. This finding would not indicate anything about segments flowing into or out of lakes. Choice B is incorrect because finding that lakes through which the Missouri River passes have higher wavelengths near their shores than in the center would not support the researchers' conclusion that segments of the river flowing into lakes have more sediment than segments flowing out of lakes. This finding would suggest only that there is more sediment around the edges of lakes than in their centers, which

does not have any direct bearing on the researchers' conclusion about river segments flowing into and out of lakes. Choice C is incorrect because finding that most segments of the Missouri River have wavelengths significantly higher than 560 nanometers would suggest that most segments of the river are high in sediment, not that segments flowing into lakes are higher in sediment than segments flowing out of lakes. Only a comparison of river segments flowing into lakes with segments flowing out of lakes can support the researchers' conclusion.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 6df33868

SOURCE_FILE: Command of Evidence(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 29

SKILL: Command of Evidence

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

"We Are Marching" is a 1921 poem by Carrie Law Morgan Figgs. In the poem, the speaker predicts future success: _____

Which quotation from "We Are Marching" most effectively illustrates the claim?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. "Can't you hear the sound of feet?"
 - B. "You who are out just get in line."
 - C. "We have answered duty's call."
 - D. "We shall never know defeat."

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice D is the best answer because it most effectively illustrates the claim that the speaker in the poem "We Are Marching" predicts future success. To say that someone will "never know" an experience-like defeat, or being unsuccessful-is to indicate that they will never personally have that experience. Thus, when the speaker says that the marching group "shall never know defeat," the speaker is predicting that the group will experience only success in the future.

Choice A is incorrect because the quotation presents a question about an activity already taking place (marching), not a statement about future success. The speaker is asking if the sound of marching feet is being heard. Choice B is incorrect because the quotation directs an immediate action instead of making a prediction about the future. The speaker is telling people to "get in line," or to join the march that's already happening.

Choice C is incorrect because the quotation describes a past action instead of making a prediction about the future. The speaker is stating that those in the march have "answered duty's call"-that is, that they have acted out of a sense of duty.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 3a489e1e

SOURCE_FILE: Command of Evidence(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 30

SKILL: Command of Evidence

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

Born in Chile in 1917, artist and ethnomusicologist Violeta Parra was a pioneer in the nueva canción chilena (Chilean New Song) movement that emerged in the late 1950s and then spread throughout Latin America, Portugal, and Spain as nueva canción. Parra traveled all over Chile compiling extensive records of authentic folk music as well as recipes, proverbs, and other facets of cultural history. These records formed the foundation for the early movement's revival of traditional Chilean folk forms in new songs that represented modern realities of the working class and strongly advocated for social change. As the movement spread beyond Chile, the breadth of musical traditions incorporated into its foundation also expanded.

Which detail about songs associated with nueva canción, if true, would best illustrate the underlined claim?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

r

A. Many feature political commentary addressing contemporary issues that stemmed from shared experiences of European colonization in Latin American countries.

B. Many demonstrate the stylistic influence of corrido, a genre of narrative songs from Mexico that had come to be characterized by political themes in the early 1800s.

C. Many were written with parts meant to be played on the quena, a traditional flute used across Andean countries, including Chile.

D. Many were produced by Argentinian artists in the late 1950s, with others by artists in additional Latin American countries first emerging soon after.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice B is the best answer because it presents a detail that, if true, would most effectively illustrate the underlined claim that as nueva canción spread beyond Chile, the breadth of musical traditions incorporated into its foundation also expanded. The text explains that the movement was initially founded on traditional Chilean folk forms compiled by Parra, so if many nueva canción songs demonstrate the stylistic influence of corrido—a Mexican narrative song genre—that would show that a musical tradition originating outside Chile became part of the movement's foundation, directly illustrating the text's claim about how the breadth of nueva canción expanded.

Choice A is incorrect because the finding addresses lyrical content—political commentary on issues stemming from European colonization—rather than musical traditions. Even if nueva canción songs across different countries share political themes, that doesn't indicate that new musical forms or styles were incorporated into the movement's foundation. Thematic content is distinct from the musical traditions that songs draw on stylistically. Choice C is incorrect because the quena is described as a "traditional flute used across Andean countries, including Chile,"

meaning it's part of the Chilean folk tradition that underpinned nueva canción at its origin. Use of the quena therefore wouldn't illustrate the incorporation of musical traditions beyond those that founded the early movement in Chile. Choice D is incorrect because the finding establishes only that artists in additional Latin American countries produced nueva canción songs, not that those artists incorporated musical traditions from their own countries into the movement. Artists in other countries could still have been drawing on the same Chilean folk forms that originally founded the movement, so geographic spread alone doesn't illustrate an expansion of musical traditions.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 64cd7321

SOURCE_FILE: Command of Evidence(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 31

SKILL: Command of Evidence

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

As media consumption has become increasingly multiplatform and socially mediated, active news acquisition has diminished in favor of an attitude known as "news finds me" (NFM), in which people passively rely on their social networks and ambient media environments for information about current events. Homero Gil de Zúñiga and Trevor Diehl examined data on a representative group of adults in the United States to determine participants' strength of NFM attitude, political knowledge, and political interest. Although no major election took place sufficiently near the study for Gil de Zúñiga and Diehl to identify causality between NFM and voting behavior, they did posit that NFM may reduce voting probability through an indirect effect. Which finding, if true, would most directly support the idea advanced by Gil de Zúñiga and Diehl?

ANSWER CHOICES:

- r
- A. NFM attitude tends to increase in strength as major elections approach, and people are significantly more likely to vote in major elections than in minor elections.
 - B. NFM attitude has a strong negative effect on political knowledge and interest, and there is known to be a strong positive correlation between political knowledge and interest and the likelihood of voting.
 - C. Political interest is known to have a strong positive effect on likelihood of voting but shows only a weak positive effect on political knowledge, and NFM attitude shows little correlation with either political knowledge or political interest.
 - D. The likelihood of voting increases as political knowledge increases, and the relationship between NFM attitude and political knowledge tends to strengthen as the size of people's social networks increases.

CORRECT ANSWER:**RATIONALE:**

e

Choice B is the best answer because it presents a finding that, if true, would most directly support the idea advanced by Homero Gil de Zúñiga and Trevor Diehl that NFM ("news finds me") attitude may reduce voting probability through an indirect effect. The text describes NFM as an attitude that has lowered people's interest in actively acquiring news and introduces Gil de Zúñiga and Diehl's study on the effects of NFM on people in the United States' political knowledge and interest. The text goes on to say that despite the fact that the study didn't occur near a major election, Gil de Zúñiga and Diehl still conclude that NFM may reduce voting probability. If the likelihood, or probability, that a person will vote is linked to that person's level of political knowledge and interest, that would suggest that negatively affecting a person's level of political knowledge and interest would also negatively affect how likely that person is to vote. Thus, if NFM attitude has a negative effect on political knowledge and interest, then it would also likely reduce voting probability.

Choice A is incorrect because the finding that NFM attitude increases as major elections approach wouldn't address the effect of NFM on the likelihood of voting, which is the idea advanced by Gil de Zúñiga and Diehl. Moreover, although the text mentions that there were no major elections that occurred near the time of the study, it doesn't discern between major and minor elections when discussing voting probability.

Choice C is incorrect because finding that NFM attitude shows little correlation with either political knowledge or political interest would undermine, not support, Gil de Zúñiga and Diehl's idea that NFM may reduce voting probability because it suggests that NFM has no effect on political knowledge or political interest. Choice D is incorrect. Although Gil de Zúñiga and Diehl's idea would be supported by the finding that the

likelihood of voting increases as political knowledge increases, nothing in the text suggests that the researchers' idea hinges on the size of people's social networks.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 25176ff8

SOURCE_FILE: Command of Evidence(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 32

SKILL: Command of Evidence

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

"Mrs. Spring Fragrance" is a 1912 short story by Sui Sin Far. In the story, Mrs. Spring Fragrance, a Chinese immigrant living in Seattle, is traveling in California. In letters to her husband and friend, she demonstrates her concern for what's happening at her home in Seattle while she is away:

Which quotation from Mrs. Spring Fragrance's letters most effectively illustrates the claim?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

r

A. "My honorable cousin is preparing for the Fifth Moon Festival, and wishes me to compound for the occasion some American 'fudge, ' for which delectable sweet, made by my clumsy hands, you have sometimes shown a slight prejudice.

"

B. "Next week I accompany Ah Oi to the beautiful town of San José. There will we be met by the son of the Illustrious Teacher.

"

C. "Forget not to care for the cat, the birds, and the flowers. Do not eat too quickly nor fan too vigorously now that the weather is warming.

"

D. "I am enjoying a most agreeable visit, and American friends, as also our own, strive benevolently for the accomplishment of my pleasure.

"

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice C is the best answer because it presents a quotation that illustrates the claim that Mrs. Spring Fragrance demonstrates concern for what's happening at home while she's in California. By giving reminders to "care for the cat, the birds, and the flowers,

" "not eat too quickly,

" and

avoid engaging in strenuous activity in the heat, Mrs. Spring Fragrance shows that she's thinking about what's happening at home and wants to ensure everything is taken care of.

Choice A is incorrect because the quotation, while it does suggest that Mrs. Spring Fragrance has made fudge at home before, is focused on preparations for an upcoming festival, not on concerns for anything happening at home while Mrs. Spring Fragrance is away. Choice B is

incorrect because the quotation has to do with an upcoming event during Mrs. Spring Fragrance's trip-visiting San José and meeting someone

new-rather than her concern for what's happening at home. Choice D is incorrect because the quotation is focused on how Mrs. Spring

Fragrance feels about her trip and the friends she's seeing, not on her concern for what's happening at home.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 67b59a67

SOURCE_FILE: Command of Evidence(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 33

SKILL: Command of Evidence

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

Plants like potatoes, tomatoes, and soybeans are susceptible to bacterial wilt disease caused by the bacteria *Ralstonia solanacearum*. A multinational team of scientists led by Zhong Wei studied whether other microbes in the soil might influence the degree to which plants are affected by the disease. The team sampled soil surrounding individual tomato plants over time and compared the results of plants that became diseased with those that remained healthy. They concluded that the presence of certain microbes in the soil might explain the difference between healthy and diseased plants.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support the team's conclusion?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

r

- A. The soil surrounding healthy plants contained significantly higher concentrations of microbes known to inhibit *Ralstonia solanacearum* than the soil surrounding diseased plants did.
- B. The soil surrounding the plants contained high concentrations of *Ralstonia solanacearum* regardless of whether the plants were affected by wilt disease.
- C. The soil surrounding healthy plants tended to have significantly higher moisture levels than the soil surrounding diseased plants did.
- D. By the end of the experiment, over half the plants had been affected by wilt disease regardless of differences in the types and concentrations of microbes in the surrounding soil.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice A is the best answer. This choice provides evidence that directly links the presence of *R. solanacearum*-inhibiting microbes in the soil to the health of tomato plants.

Choice B is incorrect. This choice would weaken the team's conclusion. It suggests that the presence of the disease-causing bacteria had no effect on the health of the tomato plants. Choice C is incorrect. This choice doesn't support the team's conclusion. The conclusion is about microbes, not soil moisture. Choice D is incorrect. This choice would weaken the team's conclusion. It suggests that the presence of the bacteria-inhibiting microbe in soil had no effect on the health of the tomato plants.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 7edfb2c5

SOURCE_FILE: Command of Evidence(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 34

SKILL: Command of Evidence

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

700
600
500
400
300
200
100
0

Temperature (°C)

L5_239
K5_106
K3_18
K3_9

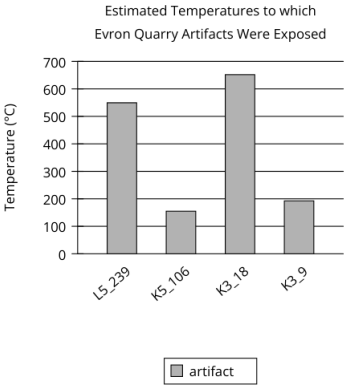
Estimated Temperatures to which
Evron Quarry Artifacts Were Exposed
artifact

Flint artifacts dating to 800,000 to 1,000,000 years ago have been recovered from the Evron Quarry in Israel. Likely created by the hominin *Homo erectus*, the artifacts have no visual features suggesting that they were exposed to fire, leading some scholars to conclude that these hominins had not acquired control of fire. But Zane Stepka and colleagues recently used a new method to determine whether these artifacts had been exposed to temperatures above 400°C (the typical temperature campfires reach) and concluded that the hominins who inhabited the site may have had control of fire.

Which choice best describes data in the graph that support the team's conclusion?

SAT	Reading and Writing	Information and Ideas	Command of Evidence	Medium
-----	---------------------	-----------------------	---------------------	--------

Question



Flint artifacts dating to 800,000 to 1,000,000 years ago have been recovered from the Evron Quarry in Israel. Likely created by the hominin *Homo erectus*, the artifacts have no visual features suggesting that they were exposed to fire, leading some scholars to conclude that these hominins had not acquired control of fire. But Zane Stepka and colleagues recently used a new method to determine whether these artifacts had been exposed to temperatures above 400°C (the typical temperature campfires reach) and concluded that the hominins who inhabited the site may have had control of fire.

Which choice best describes data in the graph that support the team's conclusion?

Answer

1. Artifacts K5_106 and K3_9 were exposed to temperatures above 400°C.
3. Artifacts L5_239 and K3_18 were exposed to temperatures of approximately 550°C and 650°C, respectively.
2. All of the artifacts were exposed to temperatures above 100°C.
2. Artifact K3_9 was exposed to a higher temperature than was artifact K5_106.

ANSWER_CHOICES:

r

- A. Ar tifacts K5_106 and K3_9 were exposed to temperatures above 400°C.
- B. Ar tifacts L5_239 and K3_18 were exposed to temperatures of approximately 550°C and 650°C, respectively.
- C. All of the ar tifacts were exposed to temperatures above 100°C.
- D. Ar tifact K3_9 was exposed to a higher temperature than was ar tifact K5_106.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice B is the best answer. Campfires typically reach over 400°C, so human ar tifacts that were exposed to temperatures higher than this may indicate some human control over fire.

Choice A is incorrect. This choice misreads the graph. Neither ar tifact K3_9 nor K5_106 was exposed to temperatures above even 200°C. Choice

C is incorrect. This choice doesn't support the claim. Campfires typically reach over 400°C, so exposure to temperatures of 100°C wouldn't demonstrate exposure to fire. Choice D is incorrect. This choice doesn't support the claim. Both ar tifacts K3_9 and K5_106 were exposed to temperatures of less than 200°C. Since campfires typically reach over 400°C, this wouldn't demonstrate exposure to fire.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 0c622cfb

SOURCE_FILE: Command of Evidence(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 36

SKILL: Command of Evidence

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

Although it's clear that Mars once had liquid water on its surface, astronomers have debated whether the evidence of ancient water reflects a prolonged phase of warm, wet conditions-the so-called wet and warm scenario-or a brief period of melting in an otherwise consistently frozen environment. Researchers Benjamin T

. Cardenas and Michael P

. Lamb recently added to this debate by using data from NASA and the Mars

Orbiter Laser Altimeter to map the topography of what is now a large basin in Mars's northern

hemisphere. Cardenas and Lamb concluded that

the wet and warm scenario is likely correct.

Which finding about the basin, if true, would most directly support Cardenas and Lamb's conclusion?

ANSWER CHOICES:

r

A. Its dimensions and shape indicate that it is unlikely to have formed as the result of an asteroid or comet impact.

B. It has features suggesting that it once held an ocean that underwent gradual sea-level changes over an extended time.

C. Its physical characteristics are most consistent with it having formed as a result of a massive but short-lived influx of liquid water.

D. It is surrounded by channels that could have been formed either by running water or by flowing lava.

CORRECT ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice B is the best answer. This choice provides direct support for the researchers' conclusion. If the basin once held an ocean of liquid water

for "an extended time,

" that supports the "wet and warm scenario" on Mars, which involved a "prolonged" period of temperate conditions (and not

just a "brief period of melting").

Choice A is incorrect. This choice doesn't provide support for the researchers' conclusions. The dimensions of the basin have little bearing on

whether or not it was filled with liquid water, and for how long, and that's the evidence that would support the "wet and warm" theory. Similarly,

whether or not the basin was formed by an asteroid or a comet is irrelevant to the question of whether or not there was water in the basin for a

long period. Choice C is incorrect. This choice does not provide support for the researchers' conclusions, but rather the opposite. A "massive but

short-lived influx" of liquid water is not the same as a "prolonged phase of warm, wet conditions.

" It more reflects the opposing theory, a "brief

period of melting.

" Choice D is incorrect. This choice does not support Cardenas and Lamb's conclusion. Both theories about liquid water on

Mars ("wet and warm" and "brief period of melting") involve flowing water, but lava isn't mentioned at all in the text. Therefore, this choice doesn't

provide exclusive support for either theory.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 5fb6ed10

SOURCE_FILE: Command of Evidence(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 37

SKILL: Command of Evidence

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

The Land of Enchantment is a 1906 travel book by Lilian Whiting. In the book, which describes the experience of traveling through the southwestern United States by train, Whiting reflects on the escape from everyday life that such a journey provides: _____

Which quotation from The Land of Enchantment most effectively illustrates the claim?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. "The oppor tunities and advantages already offered and constantly increasing are greater than would at first be considered possible."
- B. "The social and the picturesque charm of the long journey is singularly enhanced by the leisurely stops made for refreshment."
- C. "The real journey begins, of course, at Chicago, and as these trains leave in the evening the traveller fares for th in the seclusion of his ber th."
- D. "One experiences a cer tain sense of detachment from ordinary day and daylight duties that is exhilarating."

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice D is the best answer because. This quotation specifically describes a "sense of detachment from ordinary day, " which matches the claim's focus on "escape from everyday life."

Choice A is incorrect. While this quotation describes new oppor tunities associated with Whiting's experience, it doesn't frame these oppor tunities as "an escape, " and it doesn't directly compare Whiting's journey with "everyday life."

" Choice B is incorrect. While this quotation includes a positive characterization of Whiting's journey, it doesn't specifically address the idea of an "escape from everyday life, " which is the focus of the claim. Choice C is incorrect. This quotation focuses on where the journey begins, not on how it feels like an "escape from everyday life."

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: f452410b

SOURCE_FILE: Command of Evidence(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 38

SKILL: Command of Evidence

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

Results of Footprint Analysis for Two Sets of Theropod Tracks

Estimated footprint length (centimeters)

Average stride length (meters)

Estimated mean speed (meters per second)

La T

orre 6A

32.8

5.23

6.5-10.3

La T

orre 6B

28.9

5.57

8.8-12.4

The table shows data from paleontologist Angélica Torices and colleagues' 2021 study of two sets of dinosaur tracks preserved in a fossilized lake bed in Spain. The tracks, referred to as La Torre 6A and La Torre 6B, were left by two individual theropods (dinosaurs that walked on two legs). The team's findings suggest that of the two theropods, the one that left the La Torre 6B tracks had a higher maximum mean speed, _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the claim?

SAT	Reading and Writing	Information and Ideas	Command of Evidence	Easy

Question

Results of Footprint Analysis for Two Sets of Theropod Tracks

Tracks	Estimated footprint length (centimeters)	Average stride length (meters)	Estimated mean speed (meters per second)
La Torre 6A	32.8	5.23	6.5–10.3
La Torre 6B	28.9	5.57	8.8–12.4

The table shows data from paleontologist Angélica Torices and colleagues' 2021 study of two sets of dinosaur tracks preserved in a fossilized lake bed in Spain. The tracks, referred to as La Torre 6A and La Torre 6B, were left by two individual theropods (dinosaurs that walked on two legs). The team's findings suggest that of the two theropods, the one that left the La Torre 6B tracks had a higher maximum mean speed, _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the claim?

Answer

- A. a longer footprint, and a longer average stride.
- 3. a longer footprint, and a shorter average stride.
- 2. a shorter footprint, and a longer average stride.
- D. a shorter footprint, and a shorter average stride.

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. a longer footprint, and a longer average stride.
- B. a longer footprint, and a shorter average stride.

- C. a shorter footprint, and a longer average stride.
- D. a shorter footprint, and a shorter average stride.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice C is the best answer because it most effectively uses data from the table to complete the claim about the tracks left by two theropods.

The table indicates that the set of tracks labeled La Torre 6A has an estimated footprint length of 32.8 centimeters, an average stride length of 5.23 meters, and an estimated mean speed of 6.5-10.3 meters per second. For the set of tracks labeled La Torre 6B, on the other hand, the estimated footprint length is 28.9 centimeters, the average stride length is 5.57 meters, and the estimated mean speed is 8.8-12.4 meters per second. Therefore, the theropod that left the La Torre 6B tracks had a shorter footprint and a longer average stride than the one that left the La Torre 6A tracks.

Choice A is incorrect. While it is true that of the two theropods, the one that left the La Torre 6B tracks had a longer average stride, it didn't have a longer footprint: the table shows that its estimated footprint length is 28.9 centimeters, while La Torre 6A's estimated footprint length is 32.8

centimeters. Choice B is incorrect because the table shows that of the two theropods, the one that left the La Torre 6B tracks had a footprint length estimated at 28.9 centimeters, which is shorter than the 32.8 centimeters estimated for the other set of tracks. Moreover, the theropod that left the La Torre 6B tracks had a longer average stride, not shorter: 5.57 meters, compared with 5.23 meters for the other set of tracks.

Choice D is incorrect. While it is true that of the two theropods, the one that left the La Torre 6B tracks had a shorter footprint, it didn't have a shorter average stride: the table shows that its average stride length is 5.57 meters, while La Torre 6A's average stride length is 5.23 meters.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: a16128e2

SOURCE_FILE: Command of Evidence(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 39

SKILL: Command of Evidence

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

90
80
70
60
50
40
30
20
10
0

Percentage attribution

Region 1 (1970-2000)

Region 1 (2000-2014)

Region 2 (1970-2000)

Region 2 (2000-2014)

Percentage of ULE Attributed to

Population Growth and GDP per Capita

Growth in Two World Regions

Region, by time period

urban population growth

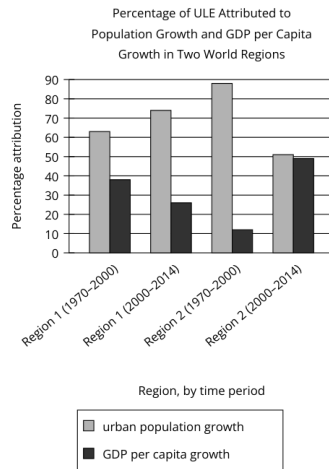
GDP per capita growth

In a study of urban physical expansion, Richa Mahtta et al. conducted a meta-analysis of more than 300 cities worldwide to determine whether urban land expansion (ULE) was more strongly influenced by urban population growth or by growth in gross domestic product (GDP) per capita, a measure of economic activity. Because efficient national government is necessary to provide urban services and infrastructure that attract economic investment, Mahtta et al. propose that absent other factors, the importance of GDP per capita growth to ULE would likely increase relative to the importance of population growth as governments become more efficient. If true, this suggests the possibility that _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the graph to complete the statement?

SAT	Reading and Writing	Information and Ideas	Command of Evidence	Hard
-----	---------------------	-----------------------	---------------------	------

Question



In a study of urban physical expansion, Richa Mahatta et al. conducted a meta-analysis of more than 300 cities worldwide to determine whether urban land expansion (ULE) was more strongly influenced by urban population growth or by growth in gross domestic product (GDP) per capita, a measure of economic activity. Because efficient national government is necessary to provide urban services and infrastructure that attract economic investment, Mahatta et al. propose that absent other factors, the importance of GDP per capita growth to ULE would likely increase relative to the importance of population growth as governments become more efficient. If true, this suggests the possibility that _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the graph to complete the statement?

Answer

1. national governments of countries in Region 1 experienced declines in efficiency in the period from 2000 to 2014, relative to the period from 1970 to 2000.
2. national governments of countries in Region 2 experienced declines in efficiency in the period from 2000 to 2014, relative to the period from 1970 to 2000.
3. countries in Region 1 experienced a slower rate of economic growth in the period from 2000 to 2014 than countries in Region 2 did, despite increasing national government efficiency in Region 1.

ANSWER CHOICES:

- A. national governments of countries in Region 1 experienced declines in efficiency in the period from 2000 to 2014, relative to the period from 1970 to 2000.
- B. countries in Region 1 experienced a slower rate of economic growth in the period from 2000 to 2014 than countries in Region 2 did, despite increasing national government efficiency in Region 1.
- C. national governments of most countries in Region 2 became more efficient in the period from 2000 to 2014 than they had been in the period from 1970 to 2000, but those of several countries in this region did not.
- D. national governments of countries in Region 1 and in Region 2 generally became more efficient in the period from 2000 to 2014 than they had been in the period from 1970 to 2000, but at different rates.

CORRECT ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

Choice A is the best answer because it most effectively uses data from the graph to complete the statement about Mahatta et al.'s proposal regarding factors that affect urban land expansion (ULE). According to the text, ULE is influenced by urban population growth and by gross domestic product (GDP) growth per capita. Reasoning that efficient national governments provide urban services and infrastructure needed to attract economic investment, Mahatta et al. suggest that, as governments become more efficient at providing urban services and infrastructure, GDP growth per capita will account for more ULE and urban population growth will account for less. But according to the graph, Region 1 saw an increase in the percentage attributed to urban population growth from 1970-2000 (between 60 and 65%) to 2000-2014 (between 70 and 75%) and a decrease in the percentage attributed to GDP growth per capita from 1970-2000 (between 35 and 40%) to 2000-2014 (about 25%). Because the percentage attributed to GDP growth per capita decreased (the opposite of what Mahatta et al. claimed would happen if the governments had become more efficient), the data suggest that the governments of Region 1 became less efficient at providing urban services

and infrastructure over that period.

Choice B is incorrect. Neither the graph nor the text gives the regions' relative levels of economic growth or what effect Mahtta et al. would expect such growth to have. Furthermore, Mahtta et al.

's proposal suggests that Region 1's decline in the percentage of ULE attributed to GDP

growth per capita from 1970-2000 (between 35 and 40%) to 2000-2014 (about 25%) would suggest decreasing, not increasing, government

efficiency over this time. Choice C is incorrect. Neither the text nor the graph provides information about the relative efficiencies of different

governments in Region 2. Choice D is incorrect. Mahtta et al.

's proposal suggests that more efficient governments will have a higher percentage

of their ULE driven by GDP growth per capita and a lower percentage driven by urban population growth. For Region 2, the percentage of ULE

attributed to GDP growth per capita increased from 1970-2000 (between 10 and 15%) to 2000-2014 (between 45 and 50%), but the opposite is

true for Region 1, which saw the percentage of ULE attributed to GDP growth per capita decline over the same period. Thus, whereas the data

suggest governments in Region 2 became more efficient, the data for Region 1 suggest that those governments became less efficient, not more.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 0cf13ece

SOURCE_FILE: Command of Evidence(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 41

SKILL: Command of Evidence

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

Recordings of Female
Bottlenose Dolphins with
Their Calves
Dolphin ID
Recording year
FB07
2012
FB25
1989
FB43
1992
FB79
2018

In a study of bottlenose dolphins, biologist Laela S. Sayigh and a team of researchers analyzed recordings of female bottlenose dolphins interacting with their calves. According to the table, in which year was the dolphin with the ID FB43 recorded with her calf?

SAT	Reading and Writing	Information and Ideas	Command of Evidence	Easy

Question

Recordings of Female Bottlenose Dolphins with Their Calves	
Dolphin ID	Recording year
FB07	2012
FB25	1989
FB43	1992
FB79	2018

n a study of bottlenose dolphins, biologist Laela S. Sayigh and a team of researchers analyzed recordings of female bottlenose dolphins nteracting with their calves.

According to the table, in which year was the dolphin with the ID FB43 recorded with her calf?

Answer

- A. 1999
3. 2012
- C. 2020
- D. 1992

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. 1999
- B. 2012
- C. 2020
- D. 1992

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice D is the best answer because it accurately reflects the data in the table. According to the table, the dolphin with ID FB43 has a recording year of 1992.

Choice A is incorrect. None of the dolphins in the table have a recording year of 1999. Choice B is incorrect. The table shows 2012 as the recording year for the dolphin with ID FB07, not ID FB43. Choice C is incorrect. None of the dolphins in the table have a recording year of 2020.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: f1bfbed3

SOURCE_FILE: Inferences(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 1

SKILL: Inferences

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

Mar ta Coll and colleagues' 2010 Mediterranean Sea biodiversity census repor ted approximately 17,000 species, nearly double the number repor ted in Carlo Bianchi and Carla Morri's 2000 census-a difference only par tly attributable to the description of new inver tebrate species in the interim. Another factor is that the morphological variability of microorganisms is poorly understood compared to that of ver tebrates, inver tebrates, plants, and algae, creating uncer tainty about how to evaluate microorganisms as species. Researchers' decisions on such matters therefore can be highly consequential. Indeed, the two censuses repor ted similar counts of ver tebrate, plant, and algal species, suggesting that

Which choice most logically completes the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

r

- A. Coll and colleagues repor ted a much higher number of species than Bianchi and Morri did largely due to the inclusion of inver tebrate species that had not been described at the time of Bianchi and Morri's census.
- B. some differences observed in microorganisms may have been treated as variations within species by Bianchi and Morri but treated as indicative of distinct species by Coll and colleagues.
- C. Bianchi and Morri may have been less sensitive to the degree of morphological variation displayed within a typical species of microorganism than Coll and colleagues were.
- D. the absence of clarity regarding how to differentiate among species of microorganisms may have resulted in Coll and colleagues underestimating the number of microorganism species.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice B is the best answer because it presents the conclusion that most logically completes the text's discussion of the different counts of species in the Mediterranean Sea. The text states that Coll and colleagues repor ted almost double the number of species that Bianchi and Morri repor ted in their study ten years earlier. According to the text, this difference can only be par tly attributed to new inver tebrate species being described in the years between the two studies, which means there must be an additional factor that made Coll and colleagues' count so much higher than Bianchi and Morri's count. The text goes on to explain that factor: researchers have a relatively poor understanding of microorganisms' morphological variability, or the differences in microorganisms' structure and form. This poor understanding makes it hard to classify microorganisms by species and means that researchers' decisions about classifying microorganisms can have a large effect on the overall species counts that researchers repor t. Additionally, the text says that the two censuses repor ted similar numbers of ver tebrate, plant, and algal species, which means that the difference in overall species did not come from differences in those categories. Given all this information, it most logically follows that Coll and colleagues may have treated some of the differences among microorganisms as indicative of the microorganisms being different species, whereas Bianchi and Morri treated those differences as variations within species, resulting in Coll and colleagues repor ting many more species than Bianchi and Morri did. Choice A is incorrect because the text explicitly addresses this issue by stating that the description of new inver tebrate species in the years between the two studies can explain only par t of the difference in the number of species repor ted by the studies. The focus of the text is on

explaining the difference between Coll and colleagues' count and Bianchi and Morri's count that cannot be accounted for by the inclusion of invertebrate species that had not been described at the time of Bianchi and Morri's study. Choice C is incorrect because nothing in the text suggests that Bianchi and Morri may have been less sensitive to how much the form and structure of microorganisms vary within the same species than Coll and colleagues were. If Bianchi and Morri had been less sensitive to within-species variation than Coll and colleagues were, Bianchi and Morri would likely have reported more species than Coll and colleagues did, since less sensitivity to within-species variation would

lead researchers to classify as different species microorganisms that more sensitive researchers would classify as variations within the same species. The text indicates, however, that Bianchi and Morri reported far fewer species than Coll and colleagues did; since the text also excludes other explanations for this difference, it suggests that in fact Bianchi and Morri were more sensitive to within-species variation than Coll and colleagues were, leading Bianchi and Morri to report fewer overall species. Choice D is incorrect because the text is focused on explaining why Coll and colleagues reported many more species than Bianchi and Morri did, and an underestimate of the number of microorganism species by Coll and colleagues would not explain that difference—it would suggest, in fact, that the difference in the number of species should have been even larger.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: d748c3fd

SOURCE_FILE: Inferences(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 3

SKILL: Inferences

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

In her 2021 article "Throwaway History: Towards a Historiography of Ephemera," scholar Anne Garner discusses John Johnson (1882-1956), a devoted collector of items intended to be discarded, including bus tickets and campaign pamphlets. Johnson recognized that scholarly institutions considered his expansive collection of ephemera to be worthless—indeed, it wasn't until 1968, after Johnson's death, that Oxford University's Bodleian Library acquired the collection, having grasped the items' potential value to historians and other researchers. Hence, the example of Johnson serves to _____
Which choice most logically completes the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. demonstrate the difficulties faced by contemporary historians in conducting research at the Bodleian Library without access to ephemera.
 - B. represent the challenge of incorporating examples of ephemera into the collections of libraries and other scholarly institutions.
 - C. lend support to arguments by historians and other researchers who continue to assert that ephemera holds no value for scholars.
 - D. illustrate both the relatively low scholarly regard in which ephemera was once held and the later recognition of ephemera's possible utility.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice D is the best answer. Johnson collected "ephemera," or things that are meant to be thrown away. Scholars thought his collection was worthless to them, then later realized that it was potentially valuable. This suggests that scholars went from disregarding ephemera to recognizing their usefulness.

Choice A is incorrect. This inference isn't supported. The text tells us that the Bodleian Library acquired Johnson's large collection of ephemera back in 1968, so we can assume that contemporary historians conducting research there do have access to that collection. Choice B is incorrect. This inference isn't supported. The text tells us that "Oxford University's Bodleian Library acquired the collection," but it never suggests that it was a challenge to do so. Choice C is incorrect. This inference isn't supported. The text actually suggests the opposite: the example of Johnson's collection lends support to arguments that ephemera does hold value for scholars.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 6b8a7c74

SOURCE_FILE: Inferences(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 4

SKILL: Inferences

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

One recognized social norm of gift giving is that the time spent obtaining a gift will be viewed as a reflection of the gift's thoughtfulness. Marketing experts Farnoush Reshadi, Julian Givi, and Gopal Das addressed this view in their studies of norms specifically surrounding the giving of gift cards, noting that while recipients tend to view digital gift cards (which can be purchased online from anywhere and often can be redeemed online as well) as superior to physical gift cards (which sometimes must be purchased in person and may only be redeemable in person) in terms of usage, 94.8 percent of participants surveyed indicated that it is more socially acceptable to give a physical gift card to a recipient. This finding suggests that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

ANSWER CHOICES:

- r
- A. gift givers likely overestimate the amount of effort required to use digital gift cards and thus mistakenly assume gift recipients will view them as less desirable than physical gift cards.
 - B. physical gift cards are likely preferred by gift recipients because the tangible nature of those cards offers a greater psychological sense of ownership than digital gift cards do.
 - C. physical gift cards are likely less desirable to gift recipients than digital gift cards are because of the perception that physical gift cards require unnecessary effort to obtain.
 - D. gift givers likely perceive digital gift cards as requiring relatively low effort to obtain and thus wrongly assume gift recipients will appreciate them less than they do physical gift cards.

CORRECT ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice D is the best answer because it most logically completes the text's discussion of perceptions of digital versus physical gift cards. The text begins by explaining that the perception of "the time spent obtaining a gift...as a reflection of the gift's thoughtfulness" is a social norm of gift giving. The text then explains that although those who receive digital gift cards view them as easier to use than physical gift cards, a marketing study nonetheless showed that 94.8% of participants found physical gift cards more "socially acceptable" to give. The text specifically contrasts the ease with which digital gift cards "can be purchased online from anywhere" with the fact that physical gift cards "sometimes must be purchased in person"-suggesting the greater difficulty of obtaining physical cards. Given the text's initial premise that gift-giving norms equate the thoughtfulness of a gift with the effort involved in acquiring that gift, it is reasonable to infer that people perceive digital gift cards as requiring less effort to obtain and thus assume recipients will appreciate them less, even though recipients actually prefer gift cards in the more usable digital format.

Choice A is incorrect. Although the text does discuss recipients' preference of digital versus physical gift cards and the relative ease with which the two formats can be used, it doesn't consider the misconceptions that gift givers may have of these factors. Moreover, the text establishes that recipients regard digital gift cards as easier to use and therefore preferable to physical gift cards. Choice B is incorrect because the text doesn't consider whether recipients of gift cards feel a sense of ownership toward them, nor does the text touch on the greater tangibility of physical versus digital gift cards. Instead, the text contrasts the two formats of gift cards in terms of their respective usability and the difficulty

involved in acquiring them and discusses how those factors influence people's perceptions of the two formats. Choice C is incorrect because it contradicts the text, which explains that recipients regard digital gift cards as superior to physical ones because they are easier to use than physical cards, not because physical gift cards require greater effort to obtain than digital gift cards do. Moreover, the text doesn't characterize the effort required to obtain physical gift cards as "unnecessary."

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: ca5a3fb4

SOURCE_FILE: Inferences(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 5

SKILL: Inferences

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

The practice of logging (cutting down trees for commercial and other uses) is often thought to be at odds with forest conservation (the work of preserving forests). However, a massive study in forest management and preservation spanning 700,000 hectares in Oregon's Malheur National Forest calls that view into question. So far, results of the study suggest that forest plots that have undergone limited logging (the careful removal of a controlled number of trees) may be more robust than plots that haven't been logged at all. These results, in turn, suggest that _____
Which choice most logically completes the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. logging may be useful for maintaining healthy forests, provided it is limited.
 - B. other forest management strategies are more effective than limited logging.
 - C. as time passes, it will be difficult to know whether limited logging has any benefits.
 - D. the best way to support forest health may be to leave large forests entirely untouched.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice A is the best answer because it most logically completes the text's discussion of the potential effects of logging on forest conservation.

The text begins by stating that logging practices are often thought of as being contrary to forest conservation efforts. Then, the text presents the results of a research study examining the effect of limited logging practices on specific forest plots, finding that the plots with limited logging may be "more robust" (healthier) than the plots that hadn't been logged at all. Given these results, it follows that logging may be a useful practice for maintaining healthy forests if it is practiced in a limited way.

Choice B is incorrect because the study referenced in the text only provides information on limited logging as a potential forest management strategy. There is no information in the text about how other forest management strategies support forest conservation efforts. Therefore, the text does not support the assertion that other forest management strategies are more successful than limited logging. Choice C is incorrect because the text presents a research study with findings that specific plots of forest with limited logging may be more robust than the forest plots that were not logged. Rather than suggesting that it is hard to know whether limited logging might be beneficial, the text suggests that the practice could be useful in forest conservation efforts. Choice D is incorrect. The text discusses the results of a research study that compares the health of forest plots with limited logging to forest plots that were not logged. It does not take a position on the best way to support forest health but rather presents a research study with findings that question conventionally held thoughts regarding the practice of logging.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: ce4448b7

SOURCE_FILE: Inferences(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 6

SKILL: Inferences

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

Researchers recently found that disruptions to an enjoyable experience, like a short series of advertisements during a television show, often increase viewers' reported enjoyment. Suspecting that disruptions to an unpleasant experience would have the opposite effect, the researchers had participants listen to construction noise for 30 minutes and anticipated that those whose listening experience was frequently interrupted with short breaks of silence would thus _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. find the disruptions more irritating as time went on.
 - B. rate the listening experience as more negative than those whose listening experience was uninterrupted.
 - C. rate the experience of listening to construction noise as lasting for less time than it actually lasted.
 - D. perceive the volume of the construction noise as growing softer over time.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice B is the best answer. It most logically completes the text. The text tells us that disruptions to an enjoyable experience increase viewers' enjoyment. It also says that researchers suspect the opposite is true for disruptions to an unpleasant experience. Thus, we can infer that the researchers expect to find that the interrupted unpleasant experience was worse for listeners than the uninterrupted unpleasant experience.

Choice A is incorrect. It doesn't logically complete the text. The text never makes any claims about how irritating the disruptions themselves are perceived to be. Rather, the text says that pleasant experiences are perceived as more enjoyable with interruptions, and that the opposite is suspected to be true of unpleasant experiences. Choice C is incorrect. It doesn't logically complete the text. The text never makes any claims about how long any experience is perceived to be. Rather, the text says that pleasant experiences are perceived as more enjoyable with interruptions, and that the opposite is suspected to be true of unpleasant experiences. Choice D is incorrect. It doesn't logically complete the text. The text never makes any claims about how interruptions affect the perceived volume of the unpleasant or pleasant experience. Rather, the text says that pleasant experiences are perceived as more enjoyable with interruptions, and that the opposite is suspected to be true of unpleasant experiences.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: a68fd3e7

SOURCE_FILE: Inferences(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 7

SKILL: Inferences

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

Many of William Shakespeare's tragedies address broad themes that still appeal to today's audiences. For instance, *Romeo and Juliet*, which is set in the Italy of Shakespeare's time, tackles the themes of parents versus children and love versus hate, and the play continues to be read and produced widely around the world. But understanding Shakespeare's so-called history plays can require a knowledge of several centuries of English history. Consequently, _____ Which choice most logically completes the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. many theatergoers and readers today are likely to find Shakespeare's history plays less engaging than the tragedies.
 - B. some of Shakespeare's tragedies are more relevant to today's audiences than twentieth-century plays.
 - C. *Romeo and Juliet* is the most thematically accessible of all Shakespeare's tragedies.
 - D. experts in English history tend to prefer Shakespeare's history plays to his other works.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice A is the best answer because it most logically completes the text's discussion of the relative appeal of different kinds of plays by Shakespeare to today's audiences. According to the text, Shakespeare's tragedies address broad themes that continue to appeal to today's audiences. Indeed, the text suggests that these themes are timeless, as illustrated by the example of *Romeo and Juliet*, which the text states is still read and widely performed despite being set in the Italy of Shakespeare's time. In contrast, the text indicates that audiences and readers may need to be familiar with several centuries of English history in order to understand Shakespeare's history plays. Because many theatergoers and readers are unlikely to possess such extensive historical knowledge, it follows that they are likely to find Shakespeare's history plays less engaging than his more accessible tragedies.

Choice B is incorrect because the text never introduces a comparison between Shakespeare's tragedies and twentieth-century plays, only between Shakespeare's tragedies and his history plays. Since twentieth-century plays aren't mentioned, there's no basis in the text for the idea that some of Shakespeare's tragedies are more relevant than twentieth-century plays to today's audiences. Choice C is incorrect. Although the text indicates that *Romeo and Juliet* is thematically accessible to today's audiences, it doesn't suggest that *Romeo and Juliet* is more accessible than Shakespeare's other tragedies. Rather, the text presents *Romeo and Juliet* as an example to support the idea that Shakespeare's tragedies hold continued appeal for today's readers and theatergoers. Choice D is incorrect. Although experts in English history would likely possess the knowledge needed to understand Shakespeare's history plays, the text never mentions such experts or suggests that they would enjoy the history plays more than Shakespeare's other works.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 4b3d6062

SOURCE_FILE: Inferences(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 8

SKILL: Inferences

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

The Mammillaria cactus *M. boolii* occurs naturally only in the state of Sonora in Mexico, and the smallness of its range makes it especially vulnerable to extinction. The traditional single-species approach to conservation emphasizes the need to focus on individual species most at risk, like *M. boolii*, but recently, conservationists have argued that an ecosystem-based approach that incorporates the many interactions between the climate, terrain, and various species of a given geographical area may lead to better outcomes for all the species in a given location. If this view is correct, the single-species approach to the conservation of *M. boolii* could thus _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. lead to a better understanding of how the distribution of Mammillaria species throughout Mexico has affected their survival.
 - B. allow conservationists to better consider how climatic changes affecting Sonora may reduce the number of species competing with *M. boolii*.
 - C. erroneously shift the focus of conservation efforts away from *M. boolii* itself.
 - D. fail to consider the ways in which the survival of *M. boolii* may be influenced by changes in the populations of other species that inhabit Sonora.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice D is the best answer because it most logically completes the text's discussion of conservation approaches for the Mammillaria cactus *M. boolii*. The text establishes that *M. boolii* only grows naturally in the state of Sonora in Mexico, which makes it particularly vulnerable to extinction. The text then contrasts two approaches to conservation: the traditional single-species approach that individually focuses on at-risk species and a newer ecosystem-based approach that considers the interactions between climate, terrain, and various species in a geographical area. According to the text, conservationists have recently argued that this ecosystem-based approach may lead to better outcomes for all species in a location. If this ecosystem view is correct, then the single-species approach to conserving *M. boolii* would likely fail to consider how the cactus's survival depends on its interactions with other species in Sonora's ecosystem. Choice A is incorrect because the text doesn't address the distribution of Mammillaria species besides *M. boolii* throughout Mexico or discuss how that distribution affects survival. The text focuses specifically on *M. boolii* in Sonora and different approaches to its conservation. Choice B is incorrect because the text doesn't suggest that climatic changes in Sonora would reduce competition for *M. boolii* or that conservation efforts are focused on understanding this specific dynamic. In fact, the text implies that an ecosystem-based approach would consider climate among many other factors but doesn't specify how climatic changes might affect competition between species. Choice C is incorrect because the text doesn't suggest that the single-species approach would shift the focus of conservation efforts away from *M. boolii* itself—rather, it suggests that this approach might be too narrowly focused on *M. boolii* alone without considering the broader ecosystem-related factors that affect its survival.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 58e9e497

SOURCE_FILE: Inferences(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 9

SKILL: Inferences

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

In the early nineteenth century, some Euro-American farmers in the northeastern United States used agricultural techniques developed by the Haudenosaunee (Iroquois) people centuries earlier, but it seems that few of those farmers had actually seen Haudenosaunee farms firsthand. Barring the possibility of several farmers of the same era independently developing techniques that the Haudenosaunee people had already invented, these facts most strongly suggest that _____ Which choice most logically completes the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. those farmers learned the techniques from other people who were more directly influenced by Haudenosaunee practices.
 - B. the crops typically cultivated by Euro-American farmers in the northeastern United States were not well suited to Haudenosaunee farming techniques.
 - C. Haudenosaunee farming techniques were widely used in regions outside the northeastern United States.
 - D. Euro-American farmers only began to recognize the benefits of Haudenosaunee farming techniques late in the nineteenth century.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice A is the best answer because it most logically completes the text's discussion of Euro-American farmers' use of Haudenosaunee agricultural techniques. According to the text, some Euro-American farmers were using these techniques in the early nineteenth century despite few of the farmers having seen Haudenosaunee farms. One explanation for these facts might be that the farmers developed techniques on their own that already had been invented centuries earlier by the Haudenosaunee people, but the text explicitly bars, or rules out, this explanation. If Euro-American farmers didn't learn these techniques from direct observation of Haudenosaunee practices and didn't invent the techniques independently, then the most logical explanation is that they learned the techniques from other people who were more directly influenced by Haudenosaunee practices than the farmers themselves were. Once they learned about Haudenosaunee agricultural practices, Euro-American farmers could then apply those practices to their own farming. Choice B is incorrect because the fact that some Euro-American farmers in the northeastern United States were using Haudenosaunee techniques suggests that the techniques were likely useful for the crops the farmers raised, not that the crops typically cultivated by the farmers were not well suited to Haudenosaunee farming techniques. If the farmers' crops were ill suited to the techniques, it's unlikely that the farmers would have used those techniques. Choice C is incorrect because the text indicates only that Haudenosaunee agricultural techniques were used by Euro-American farmers in the northeastern United States, not that these techniques were widely used outside this region. Choice D is incorrect because the text states that some Euro-American farmers were using Haudenosaunee farming techniques early in the nineteenth century. This suggests that some Euro-American farmers were beginning to recognize the benefits of these techniques near the start of the century, not that such farmers only began to recognize the benefits of the techniques much later.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 3190835d

SOURCE_FILE: Inferences(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 10

SKILL: Inferences

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

Some businesses believe that when employees are interrupted while doing their work, they experience a decrease in energy and productivity.

However, a team led by Harshad Puranik, who studies management, has found that interruptions by colleagues can have a social component that increases employees' sense of belonging, resulting in greater job satisfaction that benefits employees and employers. Therefore, businesses should recognize that _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

r

A. the interpersonal benefits of some interruptions in the workplace may offset the perceived negative effects.

B. in order to maximize productivity, employers should be willing to interrupt employees frequently throughout the day.

C. most employees avoid interrupting colleagues because they don't appreciate being interrupted themselves.

D. in order to cultivate an ideal workplace environment, interruptions of work should be discouraged.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice A is the best answer because it most logically completes the text's discussion of potential benefits of interruptions in the workplace. The text indicates that a common belief in business is that interruptions to working employees decrease energy and productivity levels. However, the text goes on to explain that a research team led by Harshad Puranik has found that there could be a social benefit to these interruptions. Since the team found that workplace interruptions can increase employees' sense of belonging and job satisfaction, it follows that the interpersonal benefits of some interruptions can offset the perceived negative effects.

Choice B is incorrect. Although the text presents research findings that suggest some workplace interruptions can have a positive effect on employee job satisfaction, no further information is presented to suggest at what frequency these interruptions are ideal. Furthermore, the text doesn't tie workplace interruptions to increased productivity, but rather links it to social benefits such as sense of belonging. Choice C is incorrect because the text doesn't address employees' motives for choosing not to interrupt their colleagues. The text presents research findings that suggest that there are some positive interpersonal effects of workplace interruptions that can increase employee job satisfaction. Choice D is incorrect because asking businesses to discourage workplace interruptions doesn't follow from the team's research about the benefits of workplace interruptions, nor does the text describe an ideal work environment. Instead, the text presents research suggesting that there may be positive aspects to workplace interruptions that haven't previously been considered.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 58817765

SOURCE_FILE: Inferences(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 11

SKILL: Inferences

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

Some geologists have proposed designating the period from 1950 to the present as a new geological epoch (the Anthropocene) characterized by human impact on Earth, but they have struggled to identify reliable stratigraphic markers of the epoch's onset. Ina Dimante-Deimantovica and a research team investigated whether the initial appearance of primary microplastics—invented and mass-produced for industrial and other purposes, beginning around the middle of the twentieth century—in sedimentary layers could serve this role. The researchers analyzed European lake sediment profiles from the late eighteenth century to the present. Microplastics were present in all layers, likely because certain microplastic shapes enabled rapid downward migration. The researchers therefore concluded that _____ Which choice most logically completes the text?

ANSWER CHOICES:

- r
- A. the lowest sedimentary layer in which microplastics are found cannot be treated as indicative of the chronological beginning of the Anthropocene.
 - B. the presence of microplastics in sediment dating to the late eighteenth century casts doubt on the appropriateness of designating 1950 as the onset of the Anthropocene.
 - C. microplastics are not prevalent enough in sediment to serve as a reliable sign of the human impact characteristic of the Anthropocene.
 - D. using the earliest presence of microplastics as a stratigraphic marker of the beginning of the Anthropocene is likely to be viable in some locations but is not viable in Europe.

CORRECT ANSWER:**RATIONALE:**

e

Choice A is the best answer because it most logically completes the text's discussion of microplastics as a proposed stratigraphic marker for the onset of the Anthropocene. The text indicates that although primary microplastics (used for industrial and other purposes) were invented and mass-produced beginning only around the mid-twentieth century, researchers found microplastics throughout European lake sediment profiles dating from the late eighteenth century to the present. According to the text, microplastics were in all layers of sediment likely because microplastics of certain shapes can rapidly migrate downward—that is, they can move into sedimentary layers that predate their manufacture. Since it can't be assumed that the date of a layer in which microplastics are found indicates when the microplastics were first deposited, it follows that the lowest sedimentary layer containing microplastics can't be treated as indicative of the chronological beginning of the Anthropocene.

Choice B is incorrect. The text explains that microplastics appeared in layers of sediment long predating 1950 likely because certain shapes allowed them to rapidly migrate downward—that is, the particles physically moved into older layers. This finding doesn't cast doubt on the appropriateness of considering 1950 as the onset of the Anthropocene; it doesn't suggest a flaw in thinking that humans' impact on Earth shifted around 1950 but simply suggests that the position of microplastics in sediment isn't useful as an indicator of such a shift. Choice C is incorrect because the issue presented in the text isn't a lack of prevalence of microplastics (and though no quantity is indicated, microplastics were found across all the layers) but rather the inability to determine when microplastics were originally deposited, since the particles can migrate rapidly into older sediment layers. Choice D is incorrect because the text indicates that the likely cause of

microplastics being present in all layers of the sediment profiles is a property of microplastic particles themselves (certain shapes allowing them to rapidly move downward into older layers), not a characteristic of European lake sediment or anything else specific to Europe. There's no reason to think the issue of particle migration wouldn't occur in other locations.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 1755eaf0

SOURCE_FILE: Inferences(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 12

SKILL: Inferences

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

Like many other genera of wild bees, bumblebees have in recent decades experienced population collapse caused by, among other factors, habitat destruction and climate variation. Bumblebees are also one of the most researched bee genera, second only to honeybees. As a result, ecologists have gained much of their insight about wild-bee declines from bumblebees. In a 2021 paper, zoologist Guillaume Ghisbain notes that bumblebees are among the relatively few wild-bee genera that display social behaviors and dietary generalism (ability to obtain nectar and pollen from a diversity of plant species), two traits that are associated with increased resilience to some specific environmental changes. Ghisbain therefore contends that _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

r

- A. although bumblebees and many other wild bees have experienced similar population declines in the past, compared with other wild bees, bumblebees are likely at greater risk of being harmed by climate variation than by habitat destruction.
- B. although bumblebees have been more extensively studied than most wild bees, researchers should not use bumblebees to draw conclusions about the decline of other wild bees, even ones with feeding patterns and levels of sociability that are similar to those of bumblebees.
- C. because bumblebees and other bees with generalist diets are less negatively affected by environmental stress than bees with specialized diets are, they are less likely to experience major population changes in the future than bees with specialized diets are.
- D. because the responses of bumblebees and other wild bees to environmental threats are not always comparable, researchers need to exercise caution when extrapolating information about wild-bee population declines from bumblebees.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice D is the best answer because it most logically completes the text's discussion of wild-bee declines. The text establishes that bumblebees and other wild bees have been experiencing population collapse as a result of habitat destruction, climate variation, and other factors. The text then indicates that because bumblebees are very extensively researched, ecologists rely heavily on findings about them to understand wild-bee declines in general. However, the text then introduces Ghisbain's observation that unlike most other wild-bee genera, bumblebees have certain traits (social behaviors and dietary generalism) linked to increased resilience to certain environmental changes. In other words, bumblebees aren't necessarily representative of wild bees as a whole because they are likely more tolerant of some pressures. Therefore, it logically follows that Ghisbain would urge researchers to exercise caution when using bumblebee data to draw conclusions about other wild-bee population declines, since bumblebees and other wild bees don't always respond comparably to environmental threats. Choice A is incorrect because the text doesn't indicate that climate variation is more of a threat to bumblebees than habitat destruction is or that it is a bigger threat to bumblebees than it is to other wild bees. The text simply indicates that climate variation and habitat destruction are among the factors that have caused population collapses for bumblebees and other wild-bee genera. Choice B is incorrect. As it is presented in the text, Ghisbain notes that bumblebees may respond to environmental changes differently than many other wild-bee genera do; this suggests that bumblebees shouldn't be treated as representative of all wild bees, but there's no reason to think that Ghisbain would go so far as to assert that

bumblebee data shouldn't be used to draw conclusions about other wild-bee genera that are similar to bumblebees in their dietary and social traits, even if there are relatively few. The text suggests caution in extrapolation, not a complete rejection of using bumblebee research. Choice C is incorrect. Although the text indicates that dietary generalism is linked to increased resilience to specific environmental changes (that is, to some but not all environmental stresses), it doesn't suggest that bumblebees and other bees with this trait are less likely than bees with specialized diets to experience major population changes. In fact, the text makes it clear that like many other wild-bee genera-most of which don't display dietary generalism-bumblebees are already experiencing population collapse.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: ac285054

SOURCE_FILE: Inferences(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 13

SKILL: Inferences

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

The domestic sweet potato (*Ipomoea batatas*) descends from a wild plant native to South America. It also populates the Polynesian Islands, where evidence confirms that Native Hawaiians and other Indigenous peoples were cultivating the plant centuries before seafaring first occurred over the thousands of miles of ocean separating them from South America. To explain how the sweet potato was first introduced in Polynesia, botanist Pablo Muñoz-Rodríguez and colleagues analyzed the DNA of numerous varieties of the plant, concluding that Polynesian varieties diverged from South American ones over 100,000 years ago. Given that Polynesia was peopled only in the last three thousand years, the team concluded that _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

r

- A. the cultivation of the sweet potato in Polynesia likely predates its cultivation in South America.
- B. Polynesian peoples likely acquired the sweet potato from South American peoples only within the last three thousand years.
- C. human activity likely played no role in the introduction of the sweet potato in Polynesia.
- D. Polynesian sweet potato varieties likely descend from a single South American variety that was domesticated, not wild.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice C is the best answer because it most logically completes the text's discussion of the sweet potato in Polynesia. The text indicates that the sweet potato is found in Polynesia but originated in South America, and that the sweet potato was being cultivated by Native Hawaiians and other Indigenous peoples in Polynesia long before sea voyages between South America and Polynesia began. The text goes on to note that research by Muñoz-Rodríguez and colleagues has established that the Polynesian varieties of sweet potato split from South American varieties more than 100,000 years ago, which is thousands of years before humans settled in Polynesia. If Polynesian peoples were cultivating the sweet potato before sea voyages between Polynesia and South America began, and if Polynesian varieties of sweet potato diverged from South American varieties well before people were in Polynesia, it can reasonably be concluded that humans didn't play a role in bringing the sweet potato to Polynesia. Choice A is incorrect. The text doesn't provide any information about when the sweet potato began to be cultivated in South America, so there's no support for the conclusion that cultivation began in Polynesia before it began in South America. Choice B is incorrect because the text indicates that the sweet potato was being cultivated in Polynesia long before sea journeys between Polynesia and South America began. Therefore, it wouldn't be reasonable to conclude that Polynesian peoples acquired the sweet potato from South American peoples. Additionally, the text indicates that the Polynesian varieties of sweet potato diverged from the South American varieties thousands of years before people settled in Polynesia, which suggests that the sweet potato was already present in Polynesia when people arrived. Choice D is incorrect because the text states that the domestic sweet potato, which is found in Polynesia, descends from a wild South American plant, not from a domesticated South American plant. The only people that the text describes as cultivating the sweet potato are Native Hawaiians and other Indigenous peoples of Polynesia.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 01989d77

SOURCE_FILE: Inferences(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 14

SKILL: Inferences

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

Microbes that live in shallow lakes and ponds produce methane, a harmful greenhouse gas. Ecologist Ralf Aben and his team wanted to see how different types of shallow-water plants might affect the amount of methane that escapes into the atmosphere. Aben's team set up some water tanks with soil and microbes from local ponds. Some tanks had a type of underwater plant that grows in the soil called watermilfoil. Other tanks had either duckweed, a type of plant that floats on the water's surface, or algae. Aben and his team found that tanks with duckweed and algae released higher levels of methane than tanks with watermilfoil did. This finding suggests that _____ Which choice most logically completes the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

r

- A. the presence of some kinds of underwater plants like watermilfoil helps prevent methane from escaping shallow lakes and ponds.
- B. shallow lakes and ponds release more methane than deeper bodies of water because shallow bodies of water usually have more plants than deep bodies of water do.
- C. shallow lakes and ponds are more likely to contain algae than to contain either watermilfoil or duckweed.
- D. having a mix of algae, underwater plants, and floating plants is the best way to reduce the amount of methane in shallow lakes and ponds.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice A is the best answer. The passage tells us that "tanks with duckweed (a floating plant) and algae released higher levels of methane than tanks with watermilfoil (an underwater plant) did." This suggests that the presence of some kinds of underwater plants like watermilfoil may help prevent methane from escaping shallow lakes and ponds. Choice B is incorrect. The passage doesn't mention deeper bodies of water at all, so there's no basis for this inference. Choice C is incorrect. The passage doesn't compare the likelihood of shallow lakes and ponds containing algae, watermilfoil, or duckweed. Choice D is incorrect. The study didn't include any tanks with a mix of plants, so there's no basis for this inference.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 8e6a96f5

SOURCE_FILE: Inferences(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 15

SKILL: Inferences

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

Duckweed is a small freshwater plant that is often exposed to zinc pollution. Sofia Vámos and colleagues collected samples of four duckweed ecotypes (genetically and geographically distinct populations within a species), along with water from each ecotype's habitat. Hypothesizing that each ecotype is adapted to its local conditions in ways that bolster its growth and resistance to pollutants, the researchers grew each ecotype in all four water samples and with three levels of zinc (none, low, high). (The researchers did not replicate local differences in light or temperature.) They found that the ecotypes grew equally well in all four water samples and that adding zinc consistently enhanced growth, regardless of concentration, suggesting that _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. while the ecotypes are genetically and geographically distinct, those differences do not represent adaptations to local environmental conditions.
 - B. there may not be significant differences in the water that each ecotype inhabits, but there are significant differences in each ecotype's resistance to zinc pollution.
 - C. if each ecotype is indeed locally adapted as the researchers hypothesized, those adaptations are to other environmental conditions than the water each ecotype inhabits.
 - D. although the researchers' hypothesis does not appear to be supported, this may be because the levels of zinc exposure the plants in the experiment received did not match their exposure in their natural environments.

CORRECT_ANSWER:**RATIONALE:**

e

Choice C is the best answer because it most logically completes the text's discussion of Vámos and colleagues' experiment with four duckweed ecotypes. According to the text, the researchers hypothesized that each ecotype is adapted to its local habitat in ways that help it grow more effectively and better tolerate pollutants. To test this, they grew each ecotype in water collected from all four habitats and exposed them to three different zinc levels. If the hypothesis were correct, each ecotype would be expected to thrive more in water from its own habitat than in the other waters and to respond to zinc levels differently depending on the level of zinc pollution in its home environment. However, the results showed that every ecotype grew just as well in every water sample, and that zinc boosted growth the same way across all ecotypes no matter the concentration. In other words, the experiment found no evidence that these ecotypes have specifically adapted to their local water or their local zinc exposure. It follows, then, that if each ecotype is actually locally adapted, it is adapted not to the water conditions in its habitat but to other environmental factors—such as local light or temperature levels, which the text notes the researchers didn't account for in their experiment.

Choice A is incorrect because the findings presented in the text suggest only that the ecotypes' genetic and geographic differences don't represent adaptations to local water conditions and zinc levels, not that the differences don't represent adaptations to any local environmental conditions. Indeed, the text notes that the researchers didn't account for light or temperature levels in each habitat, suggesting the possibility that the ecotypes are adapted to those or other local environmental factors. Choice B is incorrect because it contradicts the findings presented in the text. The text states that zinc consistently enhanced growth regardless of concentration, meaning the

ecotypes all responded similarly to zinc. This uniform response indicates there aren't significant differences in their resistance to zinc pollution. Choice D is incorrect because the findings presented in the text don't demonstrate that the researchers' hypothesis of local adaptation isn't supported. That the ecotypes grew equally well in all of the water samples and equally benefited from added zinc at all levels, regardless of zinc levels in their natural environments, suggests only that the ecotypes aren't adapted to their local water conditions and zinc levels; these findings don't rule out the possibility that the ecotypes are adapted to other local factors in their habitats, such as light or temperature (which the text notes the researchers didn't examine).

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 7c1e5880

SOURCE_FILE: Inferences(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 16

SKILL: Inferences

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

Scholars have noted that F

. Scott Fitzgerald's writings were likely influenced in part by his marriage to Zelda Fitzgerald, but many don't recognize

Zelda as a writer in her own right. Indeed, Zelda authored several works herself, such as the novel *Save Me the Waltz* and numerous short stories.

Thus, those who primarily view Zelda as an inspiration for F

. Scott's writings _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

r

A. overlook the many other factors that motivated F

. Scott to write.

B. risk misrepresenting the full range of Zelda's contributions to literature.

C. may draw inaccurate conclusions about how F

. Scott and Zelda viewed each other's works.

D. tend to read the works of F

. Scott and Zelda in an overly autobiographical light.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice B is the best answer because it most logically completes the text's discussion of Zelda Fitzgerald's contributions to literature. The text

begins by saying that many scholars view Zelda mainly in terms of her marriage to F

. Scott Fitzgerald and "don't recognize Zelda as a writer in her own right.

" The text then mentions a novel and "numerous short stories" that she wrote and that such scholars tend to ignore. Therefore, those

scholars who focus on Zelda only as an inspiration for F

. Scott's writings risk misrepresenting the full range of Zelda's contributions to literature.

Choice A is incorrect. Although the text does mention that Zelda Fitzgerald "likely influenced" her husband's literary work, its focus is on Zelda's

own writing, not on her husband's writing or factors that might have influenced it. Choice C is incorrect because the text does not discuss F

. Scott

and Zelda Fitzgerald's opinions of each other's works. Choice D is incorrect. Although the text does suggest that F

. Scott Fitzgerald's works were

"likely influenced in part" by his marriage to Zelda, it does not discuss autobiographical interpretations of the works of either F

. Scott or Zelda.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 4603d1f7

SOURCE_FILE: Inferences(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 17

SKILL: Inferences

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

In their book *Smart Pricing*, Jagmohan Raju and Z. John Zhang consider musicians' use of the nontraditional "pay as you wish" pricing model. This model generally offers listeners the choice to pay more or less than a suggested price for a song or album-or even to pay nothing at all. As the authors note, that's the option most listeners chose for an album by the band Harvey Danger. Only about 1% opted to pay for the album, resulting in earnings below the band's expectations. But the authors also discuss musician Jane Siberry, who saw significant earnings from her "pay as you wish" online music store as a result of many listeners choosing to pay more than the store's suggested prices. Hence, the "pay as you wish" model may _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. prove financially successful for some musicians but disappointing for others.
 - B. hold greater financial appeal for bands than for individual musicians.
 - C. cause most musicians who use the model to lower the suggested prices of their songs and albums over time.
 - D. more strongly reflect differences in certain musicians' popularity than traditional pricing models do.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice A is the best answer. In one example, musicians made less money than expected by using the "pay as you wish" model. In the other example, a musician made more money than expected. This suggests that some musicians may have more success than others using the "pay as you wish" model.

Choice B is incorrect. This inference isn't supported. In the examples provided, the individual musician was more successful with the "pay as you wish" model than the band was. Choice C is incorrect. This inference isn't supported. The passage provides no instances in which musicians changed the suggested prices of their songs or albums, nor does it mention this as a possibility. Choice D is incorrect. This inference isn't supported. The text never discusses the differences in popularity of different musicians, so there is no basis to make this inference.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 086dd8cc

SOURCE_FILE: Inferences(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 18

SKILL: Inferences

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

The morphological novelty of echinoderms-marine invertebrates with radial symmetry, usually starlike, around a central point impedes comparisons with most other animals, in which bilateral symmetry on an anterior-posterior (head to tail) axis through a trunk is typical. Particularly puzzling are sea stars, thought to have evolved a headless layout from a known bilateral origin. Applying genomic knowledge of *Saccoglossus kowalevskii* acorn worms (close relatives of sea stars, and thus expected to have similar markers for corresponding anatomical regions) to the body patterning genes of *Patiria miniata* sea stars, Laurent Formery et al. observed activity only in anterior genes across P

miniata's entire body and some posterior genes limited to the edges, suggesting that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. despite the greater prevalence of anterior genes in sea stars' genetic makeup, posterior genes active at the body's perimeter are primarily responsible for the starlike layout that distinguishes sea stars' radial symmetry from that of other echinoderms.
 - B. contrary to the belief that they evolved from early ancestors with the bilateral form typical of many other animals, sea stars instead originated with an atypical body layout that was neither bilaterally nor radially symmetrical.
 - C. although the two species are closely related, there is only minimal correspondence in the genetic markers for head, tail, and trunk region development in P
 - . *miniata* sea stars and *S. kowalevskii* acorn worms.
 - D. rather than undergoing changes resulting in the eventual elimination of a head region in their radial body plan, as previously assumed, sea stars' morphology evolved to completely lack a trunk and consist primarily of a head region.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice D is the best answer because it most logically completes the text's discussion of the morphology (form and structure) of sea stars, a type of echinoderm. The text indicates that echinoderms have radially symmetrical body plans (symmetrical around a central point, usually in the form of a star), whereas most animals have bilaterally symmetrical body plans (symmetrical along an axis running from head to tail through a trunk). According to the text, sea stars are unusual echinoderms because, despite their radial body plan, they descended from known bilateral ancestors. This shift in body plan was thought to be a process of losing the genetic markers associated with the head region. The text explains that by comparing the genes of one sea star species (P

. *miniata*) to those of a close relative, the acorn worm, researchers determined that instead, anterior (head) genes are active across the sea star's entire body, posterior (tail) genes are active in limited, peripheral locations of the body, and no trunk-related genes are active. This finding strongly suggests that, rather than becoming "headless" as they evolved from a bilateral ancestor, sea stars developed a body plan consisting almost entirely of a head region with a minimal tail region and no trunk region present.

Choice A is incorrect because the text doesn't identify how any particular region of sea stars' bodies influences the layout of sea stars' radial symmetry. Moreover, the text indicates that the radial symmetry of echinoderms is "usually starlike," not that a starlike layout distinguishes sea stars from other echinoderms. Choice B is incorrect because the text doesn't suggest that the idea that sea stars

evolved from an ancestor with
bilateral symmetry is incorrect (describing the bilateral origin as "known") and doesn't address any body plans other than those with radial or
bilateral symmetry. The text strongly suggests that rather than revealing something about sea stars' origin, Formery et al.
's findings contradict
the assumption that the current body plan of sea stars is "headless."
Choice C is incorrect because the text suggests that Formery et al. were
able to make determinations about P
. miniata sea stars' body plan based on the comparability of genetic markers between P
. miniata and S.
kowalevskii acorn worms. The text indicates only that little or no activity was observed in certain types of
genes associated with body
development in P
. miniata, not that those genes turned out to largely differ from body-development genes in S. kowalevskii.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: e185a21f

SOURCE_FILE: Inferences(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 19

SKILL: Inferences

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

One theory behind human bipedalism speculates that it originated in a mostly ground-based ancestor that practiced four-legged "knuckle-walking,

" like chimpanzees and gorillas do today, and eventually evolved into moving upright on two legs. But recently, researchers observed orangutans, another relative of humans, standing on two legs on tree branches and using their arms for balance while they reached for fruits.

These observations may suggest that _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

r

A. bipedalism evolved because it was advantageous to a tree-dwelling ancestor of humans.

B. bipedalism must have evolved simultaneously with knuckle-walking and tree-climbing.

C. moving between the ground and the trees would have been difficult without bipedalism.

D. a knuckle-walking human ancestor could have easily moved bipedally in trees.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice A is the best answer because it most logically completes the text's discussion of the evolution of bipedalism in humans. According to the text, one potential explanation for humans walking upright on two legs is that the behavior evolved from an ancestor that mostly stayed on the ground and walked on four limbs, as modern chimpanzees and gorillas do. However, the finding that orangutans, also a relative of humans, sometimes stand on two legs in trees while using their arms to balance and reach for fruits suggests another possible explanation: perhaps a tree-dwelling ancestor of humans began moving on two legs because it offered an advantage, such as access to certain foods.

Choice B is incorrect because the finding that modern orangutans (a relative of humans) sometimes stand on two legs in trees doesn't offer any insight into when either bipedalism or tree-climbing behavior emerged in human ancestors. Additionally, the text indicates that one theory is that bipedalism evolved from a mostly ground-based ancestor that was already practicing knuckle-walking, not that bipedalism and knuckle-walking developed at the same time. Choice C is incorrect because the finding that orangutans (a relative of humans) sometimes stand on two legs in trees doesn't offer any insight into how difficult it would've been to move between the ground and the trees without bipedalism; there's no suggestion that climbing or moving in trees depends on the ability to walk on two legs rather than four, even if that ability might be helpful in certain circumstances. Choice D is incorrect because the finding that orangutans (a relative of humans) sometimes stand on two legs in trees doesn't suggest that a knuckle-walking human ancestor could've easily moved on two legs in trees. Although the text indicates that bipedalism may have evolved from a human ancestor that mostly stayed on the ground and walked on four limbs, it gives no indication of how easy it would've been for such an ancestor to move bipedally in trees.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 20000f5f

SOURCE_FILE: Inferences(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 20

SKILL: Inferences

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

Arthur Conan Doyle's stories about detective Sherlock Holmes were published between 1887 and 1927. They have inspired countless successful adaptations, including comic strips, movies, and a television series Sherlock Hound, directed by Hayao Miyazaki, who is celebrated for his animated movies. Until 2014, these stories were copyrighted. The right to adapt was only available to those who could afford the copyright fee and gain approval from the strict copyright holders of Doyle's estate. Some journalists predict that the number of Sherlock Holmes adaptations is likely to increase since the end of copyright means that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. Doyle's original stories will become hard to find.
 - B. people will become more interested in detective stories than they were in the 1800s.
 - C. producing adaptations will become easier and less expensive.
 - D. the former copyright holders of Doyle's estate will return fees they collected.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice C is the best answer. The text tells us that because of the copyright, adapting Sherlock Holmes stories used to be expensive and difficult. This suggests that after the copyright ends, it will be less expensive and less difficult to adapt these stories. Choice A is incorrect. This inference isn't supported. The text never suggests that the copyright ending will make Sherlock Holmes stories harder to find. Instead, it suggests that adaptations of these stories will be easier and less expensive to make. Choice B is incorrect. This inference isn't supported. The text never discusses people's interest in detective stories, so there is no basis to make this inference. Choice D is incorrect. This inference isn't supported. The text never suggests that copyright fees from the past are returned after a copyright ends, so there is no basis to make this inference.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: db876fd5

SOURCE_FILE: Inferences(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 21

SKILL: Inferences

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

Songbirds learn to respond to and imitate their species' songs from an early age. With each generation, small differences are introduced that result in distinct variations-called dialects-among geographically isolated populations of the same species. A research study examined whether twelve-day-old *Ficedula hypoleuca* (pied flycatcher) nestlings prefer local dialects over the unfamiliar dialects of nonlocal *F. hypoleuca* populations: the more begging calls the nestlings made in response to a song, the stronger their preference. The researchers found that nestlings produced more begging calls in response to their own dialect than to nonlocal dialects. Since song preference plays a role in songbird mate selection, the finding suggests that _____ Which choice most logically completes the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. *F. hypoleuca* nestlings' preference for their own dialect likely disappears as they mature to promote socialization between different *F. hypoleuca* populations.
- B. *F. hypoleuca* nestlings who show an early preference for their own dialect are likely to receive more food from their caretakers than nestlings who show no preferences among any *F. hypoleuca* dialects.
- C. *F. hypoleuca* nestlings' preference for their own dialect likely drives them when they mature to reproduce with other *F. hypoleuca* from local rather than nonlocal populations.
- D. *F. hypoleuca* nestlings show a preference for both local *F. hypoleuca* dialects and the songs of other local songbirds over the songs of nonlocal birds of any species.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice C is the best answer. Because "song preference plays a role in songbird mate selection," and because *F. hypoleuca* nestlings display a preference for local dialects, we can infer that they will be more likely to choose mates from local populations. Choice A is incorrect. We don't have any information suggesting that this preference disappears, so there's no basis for this inference. Choice B is incorrect. Although the passage discusses the number of begging calls made in response to various *F. hypoleuca* dialects, no mention is made about the amount of food received based on dialect preference. Therefore, there's no basis for this inference. Choice D is incorrect. There's no mention in the passage of methods of other types of local songbirds, so there's no basis for this inference.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: f39507a3

SOURCE_FILE: Inferences(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 22

SKILL: Inferences

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

One challenge when researching whether holding elected office changes a person's behavior is the problem of ensuring that the experiment has an appropriate control group. To reveal the effect of holding office, researchers must compare people who hold elected office with people who do not hold office but who are otherwise similar to the office-holders. Since researchers are unable to control which politicians win elections, they therefore _____
Which choice most logically completes the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. struggle to find valid data about the behavior of politicians who do not currently hold office.
 - B. can only conduct valid studies with people who have previously held office rather than people who presently hold office.
 - C. should select a control group of people who differ from office-holders in several significant ways.
 - D. will find it difficult to identify a group of people who can function as an appropriate control group for their studies.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice D is the best answer because it presents the conclusion that most logically follows from the text's discussion of the challenge researchers face when studying the effects of holding elected office on a person's behavior. The text explains that it's hard for researchers to test for the effects that elected office has on people because finding people to serve as a control group is difficult. The text indicates that a control group needs to be made up of people who share characteristics of the group being tested but don't have the variable being tested (in this case, holding elected office). Because researchers aren't able to influence who wins elections, they're also unable to determine who would serve as an appropriately similar member of a control group. Thus, it logically follows that researchers will find it difficult to identify a group of people who can function as an appropriate control group for their studies.

Choice A is incorrect because the text focuses on the struggle to put together a control group for experiments; it doesn't suggest that finding information about politicians' behavior is difficult. Choice B is incorrect because the experiments mentioned in the text are testing the effects of holding elected office on a person's behavior. Studying people who have already held elected office wouldn't provide an opportunity to note any behavioral changes that the position might cause. Choice C is incorrect because the text defines people in a control group as those "who are otherwise similar to the office-holders"; selecting people who differ from the office-holders wouldn't fit the criteria for an appropriate control group.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 6bc0e595

SOURCE_FILE: Inferences(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 23

SKILL: Inferences

DIFFICULTY: Easy

QUESTION:

One aspect of in-person shopping that online shopping can't replicate is the opportunity to touch a product before buying it. Does this difference matter? In an experiment, researchers asked one group of participants to touch a mug and a toy, while another group was prohibited from touching the two items. The participants were then asked how much money they'd pay for the items. People who got to touch the items were willing to pay much more money for them than were people who weren't allowed to touch the items. This finding suggests that _____
Which choice most logically completes the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. people who mainly shop online probably spend more money every month than people who mainly shop in person do.
 - B. in-person shopping may make products seem more valuable than they seem if only viewed online.
 - C. retailers with in-person and online stores should charge the same price for a given product in both places.
 - D. online retailers may be able to raise the prices they charge for products that are only available online.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice B is the best answer. The text tells us that "people who got to touch the items were willing to pay much more money for them than people who weren't allowed to touch" them. This suggests that being able to interact with a product in person may make it seem more valuable to a shopper.

Choice A is incorrect. The text doesn't discuss how much people spend each month, so there's not much basis for this claim. Furthermore, since being able to touch a product tends to make people "willing to pay much more money" for it, we might predict that an online shopper would be willing to spend less on the same purchases as an in-person shopper. Choice C is incorrect. The text doesn't discuss what retailers "should charge," so there's not much basis for this claim. Furthermore, the study in the text suggests that in-person stores may actually be able to charge more for a given product, since shoppers can touch it. Choice D is incorrect. The text doesn't discuss products that are only available online, so there's not much basis for this claim. Furthermore, products only available online would still have the problem of shoppers not being able to touch them, and the study suggests that this lowers the prices shoppers are willing to pay.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 09d942c6

SOURCE_FILE: Inferences(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 24

SKILL: Inferences

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

A social species, chickens will cry out to one another in warning if they sense a hawk or other predator nearby. But if alone, a chicken will remain silent so as not to attract the predator's attention. Sonja Hillemacher decided to use this behavior to determine whether individual chickens possess a capacity to recognize themselves visually when reflected in a mirror (a common standard for animal intelligence). In the first condition of her study, the subject could see its reflection, but no other chickens were present. In a second condition, another chicken was visible to the subject. Hillemacher presented an image of a hawk to the subject in both conditions, reasoning that if chickens lacked a capacity for visual self-recognition, then _____ Which choice most logically completes the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. neither study condition would elicit an audible response from the subject.
 - B. the subject likely would cry out a warning in both study conditions.
 - C. only the first study condition would elicit an audible response from the subject.
 - D. the subject would fail to distinguish its reflection from the image of the hawk.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice B is the best answer because it most logically completes the text's discussion of Hillemacher's study of visual self-recognition in chickens. According to the text, when a predator is nearby, chickens cry out in warning if another chicken is present but remain silent if alone to avoid attracting the predator's attention. The text explains that Hillemacher set up one condition in which a subject was alone and could see its reflection in a mirror and another condition in which the subject could see another chicken, and then presented an image of a hawk (a predator). It follows that if chickens aren't capable of recognizing themselves visually in a mirror, the subject likely would cry out a warning in both conditions; in the first condition because it would perceive its reflection as another chicken—that is, it would think another chicken is present—and in the second condition because it would see that another chicken is actually present. Choice A is incorrect because the text suggests that regardless of chickens' ability to visually recognize themselves in mirrors, the subject in the second condition would cry out a warning because another chicken is actually present. Further, if chickens do lack visual self-recognition, the subject in the first condition likely would also cry out because it would think its reflection is another chicken. Choice C is incorrect. The text does suggest that if chickens lack the ability to visually recognize themselves in mirrors, the subject would cry out a warning in the first condition because it would think its reflection is another chicken. However, the text also indicates that regardless of their capacity of self-recognition, chickens cry out a warning when other chickens are present, and another chicken is present in the second condition. Therefore, both conditions—not just the first one—likely would elicit an audible response from the subject. Choice D is incorrect because the text indicates that the study was focused on determining whether chickens recognize themselves visually in a mirror or instead perceive their reflections as other chickens; there's no suggestion that a lack of self-recognition would cause a chicken to confuse its reflection with the image of a hawk.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: f9bd4e61

SOURCE_FILE: Inferences(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 25

SKILL: Inferences

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

German theater practitioner Bertolt Brecht (1898-1956) believed that theater should elicit an intellectual rather than an emotional response from audiences, provoking them to consider social and political realities that extend beyond the characters and events depicted onstage. Brecht's influence can be seen in English playwright Caryl Churchill's 1979 play *Cloud 9*: although the play sometimes invites empathetic reactions, it primarily works to engage audiences in an interrogation of patriarchy and colonialism, which it does by placing audiences at a distance, thereby encouraging them to _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. focus on the characters' beliefs about social and political issues as revealed by the characters' actions.
 - B. reflect on social and political phenomena not directly related to patriarchy and colonialism.
 - C. recognize pertinent social and political parallels between Germany during Brecht's time and England at the time when Churchill was writing *Cloud 9*.
 - D. be dispassionate as they think critically about the social and political questions raised by the play.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice D is the best answer. Churchill's play was influenced by Brecht's belief that theater should elicit an intellectual rather than an emotional response from audiences, making them think about social and political issues that also exist outside of the play. Therefore, it makes sense that Churchill would strive to have audiences think dispassionately (i.e., without emotion) and critically about the social and political questions raised by the play.

Choice A is incorrect. The passage mentions that Churchill was influenced by Brecht's belief that plays should provoke audience members "to consider social and political realities that extend beyond the characters and events depicted onstage," so there's no basis for an inference about audience members deeply engaging with characters' beliefs and actions. Choice B is incorrect. Reflecting on things that aren't related to patriarchy and colonialism wouldn't "engage audiences in an interrogation of patriarchy and colonialism." That creates a confusing contradiction.

Choice C is incorrect. No mention is made of social and political issues in Germany during Brecht's time, so there's no basis for this inference.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 4889580c

SOURCE_FILE: Inferences(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 26

SKILL: Inferences

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

Archaeologists and historians used to believe that the Maya civilization during its Classic period (roughly 250-900) lacked agricultural marketplaces. One reason for this belief was that these scholars misunderstood the ecology of the regions the Maya inhabited. Marketplaces typically emerge because different individuals or groups want to trade resources they control for resources they don't control. Scholars seriously underestimated the ecological diversity of the Maya landscape and thus assumed that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

ANSWER CHOICES:

- r
- A. marketplaces likely would not have attracted many traders from outside the regions controlled by the Maya.
 - B. farming practices would have been largely the same throughout Maya lands even if the crops people produced varied significantly.
 - C. marketplaces would not have enabled Maya people to acquire many products different from those they already produced.
 - D. farmers would trade agricultural products only if they had already produced enough to meet their own needs.

CORRECT ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice C is the best answer because it presents the conclusion that most logically follows from the text's discussion of scholars' understanding of Maya ecology and agricultural marketplaces. The text indicates that scholars used to believe that during the Classic period, the Maya civilization didn't have agricultural marketplaces. According to the text, scholars held this view because they misunderstood the ecology of areas where the Maya lived. The text points out that people tend to create marketplaces in order to acquire resources they don't otherwise control. Agricultural marketplaces would have allowed farmers who produced one type of crop to trade that crop for other types of crops that they didn't produce. The text goes on to say, however, that scholars underestimated the ecological diversity of the Maya areas, meaning that scholars thought that the Maya landscape produced a smaller range of resources than it actually produced. Taken together, then, this information suggests that scholars assumed that marketplaces wouldn't have allowed Maya people to acquire products different from the products they already produced: that is, if everyone produced the same array of crops, as scholars mistakenly believed, then there wouldn't have been any need for marketplaces where people could trade those crops.

Choice A is incorrect because the text doesn't say anything about trade between the Maya and people from outside the regions controlled by the Maya. Although scholars' mistaken belief that the Maya lands weren't very ecologically diverse would give those scholars a reason to think that the Maya didn't have marketplaces, it wouldn't lead scholars to assume that traders from outside Maya lands were uninterested in acquiring resources produced by the Maya. Even if the Maya actually did produce only a small array of resources throughout their lands, there is no reason to believe from the text that people outside Maya lands also produced these same resources and thus would have no need to trade with the Maya people. Choice B is incorrect because the text indicates that scholars underestimated the ecological diversity of the Maya lands, which suggests that they mistakenly believed that the Maya produced a relatively small array of resources throughout their territory, not that the crops the Maya produced varied significantly throughout the Maya lands. Although the scholars might have assumed that a lack of ecological diversity suggests that Maya farming practices were largely the same everywhere, the text does not support that they also

assumed there was a lot of variation in the crops that Maya people produced. In fact, the text states that marketplaces emerge when people want to obtain resources they don't already control. If it were the case that scholars assumed that the crops Maya people produced varied significantly, this would have led them to conclude that Maya people likely established marketplaces so they could trade for resources they didn't already possess, not that the Maya civilization lacked marketplaces. Choice D is incorrect because nothing in the text suggests that scholars assumed that farmers wouldn't trade their agricultural products unless they had already met their own needs with those products. Instead, the text says that scholars thought that the Maya lands produced a smaller array of resources than they actually did, which the text suggests led scholars to assume that the Maya

didn't have any need for marketplaces. The scholars' mistaken belief has no bearing on the issue of whether farmers met their own needs before trading their products.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 4ba0695d

SOURCE_FILE: Inferences(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 28

SKILL: Inferences

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

The alpaca was domesticated by Indigenous peoples in the Andes about 7,000 years ago. But which wild species did it descend from, the vicuña or guanaco? A research team led by Ruiwen Fan may have solved the mystery, concluding that the alpaca is the domesticated form of the vicuña but that the modern alpaca gets only 64 percent of its genetic material from its wild ancestor. The rest comes from the domesticated llama. The llama, meanwhile, gets 95.5 percent of its genetic material from its own wild ancestor, the guanaco, and the rest from the alpaca. The llama and alpaca apparently interbred widely for only a handful of generations between 400 and 600 years ago. Assuming that the findings of Fan's team are valid, it can be inferred that _____ Which choice most logically completes the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. modern llama populations have a greater degree of genetic diversity, on average, than modern alpaca populations do.
 - B. the domestication process of the alpaca may have involved some introduction of genetic material from the llama.
 - C. the period of interbreeding resulted in a greater genetic difference between alpacas and their wild ancestors than between llamas and their wild ancestors.
 - D. if they were subjected to genetic testing, modern populations of guanacos and vicuñas would likely show traces of ancient interbreeding as well.

CORRECT_ANSWER:**RATIONALE:**

e

Choice C is the best answer because it presents the inference that most logically follows from the text's discussion of the genetic material of alpacas. The text states that modern alpacas get only 64 percent of their genetic material from their wild ancestor (the vicuña), while llamas get 95.5 percent of their genetic material from their wild ancestor (the guanaco). These data imply that relative to llamas, alpacas have experienced a much greater genetic shift away from their wild ancestors (36 percent of their genetic material derives from another source, compared to 4.5 percent of llamas' genetic material). Moreover, the text establishes that the remainder of alpacas' genetic material derives from llamas, and the remainder of llamas' genetic material derives from alpacas, reflecting a period of interbreeding. Taken together, these details support the inference that the period of interbreeding had a more significant impact on the genetic material of alpacas than on that of llamas, thereby reducing the percentage of alpacas' genetic material that derives from wild ancestors and placing alpacas at a greater remove from these ancestors.

Choice A is incorrect because the text doesn't provide information about genetic diversity within modern llama and alpaca populations. While the text discusses the percentage of genetic material each domesticated species inherited from its wild ancestor and from interbreeding, it does not address the level of genetic variation within each species. Therefore, it isn't logical to infer that modern llama populations have a greater degree of genetic diversity than modern alpaca populations do. Choice B is incorrect because it contradicts the chronology presented in the text. The text states that alpacas were domesticated about 7,000 years ago, but the interbreeding with llamas occurred "between 400 and 600 years ago."

The genetic mixing happened thousands of years after domestication, not during it; in addition, the text does not

provide details about what the process of domestication might entail. Therefore, it isn't logical to infer that llama genetic material was introduced during the domestication process of alpacas. Choice D is incorrect because though the text notes that guanacos and vicuñas contributed to the genetic material of alpacas and llamas, it only discusses alpacas' and llamas' genetic composition. Therefore, the text does not support the inference that modern populations of guanacos and vicuñas would likely show traces of ancient interbreeding.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: d95a0bb8

SOURCE_FILE: Inferences(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 29

SKILL: Inferences

DIFFICULTY: Hard

QUESTION:

The ratio of methane to other atmospheric constituents-represented by a measure called the methane mole fraction-influences a variety of meteorological phenomena, notably precipitation and humidity. For Titan, Saturn's largest moon, the observational data that exist are too sparse and discrepant to fully constrain the range of the methane mole fraction at various atmospheric levels. Juan Lora and colleagues point out that outputs of the IPSL atmospheric model of Titan, which track closely to observations in some respects, reflect how the model's developers responded to this challenge: by prescribing a uniform methane mole fraction for the lowest level of the atmosphere. It is therefore important to note that _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

ANSWER CHOICES:

- r
- A. some disagreements between the model's simulations of Titan's precipitation and humidity and the moon's actual precipitation and humidity are to be expected.
 - B. further observations of Titan may clarify the moon's methane mole fraction sufficiently for the model to employ a single value rather than a range.
 - C. even though the model's outputs sometimes agree with observational data, Titan's real methane mole fraction is likely higher than the methane mole fraction used in the model.
 - D. inconsistencies across the model's simulations of Titan's precipitation and humidity could be attributable to variations in the moon's methane mole fraction.

CORRECT ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice A is the best answer because it most logically completes the text's discussion of modeling the atmosphere of Titan. The text establishes that the methane mole fraction (the ratio of methane to other atmospheric components) influences precipitation, humidity, and other meteorological phenomena and that observational data for Titan are too lacking ("too sparse and discrepant") to fully determine the range of this measure across the moon's various atmospheric levels. The text indicates that because of this limitation, researchers developed an atmospheric model (IPSL) that uses a simplified approach: it applies a uniform methane mole fraction for the lowest atmospheric level. Since it is very unlikely that the actual methane distribution across atmospheric levels on Titan is uniform, and since the methane mole fraction directly affects precipitation and humidity, it logically follows that the model's simplified treatment of the methane mole fraction would lead to some disagreements between the model's simulations and Titan's actual precipitation and humidity.

Choice B is incorrect because the text makes it clear that the model already uses a single value for Titan's methane mole fraction instead of a range. Further, the text suggests that the single value is a simplification of what is likely a more complex reality, so there's no reason to assume that a single value would be more desirable than a range. Choice C is incorrect. The text strongly suggests that Titan's actual methane mole fraction differs from the uniform value used in the model, even though some of the model's outputs align closely with observations, but nothing in the text indicates how the actual value would differ. There's no reason to assume that the actual methane mole fraction is higher than what the model uses. The "lowest level" mentioned in the text refers to the atmosphere and not Titan's methane mole fraction. Choice D is incorrect

because the text makes it clear that the model doesn't reflect the actual variations in the methane mole fraction across Titan's atmospheric levels, since observational data are too limited. Because the model uniformly applies a set methane mole fraction, no inconsistencies in the simulations would be attributable to actual variations in the moon's methane mole fraction.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 3cc2eacc

SOURCE_FILE: Inferences(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 30

SKILL: Inferences

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

In a study of the mechanisms underlying associative memory-or the ability to learn and remember connections between inherently unrelated things-neuroscientists Kei Igarashi, Jasmine Chavez, and others presented mice with memory tests. The team discovered that fan cells, a type of cell found in the medial temporal lobe of the brain, are necessary for the acquisition of new associative memories. They also found that fan cell activity requires dopamine, a chemical the brain produces in response to pleasure and rewards. Consequently, receiving a reward should likely help to _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. decrease an individual's capacity to utilize dopamine.
 - B. increase an individual's capacity to recognize differences between unrelated things.
 - C. increase an individual's capacity to form associative memories.
 - D. decrease an individual's capacity to create fan cells.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice C is the best answer because it most logically completes the text's discussion of the mechanisms underlying associative memory. The text explains that fan cells-a type of brain cell-are necessary for the acquisition of new associative memories, and that activity among these cells requires a chemical known as dopamine, which the brain produces in response to rewards. Since the brain cells that enable the formation of associative memories require dopamine in order to function, and since the brain produces dopamine in response to rewards, it can be inferred that receiving a reward should likely help to increase an individual's capacity to form associative memories. Choice A is incorrect because the relationship between rewards and dopamine sketched by the text is that rewards result in the production of dopamine, not that they cause an individual's capacity to utilize dopamine to decrease. Choice B is incorrect. The text suggests that receiving a reward would produce dopamine and thereby assist with associative memory formation. However, the text never suggests that associative memory involves the capacity to recognize differences between unrelated things, indicating only that associative memory involves remembering what connects those things. Choice D is incorrect because the text never discusses how fan cells are initially created and therefore provides no evidence for a conclusion about how receiving a reward would affect their creation.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 5bcee487

SOURCE_FILE: Inferences(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 31

SKILL: Inferences

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

Pablo Picasso famously subverted the norms of traditional painting: in his cubist paintings he refused to let his expression be constrained, fragmenting objects and figures to present multiple perspectives simultaneously. Though less widely known, Picasso—who once lamented that writers of his time had "limited themselves to moving around words somewhat while respecting the syntax"—also wrote poetry that defied conventional grammar, semantic relationships, and text structure. Thus, the paintings and poems are linked in that _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

r

- A. the poems present many of the same subjects as the paintings but with different thematic approaches.
- B. the poems are intended to be understood as explanations of the artistic inclinations reflected in the paintings.
- C. both types of work are characterized by the simultaneous representation of multiple points of view that Picasso is known for.
- D. both exhibit Picasso's prioritization of creative expression over the standard rules of the art forms.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice D is the best answer because it most logically completes the text's discussion of the link between Picasso's cubist paintings and his poetry. The text states that Picasso subverted, or intentionally went against, the norms of traditional painting; rather than following conventional rules about how paintings should look, he fragmented objects and figures to present multiple perspectives at the same time. The text explains that similarly, Picasso wrote poetry that defied conventions of grammar, semantics, and structure. Because Picasso subverted the conventions of both painting and written language in favor of unconstrained expression, it is reasonable to conclude that his paintings and poems are linked by their demonstration of his prioritization of creative expression over the standard rules of the art forms. Choice A is incorrect because the text doesn't give any information about the subjects or themes of either Picasso's paintings or his poems; it indicates only that Picasso didn't adhere to the norms of either art form. Choice B is incorrect. Although the text explains that the forms of Picasso's paintings and his poems demonstrate his inclination to not be constrained by convention, it doesn't discuss any of the ideas expressed in his poems; there's no indication that Picasso intended his poems to be understood as explanations of anything reflected in his paintings. Choice C is incorrect. The text mentions the simultaneous representation of multiple points of view as a characteristic of Picasso's cubist paintings but doesn't indicate that his poems had the same characteristic; the text doesn't address perspective in Picasso's poems at all.

END_QUESTION

QUESTION_ID: 54057e3f

SOURCE_FILE: Inferences(1).pdf

SOURCE_PAGE: 32

SKILL: Inferences

DIFFICULTY: Medium

QUESTION:

Although military veterans make up a small proportion of the total population of the United States, they occupy a significantly higher proportion of the jobs in the civilian government. One possible explanation for this disproportionate representation is that military service familiarizes people with certain organizational structures that are also reflected in the civilian government bureaucracy, and this familiarity thus _____
Which choice most logically completes the text?

ANSWER_CHOICES:

- r
- A. makes civilian government jobs especially appealing to military veterans.
 - B. alters the typical relationship between military service and subsequent career preferences.
 - C. encourages nonveterans applying for civilian government jobs to consider military service instead.
 - D. increases the number of civilian government jobs that require some amount of military experience to perform.

CORRECT_ANSWER:

RATIONALE:

e

Choice A is the best answer because it presents the conclusion that most logically follows from the text's discussion of military veterans working in civilian government jobs in the United States. The text indicates that the proportion of military veterans working in civilian government jobs is considerably higher than the proportion of military veterans in the population as a whole. The text also notes that the unusually high representation of military veterans in these jobs may be a result of the organizational structures shared by civilian government entities and the military. Hence, it's reasonable to infer that it's the familiarity of the structures of civilian government that makes jobs there particularly attractive to military veterans.

Choice B is incorrect because the text doesn't address what a typical relationship between military service and later career preferences would be, and there's no indication that it's atypical for veterans to work in civilian government jobs after they've left the military. On the contrary, the text suggests that many military veterans are drawn to such jobs. Choice C is incorrect because the text is focused on the high representation of military veterans in civilian government jobs and doesn't address nonveterans or their possible interest in military service. Choice D is incorrect because the text conveys that military veterans may be particularly interested in civilian government jobs due to the familiarity of organizational structures that are already in place, but there's no reason to think that this interest would mean that more civilian government jobs will start to require military experience.

END_QUESTION